

Premier Energies (PREMIERENE)

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To To

The Secretary The Manager,
BSE Limited Listing Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Dalal Street, Exchange Plaza, C-1, G Block, Bandra-Kurla
Mumbai – 400001 Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051
Scrip Code: 544238 Trading Symbol: PREMIERENE

Sub: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter ended
September 30, 2024

Dear Sir/ Madam,

Pursuant to Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, please find enclosed the transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter ended September 30, 2024, conducted after the meeting of the Board of Directors held on November 08, 2024.

The above information will be made available on the website of the Company
This is for your information and records
Thanking you,
Yours truly,
For Premier Energies Limited

Ravella Sreenivasa Rao
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

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"Premier Energies Limited
Q2 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call"
November 08, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SALUJA – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. ABHISHEK LOONKER – NON-EXECUTIVE
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. N. K. KHANDELWAL – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER
– PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Premier Energies Q2 FY25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference, please signal an operator by

pressing star and then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Dorwin. Good evening. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the first call of Premier Energies Limited, whose successful listing is September 24. Today, we have with us from the management, Mr. Chiranjeev Saluja, Managing Director, Mr. Abhishek Loonker, Non-Executive Director, and Mr. N. K. Khandelwal, CFO. We'll begin with the opening remarks from the management, followed by Q&A. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you. So good evening, everyone, and thank you all for joining us today. This is a special moment for Premier Energies as we are addressing our first analyst call post listing. I am Chiranjeev Saluja, Managing Director of Premier Energies, and it is an honour to present our quarterly results in this new chapter of our journey. I'm joined today by my colleagues, N. K. Khandelwal, Group CFO, and Abhishek Loonker, Non-Executive Director. It's a proud moment for us to share with all of you that Premier Energies has clocked another quarter of outstanding operational and financial performance, hosting excellent revenue and earnings growth.

For the Q2 FY25, company has achieved a revenue of INR1,553.59 crores as against INR701.81 crores in Q2 FY24, marking a 121.4% year-on-year increase. This growth is driven by robust demand from domestic market, reflecting solar energy's growing importance in the energy mix. Our exports for this quarter were 2.82% of the quarterly revenue. The EBITDA for the quarter stood at INR406.95 crores compared to INR107.02 crores in Q2 FY24, exhibiting a growth of 280.2%. The EBITDA margin improved from 15.25% in Q2 FY24 to 26.19% in Q2 FY25. This improvement highlights our focus on operational excellence, cost optimization, and our ability to efficiently ramp up capacity and meet the rising demand.

The profit after tax for the quarter serves to INR205.95 crores, making a remarkable 289.6% year-on-year growth compared to INR52.86 crores in the same period last year. PAT margin has improved from 7.53% in Q2 FY24 to 13.26% in Q2 FY25. The proceeds from our IPO have significantly strengthened our balance sheet. Our net debt-to-EBITDA ratio was 5.5 in H1 FY24, and today we are net cash positive.

As we discuss our performance, it is equally important to touch upon our future growth plans and the broader outlook of the solar sector. We are executing a 1 GW TOPCon cell line expansion, which will be completed by Q4 FY25. Further leveraging the opportunities for backward integration, we are planning an investment into a wafer manufacturing facility of 2 GW, which is targeted to be commissioned by FY26.

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We are also pleased to announce today our foray into aluminium frame manufacturing business by setting up a 36,000 metric ton per annum facility for captive consumption. This project would require a capex of INR230 crores, wherein the equity portion of 25% will be funded through internal accruals. This investment into aluminium frame manufacturing will improve our EBITDA margin by 100 basis points to 150 basis points.

We are very well placed to benefit from the solar power demand outlook, and we are highly confident of achieving timely project execution and turnaround by lever

aging our core strengths

and delivering value-enhancing investments to our stakeholders. I look forward to sharing and discussing our progress in detail with all of you in the years to come. Thank you, and we are now open for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. Anyone who wishes to ask a question may please press star and 1 on their touchtone telephone. If you wish to withdraw yourself from the question queue, you may press star and 2. Participants are requested to use handsets while asking a question. Ladies and gentlemen, we will wait for a moment while the question queue assembles. We have the first question from the line of Deepak Krishnan from Kotak Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Deepak Krishnan: Congratulations on a good set of numbers. Maybe just wanted to first start off, you know, given the strong performance in H1, is there any sort of revenue and EBITDA margin guidance that you would want to give for the full year?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it's not that we cannot give any guidance, but what we can tell you is that, you know, being one of the top companies in the solar manufacturing space in India, we will continue to maintain leadership position and as the industry grows, we will be in the top tier of the growth.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure. Maybe just wanted to sort of understand this sharp margin improvement that we've kind of seen. Even considering the fact that we've seen a sharp increase in other expenses. Anything that you want to call out why other expenses have seen a sharp jump QoQ when revenues have sort of been flat?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, margin improvement has happened because lines have stabilized and they are working on better utilization compared to last year. And last year our cell line was not commissioned. It had got commissioned only in the Q3 of last year. And then also efficiency in procurement because of scale what we have. So, all these have contributed for the margin improvement.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure. Just anything on the other expense? You've seen a sharp jump QoQ with, you know, for a flat revenue base. It's gone up to INR194 crores from about INR131 crores.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So that's as per our policy and provisions as the revenue is growing. We have a provision which is there for warranty because modules are sold on a 25-to-30-year warranty. So, because if you look at the revenues, they've almost doubled compared to last year. So that's how that provision has gone up.

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Deepak Krishnan: Maybe just wanted to sort of check out in terms of any volume numbers that you want to indicate in terms of production of cell and module that you did. I know we already have the revenue numbers in the presentation, but any broad range of how much did we produce cell and module?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we generally track and share revenue numbers and both not volume and revenue because of confidentiality reasons. So, I think revenue is what would give you an indicator on volumes.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure. I just wanted to sort of understand because, you know, if we assume sort of very strong EBITDA margins of maybe 35%-40% on cell, even at module level, we will be doing north of 20%. So, is there sort of like a healthy mix of DCR also in the module revenue numbers?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we do have a healthy mix of DCR because we are one of the very few two or three players who are making DCR cells in India. And if you talk of the EBITDA margins, the operating EBITDA margins have increased by about 3.3%. And then this is again because of operational efficiency and also a mix of DCR and non-DCR remains almost constant every quarter. But there is a healthy mix.

Deepak Krishnan: Maybe just one final question from my end. I think just wanted to understand our US expansion policy given the change in government in the US And,

does this further strengthen our thought

process of expanding on the ground presence in the US? Or how are you looking at if there is any potential IRA rollback or any of that, how would you consider your investments today?

Exports is a very small part, I understand. But obviously we are also looking at certain expansions in the US

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, our exports have been not very significant for a long time now. It's simply because of the demand for the domestic market. There is a huge domestic market demand and we are committed to the requirements in the Indian market. On US expansion, we are a little bit of a wait and watch looking at the political developments. We have signed, you know, an MOU and announced that we'll be setting up a gigawatt of facility along with our US partner that's Heliene.

Generally, as I had even told earlier in my investor meetings that to construct a cell line takes about 2 to 3 years. We are just starting off now. And we will be looking at how developments happen. We are one of the few companies in solar manufacturing in India which is not dependent on the US market.

Deepak Krishnan: Yes, sir. I think those are my questions and best of luck for future projects. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We have the next question from the line of Bala Murali Krishna from Oman Investment Advisors. Please go ahead.

Bala Murali Krishna: Yes, good evening. I want to understand the margins going forward in backward integration. So, where would it be by the year end?

Chiranjeev Saluja: You know, it's our plan to maintain similar margins than what they are today. And according to us, we will continue to maintain these margins because the industry, the demand is very robust.

We are looking at a little bit of softening the margins only after about 2 to 3 years.

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Bala Murali Krishna: Okay. And as per the module capacity, as of now, we have 4.13 GW. Out of which, could you please break up technology-wise like TOPCon how much and monocrystalline how much?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yeah. So, our lines are apart from the 250 megawatt, that's 0.25 GW of polycrystalline line. Everything else is neutral. We can do Mono Perc, TOPCon, HAT, anything what we want.

Bala Murali Krishna: I mean, there is no rate of investment in the technology.

Chiranjeev Saluja: No. At the moment, almost 70% to 80% of our production is TOPCon. To move to HJT, the, spend on capex is insignificant. It is just changing some jigs and fixtures. So, it's not material at all. But I'm talking about module line.

Bala Murali Krishna: Okay. Understood. So, by the year-end, we are going to commission again a 1 GW cell facility

also. So, how much it could contribute to the margins? Like you mentioned that aluminum frame will contribute 1% to 1.5%.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, for aluminum, we have already shared the improvement in margins. TOPCon is a technology which is just coming into India. And it is the first time even we are pouring into

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Vipraw Srivastava from Phillip Capital. Please go ahead.

Vipraw Srivastava : So, just first question on your margins. Obviously, you are making margins which is very higher than your peers. And I understand that is because of the DCR cells which you are selling. But it is being anticipated that by year-end, India should have around 10 GW to 12 GW of cells coming online from various players. Then that monopoly which you have currently goes away. So, how do you see margins progressing? Because if more solar capacity comes online, then the DCR compliant modules which are selling at very high elevation right now, might fall gradually.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, we had given this in all our investor presentations that the demand is very robust. And as more cell lines come up and competition catches up, there would be a softening of EBITDA

margins from where they are today. And this would take at least about 2 to three years as cell lines come up. But it also depends on how demand increases in US and in India. So, it's very difficult to give an answer to that today.

Vipraw Srivastava: Fair enough, sir. So, currently, obviously, since ALMM and cells are still some time away, government is indicating 2026. So, I mean, what benefit do you have compared to China because cells sourced from China are still cheap. So, apart from DCR, there is no regulatory requirement to use Indian-made cells. What's your pitch to players if you're pitching your cells?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, these are two different markets. What is happening in China is an oversupply situation. They are bleeding. You can look at the financials of Chinese companies. They are suffering huge losses when you see their quarter-on-quarter results. So, it's a very tricky question to compare what China prices are today. Because when you look at China prices over the last one, one and a half years, they are today selling below even material costs because of survival. So, there are two different markets in India. And even if you talk of Chinese companies making solar cells

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outside China, we are able to compete with them. It's only in China that they are able to dump to other countries. So, it's very difficult to compare these two markets.

Vipraw Srivastava: Well, in the non-DCR market, someone who is sourcing the cell from China will have an advantage. Indian-model manufacturers sourcing a cell from China will have an advantage, right, in the non-DCR market?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, we also have a non-DCR market. So, we do import cells from China for our IPP customers. And that's a significant portion of our revenue. So, there is no competition between these two markets. When an IPP customer wants solar panels from us with Chinese cells, we do import and give them solar modules which are ALMM compliant. Now, once ALCM gets imposed, which the government has announced that they will impose in the future date, then there will be no difference because then everything will become DCR.

Vipraw Srivastava: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Darshil Pandya from Finterest Capital. Please go ahead.

Darshil Pandya: Thank you and congratulations on the great set of numbers, sir. Sir, my first question would be on, there is some anti-dumping duty petition filed by the Indian solar firms. Do you have any update on that as on where this thing is right now?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It's still in the nascent stage. It's just been filed a couple of days ago. So, there is no development or significant update on that as of today.

Darshil Pandya: Okay. And do we expect any timeline or something that we may expect some developments from here on?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It's difficult to say. It may take a couple of months and it depends. There are a lot of stakeholders involved. So, we really cannot give the outcome of this.

Darshil Pandya: Okay. All right. And, sir, the second question would be, sir, what percentage of revenue comes from government projects? Or do we do something that we get revenues from the government sector?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, in the government sector, we've got direct and indirect Then our revenue in H1 has been around 10.3%.

Darshil Pandya: From government?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Okay.

Darshil Pandya: And, sir, how are we targeting to increase our revenue from government? Are we targeting that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It depends. I mean, it depends on how the tenders come up, what the payment terms are. So, it all depends.

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Darshil Pandya: Got it. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We have the next question from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go

ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Hi. Thank you so much for taking my question. I had a couple of questions on the expansion that we had mentioned in the geography. So, the 4 GW cell and module line, have we given out orders for the expansion yet?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the order in the 4 GW project is that the land has already been acquired. We have finished with the land levelling and the boundary wall. We have already signed the agreements with the consultant who is going to be doing the design and engineering. And the tool finalization process is ongoing. As of today, we have not released the orders for the tools.

Nidhi Shah: All right. And, again, so the timeline that we had mentioned earlier for the setup of this, we are well in order to achieve that timeline? Yes.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, we are well on track.

Nidhi Shah: So, we were also talking about a JV in the US where we would essentially produce modules in the US?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the JV in the US is to produce US cells. Our JV partner in the US is a module manufacturer, manufacturing modules for the last 14 years in the US. We are progressing well, but as of now, we are in a wait-and-watch situation. Because of the political developments in the US., we want to wait to understand the new regime's stand on the IRA benefits. So, as of now, we are just focusing on design and identifying the sites. So, we will be updating more on this as we progress.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you so much for my question.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Naman Jain from Kotak Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Naman Jain: So, congratulations on a great set of numbers. Actually, you were going through your presentation and one of the things which you have shared is the module pricing, right? So, Mono Perc is currently trading at USD0.19 while TOPCon is trading at USD0.11. Any reason for this? Is it because of DCR and its weighted average or is there some other reason or a difference?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think those were prices given in the Chinese China market. Let me just look at that. So, as of now, in India, the TOPCon module prices are around USD 0.155 to USD 0.16 for non-DCR and DCR is around USD0.23 to USD0.24.

Naman Jain: Okay. And any other reason for the gap, is just because of China, is it?

Chiranjeev Saluja: You are talking about the drop in prices in China?

Naman Jain: No, just the gap.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. The gap is because China is leading. They are selling below cost and we are able to get full advantage of that. Other customers in India, the IPPs are getting full advantage of cheaper solar cells from China because of overcapacity in China and that's why we are able to give them modules at USD 0.155 to USD 0.16.

Naman Jain: Got it. Thank you. That's it.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Deepak Saha from KR Choksey Shares and Securities. Please go ahead.

Deepak Saha: So, my question is, on the wafer side, the capacity expansion that we are doing, so can you please highlight your plans for polysilicon? What are your plans exactly? What are the dynamics there?

Do you have Indian suppliers for 16th grade silicon or are we looking to import it and further processes for ingots? If you can highlight that particular part on the wafer side.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. So, we have announced even in our DRHP and RHP that we have entered into an agreement with a Taiwanese company to set up wafer manufacturing. The equipment for this has already been ordered and we expect, commissioning sometime in FY26 for this 2 GW wafering facility. And we will also get into backward integration to ingot subsequently once this line stabilizes. We don't have any plans to get into polysilicon manufacturing. We will be sourcing our polysilicon from outside India. And as and when polysilicon is available

in India

under the PLI scheme, if we get polysilicon in India, we will buy it in India. But if we don't, we would import polysilicon.

Deepak Saha: So, even without having polysilicon, will we still be able to gain better margins with the wafer

backward integration that we have gained, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Even without getting into polysilicon, wafer and ingot itself will improve our margins.

Deepak Saha: Okay. And the last part is, I missed it. Pardon me for that. On the US side, did you say your plans to set up the JV of a plant in the US is currently on hold because of policy uncertainty?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, it's not on hold. We're just going a little slow to understand, to get more clarity on their views on clean energy transition. So, it's not on hold. As I told, any case, it takes about 2 and a half, 3 years to set up a cell line. So, it's progressing. But we will just look at how things develop on the US side with the speculations and kind of rumours on how the focus will be on clean energy.

Deepak Saha: No, my question is to be more specific. Is it just because of the change in government? Because I'm just trying to understand. The particular company you are trying to set up the JV with, no change on that part, right? That remains untapped. It's just the policy uncertainty and those things are impacting your decision, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, there is no change in our plans with our JV partner. We have an excellent relationship with them. The whole point of going a little slow is only to understand how the new regime in the US decides on the clean energy transition. There's no other reason.

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Deepak Saha: Okay. Thank you, sir. I'll fall back on that.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harshil Shethia from Renaissance Investments. Please go ahead.

Harshil Shethia: Can you outline the total capex value planned for the cell module and the wafer manufacturing facility?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, for the 1- GW cell line, the capex investment is about INR670 crores. For the 4 GW plus 4 GW, which is coming from the IPO route, is INR3,300 crores. And on the wafer, it's about INR175 crores.

Harshil Shethia: And for the aluminum manufacturing?

Chiranjeev Saluja: INR230 crores.

Harshil Shethia: Okay. And that would be done in phases. So, how much would be done in FY25?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, FY25, we will be finishing the 1 GW of TOPCon, which is the INR670 crores. The aluminum would come in FY26 and everything else will come in FY27.

Moderator: Thank you. Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikhil Abhyankar from UTI Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Thank you, sir. I just had a query on the order book position that you have given in the PPT. So, this 3,800-megawatt order book that you have mentioned, is it only for module or is it module plus cell? Can you just clarify?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it is both put together.

Nikhil Abhyankar: It is cell plus module. Can you just give us a split, if you can?

Chiranjeev Saluja: The split is already shown in the investor presentation. In the revenue mix, it's about INR3,943 crores for modules and INR1,915 crores for cell and INR375 crores for EPC.

Nikhil Abhyankar: So, this pipeline of 4,250 megawatt, given the bidding activity that we have seen in India, isn't it a bit less? How exactly do you target your projects for which you will be bidding?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the bidding activity is quite robust. The demand is really high, but looking at the volatility in the market, we don't take very long-term kind of bets on orders. So, these are orders which we look at finalizing and closing in the next 6 months-8 months.

Nikhil Abhyankar : Okay. It is only that activity. Sure, sir. That's all from me, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aashish Upganlawar from Inves

Q PMS. Please go ahead.

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Aashish Upganlawar: Thank you so much. Sir, on the question that was asked on your standard for the US capacity, is it possible to give some more insights whether current IRA, can the new government basically scrap it?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we have not heard anything concrete that there is going to be any change in the IRA. There are kind of rumours and market news and speculation based on statements given by the various political parties when they were campaigning. So, after the government is in place now, we have to wait and watch. We have to see what kind of stance they take. As of now, there is no change.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Anant from Mount Intra Finance. Please go ahead.

Anant: Hi. Thank you for taking my question. I have two questions. Could you please provide me an overview of the major raw materials required for a solar module and their respective contributions as percentages to a 1 GW module? So, let's just say solar cells, solar glass, aluminum frames, how much would that account for as a cost?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, this keeps changing depending on the price for solar cells. As of today, when you talk of non-DCR modules being sold at USD 0.155, USD 0.16, the contribution for cells is close to about 40%. And then the BOM, that is the Balance of Material, is the rest of the contribution which comes in. In terms of, you know, an overall mix of DCR, non-DCR cells, our material margin is ranging between 35% to 38%.

Moderator: Thank you. We will proceed to the next question, which will be from the line of Sarang Joglekar from Vimana Capital. Please go ahead.

Sarang Joglekar: Thanks for the opportunity. So, just wanted to understand, is there any, I mean, regional hold in the industry? For example, you have factory in Telangana, so does that mean that you have better holdover market in that region and other people who are in factories in North, they control the market there? Is there any kind of thing?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, there is nothing like any significance that, you know, because we are based in Telangana, we have a stronger market share in this region. We sell all across India. We sell our solar cells to over 25 module manufacturers in India. So, we sell all across India. There is no specific regional mix.

Sarang Joglekar: Okay. And so, can you give a distribution of how much of your modules are sold directly to EPC or through government vendors or through distributors?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we have, about maximum sales are, in domestic terms, it is about 41%. And to IPP, this is 32%. We do OEM for customers, that is about 12.2%. And export is about 3.9%. So that's the mix. So IPP customers is 31%. IPP is a large power plant developer

Sarang Joglekar: Thanks. That's it from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vipraw Srivastava from PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

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Vipraw Srivastava: I just wanted to understand, annually, what is the DCR market in terms of gigawatts in India annually? And this is growing. The pipeline is huge.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, this is increasing now with the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana and the Kusum scheme, which was announced. In fact, one of the components of the Kusum scheme was converted to DCR from 1st of April, 24. So the demand is anywhere between, as on today, between 10 GW to 12 GW, and this is growing. The pipeline is huge. So, when you talk of pipeline, there is, the Kusum scheme, which has a huge pipeline. And then you have the CPSU scheme. You have the Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana.

So, if you look at the Kusum scheme itself, only about 5 lakh pumps have been installed, as against the government's target of 50 lakh pumps by FY26. And if you talk of the feeder level

I

and the grid connect, that's about 34.8 GW of installation which has to be done at the target under the component C. In the Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, that's about 25 GW to 30 GW to be done over 3 years. So, this demand is growing. I would estimate it's been 10 GW to 15 GW as of today, but it's growing.

Vipraw Srivastava: Sir, since you brought Kusum scheme, so, on those lines, so basically government has an access dashboard which you can actually track the pumps being installed. So, even the government has sanctioned a lot of tenders for these pumps, but actual installation by farmers is not happening. Farmers are not ready to spend money on this. So, how do you see this progressing? Because even the government is giving tenders and Shakti Pumps are installing those pumps, you are getting the money. But if farmers are on the ground and installing those pumps, then maybe you could face an open capital issue in future. Is that a possibility?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think the government has seen this slow progress which has been happening in the last couple of years. And they have come out with efficient mechanism, like in the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana scheme, they have come up with direct subsidy transfer to the individual or the family, which is installing the rooftop. And they have minimized documentation. You could very easily get your subsidy and very minimal documentation required. So, there are processes involved in disbursing the subsidy. Similar issue was also in the Kusum scheme, which has now been simplified, with Shakti and the government getting very proactive. So, we feel that the demand is going to grow from here.

Vipraw Srivastava: And sir, lastly, the numbers for Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, can you please repeat, what was the target in three years?

Chiranjeev Saluja: About 30 GW We are talking about 10 million households, even if you take an average of a very conservative average of everybody installing a 3-kilowatt system, that's about 30 GW.

Vipraw Srivastava: Fair enough. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bala Murali Krishna from Oman Investment Advisors. Please go ahead.

Bala Murali Krishna: Thanks for the opportunity. Could you please give a break-up of DCR and non-DCR in this current quota?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: So, could you repeat? What did you mean, break-up of?

Bala Murali Krishna: DCR revenue and non-DCR revenue.

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, we don't share revenue of DCR and non-DCR in our revenue mix. It's a total revenue mix which we share.

Bala Murali Krishna: Okay. So, we are not exporting anything to the other countries, but do you see any opportunity going forward for the exports as we heard from other competitors that export margins are a little better than the domestic margins?

Chiranjeev Saluja: We are looking at various export opportunities, but at the moment, there is such a robust demand in India that we are catering to the domestic demand because of the unprecedented volumes which are required locally. And in our investor presentation, we have also shared the revenue mix of solar cell and module. I think you can get some idea from that.

Bala Murali Krishna: Yes, sure. So, under this aluminum frame capex, we are going to purchase aluminum from the smelter and do that process here or are we running any smelting or something like that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, we will be procuring the billets and then doing the exclusion and anodizing and then refabrication.

Bala Murali Krishna: Okay. Thanks. That's all from me.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Darshil Pandya from Finterest Capital. Please go ahead.

Darshil Pandya: Thanks again for the opportunity, sir. Just one question is on the interest cost. Sir, what will be the interest cost for this financial year and what is the debt around it in t

he company?

N. K. Khandelwal: So, the interest cost for the company right now on the long-term liabilities is around 9.25% per annum. And for the short-term liabilities, working capital funds, it's in the range of about 8.5%.

And for the total long-term debts and short-term debts, as on 30th September, long-term debts are INR 863 crores, short-term debts are INR385 crores. So, 1248 crores is the total debt. Against that, we have cash in hand of about INR1,520 crores, including the IPO proceeds. The net cash on hand is about INR 223 crores against the IPO proceeds and regular cash of about INR 40 crores liquidity to INR 270 crores is the total cash.

Darshil Pandya: Okay. And this will be roughly around INR 180 crores-INR 190 crores for the full year? Sir, the full year interest cost for this financial year.

N. K. Khandelwal: Full year? Around INR 180 crores-INR 200 crores. All right.

Darshil Pandya: Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deepak Saha from KR Choksey Shares and Securities. Please go ahead.

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Deepak Saha: I just wanted to understand one thing. I missed the numbers on the industries, I mean, the customers, if you can just highlight that particular part, how much is the IPP and other players that you are supplying to? OEMs and IPPs in terms of the models that you are producing.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think I have only answered this question. You are talking about the percentage of revenue to the IPPs, right?

Deepak Saha: Right.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. 32% is our mix in H124, H125, 32% is to IPPs, 41% is to other domestic customers, and 12% is to OEM customers, 10.3% is government customers, and 3.9% is exports.

Deepak Saha: Okay. What was your order book in terms of Q1? What was your order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: You are talking about Q1 or Q2?

Deepak Saha: Q1 FY25, what was your order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, Q1, the order book was INR5,700 crores and Q2, we have already shared in the investor presentation.

Deepak Saha: I am asking in Q1, you shared the absolute number. If possible, can you share in terms of gigawatts, what was your order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think Q1 numbers were given in the RHP, the megawatt and the order book. Q2 numbers is 3860, that's 3.86 GW, INR6,233 crores.

Deepak Saha: I mean, we looked into it, so we couldn't get the Q1 numbers in terms of gigawatts in the order book. The absolute number was there, but in terms of gigawatts, that number, I couldn't find. So that is why I was asking.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Okay, then allow us to come back to you on this, please.

Deepak Saha: Fine, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ketan Deen from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Ketan Deen: Hello Sir. So, my question is, what would be the realizations on sales in Indian market? And who would be the typical customers for this?

Chiranjeev Saluja: When you talk of cells, you are talking about Indian manufactured cells, right?

Ketan Deen: Yes, Indian manufactured.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it ranges depending on the order volume between USD0.13 to USD0.15 cents per watt.

Ketan Deen: Okay. And who would be the typical customers like for the module manufacturers? Is it the B2B? Is it a B2B market only then?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so about 15%-20% of our cells are going into export, and about 30% are going to B2B for a different module manufacturer, and the rest goes into own consumption.

Ketan Deen: Okay, understood. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deval Shah from Mirae. Please go ahead.

Deval Shah: Yeah. Hi, sir. Thank you so much for the opportunity. My first question is, our 36,000 metrics and aluminum frame capacity, what kind of module requirements will this

capacity suffice?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So as of now, it will suffice our module requirement, which is close to about 3 GW -3.5 GW.

Deval Shah: Understood. And sir, my second question now is, when we say once our wafer capacity commissions, this will result in 100-120 basis by margin improvement. So, does this imply that we will be able to manufacture wafers at prices less than USD1.5 to USD0.2 cents per watt that we are currently importing?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Margin improvement was for aluminum, not for wafers.

Deval Shah: So, sir, on the wafer side, are we getting any benefits under PLI, will it result in margin improvement once the wafer capacity is commissioned? So, will our wafer proficiency cost be less than USD1.5 to USD0.2 cents per watt?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So today, as I told you, China is bleeding. It's very difficult to compare today's China price with what our margins would be when we start our wafer manufacturing. We are getting into wafer manufacturing because we want to get into backward integration, and there is a very robust demand from customers in the US for a clean solar supply chain. There are customers in the US whom we sell solar cells to who want non-Chinese wafers.

It will again be similar to the DCR, non-DCR kind of a model. When we are selling to entities in India, we did not use our own wafers. And looking at the support from the Government of India, the roadmap is clear. They are talking about ALCM now, and they want to also look at ALWM as we go forward. And talking about the PLI, we are not under PLI. We are under the MSIPS and the SIPS scheme, and the local incentives given by the Telangana government, we do not have any subsidy under PLI.

Deval Shah: Understood. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harshil Shethia from Renaissance Investments. Please go ahead.

Harshil Shethia: Sir, what I want to understand is whenever a customer orders, do they have the option to say that I want the cell from so and so player and you make the model, or they just have to get an integrated cell from you only?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It depends on the customer. If it is an IPP customer, they could actually decide on getting the solar cells and tell us to do the rest of the bomb. And if it is a DCR customer, then it could be our in-house cell and we would make the model.

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Harshil Shethia: So, can I say that 100% of our cell capacity is capitally consumed for our own modules only?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No. So, we supply solar cells to about 25 module manufacturers in India. We also export cells to the US. So, what goes into our capital consumption is around 50%. Okay.

Harshil Shethia: Understood. And only the cells which are sold outside are being specified for those INR448 crores of revenue?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes.

Harshil Shethia: Okay. Understood. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Jawar from AK Investments. Please go ahead.

Aditya Jawar: Thanks for the opportunity. This is regarding the cell market. So, in a couple of quarters, there will be large sums of modules, cell manufacturing companies going live. And how do you see the competition here? Is it easy to stabilize the line because they are coming up with, I guess, 5 GW of cell capacity?

So, how will this affect Premier Energies as a company? That is my first question. And the second question is, I see you putting a lot of capacities till FY28 and the prices might be unstable at FY28. How do you see in terms of growth and what are your revenue and margin guidance in the coming three years? These are my three questions. Thanks.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, talking about capacity which are coming into India, we have given this update even earlier that it is not easy to set up cell line. If you look at the companies which have been setting up cell line o

r announced setting up cell line, and if you look at how much time it's taking them to even commission the lines and then to stabilize these lines is not easy.

We are one of the two companies in India which have almost 14 years of experience in cell manufacturing and at scale. So, according to us, it takes time for people to set up cell manufacturing. It's a process-driven industry. It's not easy. And with the announcements being made, we see that looking at the demand, there's going to be a very clear demand and margins are going to be stable for at least 2.5-3 years.

Post that, what is going to be a differentiator between Premier and other companies is the knowledge, the operational efficiency, the kind of deep and rich experience we have. And then if you look at what Government of India is talking about, ALCM, if that comes in, which the government is quite positive about, then the entire market would need 40 GW to 50 GW of cells. So, if ALCM comes in, then we are looking at this whole story going for at least 4 to 5 years with very stable margins.

Aditya Jawar: And what about revenue and margins for the next three years? What is your target, internal target?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: So, our internal target is to be among the top one or two companies growing at the same rate and having similar margins of what the industry would be delivering. So, we would like to maintain leadership position and have similar kind of growth story the industry has.

Aditya Jawar: But I don't see you putting a lot of capacity in the modules, right? I mean, industry is going at 20 to 25 at the single player, but we are planning for 8 GW. So, there is a lot of gap there in solar module. But I know you are good at solar cell, which is commendable. But in revenue and margins, do you have any thoughts? Can you share a concrete number, if you have internal targets?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, would you pardon me, I'd like to refrain from any future guidance.

Aditya Jawar: Okay, sir. Wish you all the best. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aashish Uppanlawar from InvesQ PMS. Please go ahead.

Aashish Uppanlawar: Yeah, so I just wanted to understand the margin profile at an integrated facility. I mean, as you go backwards, how do the margins move? If you're a module manufacturer with your skill, maybe. And when you're doing cell plus module and then wafers plus cell plus module. Just for understanding, we need to know.

Chiranjeev Saluja: I think our results are up there. You know what kind of margins an integrated player is making and there are other listed players in pure play module. I'm sure you can compare what the advantage is to be an integrated player.

Aashish Uppanlawar: Okay, so would that be maybe module would be 16%, 17% EBITDA at that scale and integrated would make it say 25% plus. Is that a fair assumption?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, I think what is shown in pure play module listed players and our numbers are there. I think it's a ballpark around there.

Aashish Uppanlawar: Okay. Fine, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bhavani from Kijuna Research. Please go ahead.

Bhavani: Hello, sir. Thank you for taking my question. My question was with respect to this aluminium frame manufacturing, so will that be whole for captive consumption or also for providing to other companies?

Chiranjeev Saluja: As of now, what we are going to implement in phase 1 and phase 2 is going to be captive. We don't have plans to sell to anybody else.

Bhavani: What kind of margin improvement would it bring?

Chiranjeev Saluja: About 100 basis points to 150 basis points.
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Bhavani: 100 to 150. And then could you name any other company like any other competitor which are also into this alum

inum frame manufacturing?

Chiranjeev Saluja: There have been quite a few announcements made by module manufacturers, which is I think available in public domain.

Bhavani: Okay, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Sushrut Gokhale from Caprise Investment. Please go ahead.

Sushrut Gokhale: Sir, as you were replying to a previous participant that due to the increased volatility, we are not going into too much long-term contracts. So, this current order book of say INR6,200 crores.

So, is it safe to assume that this is executable over next 6, 8 months? Or what is our typical order execution timeline?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, this particular order of INR 6,200 crores is going to be about around 10 months to 12 months.

Sushrut Gokhale: Okay. And also, is there any seasonality like H2 strong?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, we don't have any seasonality as such.

Sushrut Gokhale: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Dipesh Sancheti from Manya Finance. Please go ahead.

Dipesh Sancheti: I just want to know how much is the capex in terms of monetary? How much capex are we doing? And how are we going to fund it?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think all the capex which we are doing apart from the one, we have announced today, it was all in the RHP. The 1 GW TOPCon cell line which is coming up in Q4 2025 is INR670 crores with 75% of net and 25 equity. The 4 plus 4 GW is INR 3,200 crores of project cost. Again about 66% debt and the rest has come from the IPO proceeds. The INR 230 aluminum will be again 75:25 equity.

Dipesh Sancheti: And now we have mentioned that we have an order book of around INR 6,000 crores. And our run rate every quarter is around INR1,500 crores. So, we have approximately a year of orders.

Is the company comfortable with this or in future are we looking at 1.5 years or 2 years of orders?

What is the comfort level for the company?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, there is also a pipeline and with the new cell line getting commissioned in March next year, we will be closing further orders in the next 3 to 4 months. Okay.

Dipesh Sancheti: And if I can squeeze in a question about the US expansion. With the change in government, I mean with Donald Trump coming into this and everybody knows how his outlook towards solar is. Do you see any potential risks or is it covered?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we really do not know. It is a wait and watch situation. There have been statements made earlier, but I think most of them were during the political rallies. And if you look at the change in statement on the EV cards, what was made earlier and what is made now, there has been a total turnaround. And if you look at the module manufacturing facilities which have come up in the US, around 30 GW of manufacturing has come up. Majority of them have come up in the red states.

So, you will see that it will be difficult for them to turn around on policies, but we just want to be making a wait and watch kind of situation. We are not really dependent on the US market in any case, but as it progresses, we will take steps.

Dipesh Sancheti: How much capex have you already done in there?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Nothing. That is what I said. It is a wait and watch. We have already signed agreements and capex has not happened. We are just looking at identifying locations for the plant.

Dipesh Sancheti: Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we will take that as our last question for today. I would now like to hand the call over to the management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you. Thank you so much. I would like to thank all the analysts and the companies which joined in and the valuable time for today's call. We look forward to having more fruitful interactions with all of you and we look forward to m

ore calls in the future.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for

joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2025

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: May 2025

Ref: PEL 21/ 2025 -26

Date: 22nd May 2025 .

To To

The Secretary The Manager,
BSE Limited Listing Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Dalal Street, Exchange Plaza, C -1, G Block, Bandra -Kurla
Mumbai - 400001 Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051
Scrip Code: 544238 Trading Symbol: PREMIERENE

Sub: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter and Year ended March 31 ,
2025.

Dear Sir/ Madam,

In accordance with Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we are enclosing herewith the transcript of the conference call discussing the financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2025. This call took place on May 19, 2025.
The above information will be made available on the website of the Company .

This is for your information and records .

Thanking you,
Yours truly,

For Premier Energies Limited

Ravella Sreenivasa Rao
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

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"Premier Energies Limited
Q4 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call"
May 19, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SINGH SALUJA – MANAGING
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. NAND KISHORE KHANDELWAL – CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. VINAY RUSTAGI – SENIOR DIRECTOR – INVESTOR
RELATIONS – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES

Premier Energies Limited
May 19, 2025

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Premier Energies Limited Q4 and FY '25

Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch-tone phone.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Shruti. Good morning. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the Q4 and FY '25 Earnings Call of Premier Energies. Today, we have with us from the management, Mr. Chiranjeev Singh Saluja, Managing Director, Mr. Nand Kishore Khandelwal, CFO, and Mr. Vinay Rustagi, Senior Director, Investor Relations. We believe we will begin with the opening remarks from management, which will be followed by Q&A. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Mohit. Am I audible?

Moderator: Yes, sir, you are audible.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Okay, thank you. Good morning, everybody. Thank you for joining us today for our financial year 2025 results call. I am joined today by my colleague, Mr. N. K. Khandelwal, Group CFO, Sudhir Reddy, Director and Chief Strategy Officer, Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer. Premier Energies has had an outstanding year with excellent revenue and earnings growth. For the whole year, the company achieved a total revenue of INR66,521 million, registering a 110% growth over the previous year. EBITDA came in at INR19,142 million, exhibiting a growth of 279%, while PAT grew by 305% to INR9,371 million.

These strong results have come because of robust demand across different segments in the domestic market, plus our strong focus on optimizing operations and building customer relationships. I'm very pleased to share with all of you about our long-term vision of maintaining a leadership position in the industry. As part of our mission 2028, we have set ourselves a target of achieving a 10 gigawatt ingot, wafer, cell, and module integrated capacity.

Apart from this, our entry into battery energy storage business and inverter businesses. Our previously announced growth projects are progressing very well. A new 1.4 gigawatt module line has become operational last week, while the 1.2 gigawatt TOPCon cell line is due for commissioning next month. Work is also progressing well on our 4.8 gigawatt TOPCon and 5.6 gigawatt module line, which is a part of the 4 plus 4 of the IPO proceeds, as well as the 2 gigawatt wafer plant.

We are also ready to move ahead with our investments into the U.S. space for a 1.2 gigawatt cell line, as and when there is more clarity on the U.S. policy. Including these ongoing expansion plans and the new initiatives announced today, as part of our mission 2028, our total estimated capex over the next three years is going to be INR125,000 million.

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We believe that mission 2028 places us in a great competitive position with investments in scale, advanced technology, backward integration, and a complimentary product portfolio with huge synergies. Overall, we see a very good demand visibility in the solar sector. There is a strong policy impotence behind the government's flagship Surya Ghar and Kusum scheme, both of which require DCR modules.

With the implementation of ALMM on cells from June '26 onwards, the market is gradually moving to a 100% DCR status. The government of India remains very supportive of domestic manufacturing, and to this end, a new national manufacturing mission has been announced in the union budget 2025. We expect specific policy support for promoting upstream manufacturing to be announced shortly.

We are con

tinuously examining the market landscape and remain open to new growth opportunities, offering scale and synergies with our existing business. Thank you. We are now open for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. The first question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. You may proceed.

Nidhi Shah: Thank you so much for taking my question. Firstly, on the 125 billion capex that has been announced over the next three years or so, I want to know what was the capex from this 125 that was already undertaken in FY25 and what will this have in 2026 and 2027? Basically, the phasing of the capex. That is my first question.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. So, I will allow Vinay to take this question.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, Nidhi. Hi. This is Vinay here. So, in terms of the capex, the 4.8 gigawatt cell line and the 5.6 gigawatt module line, the bulk of the capex will be incurred in the current financial year because we are anticipating completion by end of this financial year or early next year. For the other businesses, capex will be incurred in a scaled manner. A phased out manner because we are anticipating a phased ramp-up of the battery energy storage business as well as the inverter

business.

Nidhi Shah: Okay. So, my second question is on DCR. How much percentage of the current order book would be DCR? That is one. And secondly, how do we see DCR demand in FY26 compared to how FY25 has been? What can we expect from DCR perspective, not only because of the ALM-1 kicking in, but even otherwise the existing segment of the PM Suryagar and the Kusum schemes?

Vinay Rustagi: See, I think if you see our presentation, we have given an order book breakup between cells, modules, and the EPC business. We are not able to unfortunately break down that number in more detail in terms of DCR versus non-DCR.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And the question was on demand for DCR.

Vinay Rustagi: So, in terms of demand for DCR, the demand envelope remains very, very strong. Like we said in the presentation, there are three components to demand right now, namely the Surya Ghar Premier Energies Limited

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Yojana the Kusum scheme, and the CPSU scheme. Between these three schemes, the total demand as per the government targets is about 65 gigawatts over the next two years. Even if we take a slightly realistic and more conservative number, there is likely to be very strong demand over the next two years.

And then, of course, with ALM cells being implemented from June 2026 onwards, there will be more market segments, namely the corporate segment, as well as the IPP segment opening up in the next two years.

Nidhi Shah: So, just to follow up on what you mentioned, that you are expecting demand from these three different schemes in DCR. Have you seen anything coming up in the first one-and-a-half month of this year? Has there been more inquiry on this? And secondly, you mentioned again the ALM-1 kicking in. Have the notifications come out? Have we got any orders pertaining to that? Do we expect this to kick in in June, or could there be any delays?

Vinay Rustagi: So, I think taking the first question first, yes, of course, we are seeing more and more customer inquiries for both the schemes, particularly Surya Ghar Yojana and the Kusum scheme. In terms of the government policy, so I think that is a hypothetical question in our view. As I said, the annual demand expectation is about 30-odd gigawatts from the government policy perspective. Already the domestic cell capacity is about 25 gigawatts. More capacity is coming online as we speak, and we expect there to be enough capacity by the middle of next year for it to be able to cater to domestic demand. So, as such, plus given the government support for the sector, we don't see any possibility of any LMM relaxation for cells.

Nidhi Shah: Alright. Thank you so much. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line o

f Deepak Krishnan from Kotak Institutional Equities. You may proceed.

Deepak Krishnan: So I just wanted to first check on this Ingot vehicle. Are we going to await any policy support to do this? Because some of the peers have PLI and we don't currently. So are we going to get some local spec schemes for that? And secondly, on the BSS 12 gigawatt capacity, what are you going to do in terms of how much is the capex, what level of backward integration? So maybe this is the first question, and then I'll come back for a couple more.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. So for ingot wafer, Deepak, we've already announced our timelines for setting up the 2 gigawatt wafer facility, which is in a JV with SAS of Taiwan. This is planned for commissioning in FY27. And we are seeing a very strong demand for non-Chinese wafers in Ingot. And to answer your question on specs, yes, we are working with the government for subsidies through specs apart from state government subsidies. We will be evaluating our capex deployment plans on expansion.

The target is to achieve 10 gigawatt. We are starting with a 2 gigawatt wafer. And as and when we see plans getting formed, we will update the market on that. And your next question was on battery, right? On BESS, we are getting into to start with a cell-to-pack manufacturing line along with EPC offerings to our IPP customers. And we will be doing this in two phases. The first

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phase would come up in FY27, and the second in FY28. Each is going to be a 6 gigawatt hour capacity. And that's the plan on the BESS investments.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, sir. Maybe just on the commissioning of your module and cell line, I think, given that cell is about a quarter of the 1 gigawatt than what we had initially thought through, and we've had a change of location for the 4 gigawatt, how confident are you of achieving the 6.4 capacity by

2026? Is there Would stabilization be post that or are you implying COD plus stabilization by June '26?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So for the 1.4 gigawatt module, it's already commissioned as we announced in the opening remarks. And the 1.2 gigawatt TOPCon cell line is getting commissioned next month, which is well in time compared to the data which we had shared in the last quarterly results. We had said it would be commissioned by June 26, and it is on track.

On the 4 plus 4, which has now become 4.8 and 5.6, that's enhanced capacity. This is also well on track. Changing location has actually given an advantage rather than a disadvantage, because the new location is far more better a site in terms of the land development work to be done, and also the connectivity to the substation is far better compared to the earlier site.

So we are on track, and we don't anticipate any delays in those projects in terms of commissioning. In fact, we are trying to get the enhanced capacity commissioned by then.

Instead of 4, we would maybe achieve 4.8, and instead of 5, we'll achieve 5.6, well within the stipulated timelines.

Deepak Krishnan: So maybe just a thought process. Essentially, no policy support today in terms of ingots, wafers, or BESA. Would we sort of awaiting anything on that front, or will we go ahead and commission irrespective of any government-equivalent policy coming for domestic sourcing at that particular point of time?

Vinay Rustagi: So like we said in the opening remarks, there is a new manufacturing mission, a national manufacturing mission has been announced by the government. We have been in consultations with MNRE already over the policy support needed for the upstream manufacturing space, and the government is worrying mulling a set of incentives. It could be a mix of financial incentives, duties, and other elements such like measures, which will be announced in due course. So we are in consultations with the government and expecting a package to be announced over the next year.

Deepa

k Krishnan: And all our expansion is on, essentially the sale is with TOPCon today, right? And if any change in technology, that we look at it in the future, are we adding anything else in some of the newer capabilities as well?

Vinay Rustagi: No, that's correct. The current lines are all being set up using TOPCon technology. We are, having said that, we are in parallel doing a lot of work behind the scenes on new technologies.

You may have seen, last month we signed an MOU with a German company. We are also studying new technologies, whether it is BackContact or SkyTandem, etc. So we will be anticipating these developments and be ready to commercialize and set up lines as and when there is a commercial viability.

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Deepak Krishnan: Sure. I think there's maybe one final question from my end. Just the slight different revenue that we've seen this quarter versus the previous quarter with similar level of utilizations. Our understanding is it's because of higher DCR mix versus the previous quarter. Is that sort of a fair understanding?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Deepak, this is, I won't read too much into the small dip that we have seen. That can be caused by a number of different factors. One of those being the change in the product mix, as you said. But also, given that it is year-end, some clients are hesitant to take deliveries so I think some shipments have been delayed simply because of that. So I think there are a number of factors. But overall, I would say, in terms of utilization of the line and the product mix, there is no major change.

Deepak Krishnan: And any FY '26 guidance that we have in mind or no public guidance at this point?

Vinay Rustagi: No, no. I mean, look, I think you know what is the planned delivery of all the new expansion capacities. So, you know what is that order book also. So I think that should be able to give you enough guidance in terms of numbers. But as such, as a company, we are not giving any specific guidance.

Deepak Krishnan: Perfect. Those are my questions. Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Bala Murli from Oman Investments. You may proceed.

Bala Murli: We have a big capex plan of 12,500. What could be the asset turn in our business?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sorry, could you repeat that? We couldn't hear the second half of your question.

Bala Murli: Yes, what could be the asset turn for the capex we're going to incur? Approximate asset turn, how much we can expect in terms of asset turn?

Vinay Rustagi: Bala, hi. This is Vinay here. So overall, of course, this depends on how the pricing and the demand envelope shapes up over the next 3 years. But we are expecting, based on all this capex, fixed asset turnover of about between 2.2x to 2.5x by the end of this implementation program.

Bala Murli: So further, by enhancing our sales capacity to 6.4 gigawatts in the next fiscal year, so how much it could contribute to margins? Is there any significant, can I expect any significant move in the

margins? That would...

Chiranjeev Saluja: The line is not clear, Bala. Could you be a little closer to the phone? We are not able to hear you clearly.

Bala Murli: Yes, I'm asking about the sell line after we commission the 6.4 gigawatt in the upcoming year.

So how it is going to impact the margins? So can we expect any significant movement in the margins or it would be a similar line as of now?

Vinay Rustagi: So Bala, I think it is very difficult to predict how the margins are going to play out. It is a very fast-moving industry with a lot of variables out there. Insofar as we have the visibility and the

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order book, which is already committed for the next year, we should be able to, by and large, maintain our margins. But, we are not able to give any guidance as such.

Bala Murli: Okay. And lastly, on the execution side, mostly we are

focused on the domestic side only. So

we are not exporting much to any other country. So how do the margins compare to domestic and exports? And do we have any plans in this year or coming year to increase the export content?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So I think in terms of the export markets, I think, the US is the main export opportunity for India right now. Although we do hope that Europe and some other countries will open up in the future. In the US itself, there is a little bit of a short-term uncertainty given the recent tariff moves by the US Government.

We do expect more clarity to come up as the trade treaty with the US is signed up over the next few months. The US is a market which remains of great interest to us. We have already, as you know, previously announced a 1.2 gigawatt cell venture there and are looking at other business opportunities. So as and when there is more clarity, we will move into those projects and capitalizing on those opportunities.

Bala Murli: Okay. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So as of today, at least over the foreseeable period, most of our revenue and profit is expected to come from the Indian market.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from SUD Life. You may proceed.

Anupam Goswami: Sir, my first question on the, if you can give some light on the price realization that is going on currently and what sort of spread are we making in the different categories? And over the long term, sir, where do we see the capacity of cell coming and how do we see the price movement in the next 3 to 4 years?

Vinay Rustagi: Sure. So in terms of the current pricing, I think this is publicly available information. The DCR modules, the general pricing is around \$0.24 to \$0.25. Non-DCR modules are at about \$0.17. For sales, again, there's a little bit of a variation depending on whether sales are being sold in the Indian market or exports. In the Indian market, prices tend to be around \$0.14 to \$0.15. Export market prices are a little lower.

In terms of future trend, I think it is very difficult to say how these prices will evolve. But insofar as our order book is concerned, this is more or less in line with the prices that I've indicated to you.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And just to add to on future with cell capacities coming in, we feel that we are very well positioned on the three pillars which are required for this business. One is scale, one is the technology, and the third is vertical integration. We don't see any foreseeable risk in the coming 2 to 3 years in terms of additional capacities coming in because we feel that these three pillars

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are very important in terms of success in this business and Premier is very well positioned on all these three pillars.

And the demand also is growing. We don't see any major kind of margin erosion coming in because of capacity because several of the announcements which have been made we feel only about 50% of those would actually come up.

Anupam Goswami: Okay, sir. Thank you, sir. I'll turn back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikhil Nigania from Bernstein. You may proceed.

Nikhil Nigania: I just have a follow-up on the US market. While I understand the focus on the domestic market given the strong realisation and margins here itself, I just want to understand if the proposed anti-dumping duties they have on South-East Asian players goes through Vietnam, Malaysia,

etc.

Do you think that could open up a big front for Premier as well as a couple of your competitors have been targeting that space and any particular reason why we have not been that exposed to the US market as some of our peers have been?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, you are right that the CMTB duties have opened up a big market for Indian players. But as we said earlier, we are committed more to first cater to the domestic dem

and. We have always

been giving priority to the Indian market not now, but from the last 2 years since we started making sales.

As far as the US market, some of our peers are exporting modules. We as a company had a very clear strategy that we would like to restrict ourselves to exporting sales to the US because we do not want to compete with our clients in the US. Our strategy was clear that it is not easy to make sales and not easy to make good quality high efficiency sales.

We at Premier have achieved this and have been consistently exporting sales to US module manufacturers and we feel that it has played out well for us because now in the US market there is almost about close to 30 gigawatt of operational module capacity but very little cell capacity which means that the demand for cells from the US is huge but we would look at increasing exports to US only when we have our new capacities coming in that is starting June 26.

For now our focus commitment is towards the Indian market and Government of India has really supported the manufacturing and we don't want to we want to ensure that supplies to the Indian programs are consistent.

Vinay Rustagi: Just to add Nikhil, I think first of all we remain completely open to we are actively tracking the US market and we remain open to any such opportunity but the fact is that beyond CMTB there are other countries which are exporting cells to the US as I said also earlier the prices that we realize in the US are lower than in the domestic market so the domestic market there is a very strong demand plus pricing environment.

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And from a company point of view that is something which is more conducive to us more attractive for our business. So, we are deliberately keeping more of a focus on the domestic market, but as and when the market evolves and the US market grows and the pricing is more attractive, we will be ready to effectively tap into that market and supply more volume there.

Nikhil Nigania: My second and last question was on the new opportunities being targeted, especially BSS. It's a thought process where that what we have seen happen in solar PV industry with government restricting imports into the country. There is a similar expectation we have playing out in BSS as well. And that's a thought process to be an early mover in that space?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, sure, Nikhil. So you're right. Think that a pretty logical assumption. The government is very committed to making India. There is a huge amount of investment which is going to go into the storage space. And inevitably, there would be more indigenization in that space as well.

So our thought process in terms of the best market is that we are initially going to focus on cell to pack container solutions and the EPC business. Really just to understand the client needs, the technology, the value chain, etc. And it is not, this part of the business is not particularly capital intensive.

As in when there is a more conducive policy framework that emerges and we feel enough confidence in terms of going further back upstream, sorry, we will examine a further foray into the segment action business.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Mayur Patel from 360 ONE assets.

Mayur Patel: Hi, Stellar Performance, Chiranjeev and the team. Thanks for the opportunity. Just want to ask INR3,100 crores of new bookings. So is it fair to assume that some part of that would be also related to the greenfield which is coming in 2026, the sale and the model?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so you're talking about ALMM List-II, right? The sale one which is going to come up.

Mayur Patel: Yes, your greenfield project Chiranjeev? Earlier you were trying to...

Chiranjeev Saluja: So yes, the project which is -- the Greenfield project which is coming up, there's a very, very small amount which would spill over into that project. As of now,

most of these have timelines

of around, I would say, 12 to 14 months. So what we show in our order book, Mayur, is signed, advances received and confirmed order book. This doesn't include our pipeline.

Our pipeline would be almost similar or a little higher than the 5 gigawatt of order book which we have. So there is a lot of pipeline which is under discussion. As and when we get finalized, we add them in the order book. And not a significant portion of this order book is from the greenfield project.

Mayur Patel: Got it. So say next 3 to 6 months, we should expect the pipeline getting converted into bookings

related to the greenfield which is going to come in '26 right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, correct.

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Mayur Patel: Perfect. I will join the queue for more questions and all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sanjay Mookim from JPMorgan. You may proceed.

Sanjay Mookim: Hi. Good morning, everybody. Couple of questions on your utilizations, the cell utilization has remained relatively stagnant at about 74%, 75% for 2 quarters. Is this what we should assume continues in the future or do you expect the utilization to go up again?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sanjay, I think you are talking about the module...

Sanjay Mookim: The module, I beg your pardon. I beg the -- module, that's right.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So let me answer this question to you Sanjay. Unlike the cell business, the module business has different customers buying you know different category of products from us. Some buy Mono PERC, some are moved into TOPCon. In TOPCon, there is M10, M10 Plus size. Then there's also a G12R. So unlike a cell line that you're producing one product category 24 hours, 365 days, in a module line, you would actually require several changeovers depending on customer requirements.

So for cell manufacturing, we see that the peak could be around 80%-85%. It is at 75% now.

But we don't expect cell line to go to 95% as, sorry, module to go to 95% like cell.

Sanjay Mookim: Right. Thanks for that Chiranjeev. The second question is, let's say when we say that the utilization of the cell line was 95% for the quarter, is it fair to assume that if I take your capacity of 2 gigawatts multiplied by 95, that gives me an estimate of how many cells?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, no. So this is 95% of effective capacity. Again, in a cell line, you've got various formats of wafers which you can process. What we are making today is an M10 Plus wafer. 2 gigawatt would be based on G12 wafer, which is still not under the production and is not being used in India. So this is not 95% of 2 gigawatt. It would be 95 % of around 1.8 gigawatt, 1.8, 1.8 5 gigawatt.

Sanjay Mookim: Great. So it will be great if we can get some sense of quarterly production of both cells and modules, right? Because it will help track pricing and margins better for us. So perhaps if you could talk about how many cells and modules produced or sold this quarter, that would be great.

Chiranjeev Saluja: I think we have not been sharing this data in the past two and we don't intend to, Sanjay, because of confidentiality reasons. We will just be able to give what we are giving as of now every quarter. We would not be very comfortable to share further details.

Sanjay Mookim: Okay, okay. Thanks. Those were my questions. Thanks, Chiranjeev.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes.

Vinay Rustagi: Sanjay, can you hear me?

Sanjay Mookim: Yes. Hi, Vinay.

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Vinay Rustagi: Hi. I was just going to say that, you know, we have given an indication of what the delta between effective capacity and limited capacity is. We've given you the capacity based on effective capacity, so I think -- but actually not very difficult to get, of course

Sanjay Mookim: Of course, of course. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank

you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Hemaant, an individual investor. You may proceed.

Hemaant: Congratulations on a stellar set of numbers, and thank you for providing us the opportunity.

Pardon me, actually. I'm new to the company. I just wanted to clear few things. So first of all is our initial capacity of cell was 2 gigawatt, and module was for 4.1 gigawatt. And the plan was to take the cell capacity to 7 gigawatt and module to, I guess, 9 gigawatt, right? Out of the 9 gigawatt module capacity, we have implemented 1.1 gigawatt, right? 1.4. 1.4. So I had a look at the investor presentation uploaded, I think, yesterday. So that 7 gigawatt cell capacity is still intact, plus 0.8 gigawatt will be, we will be adding over and above it?

Vinay Rustagi: That's correct, yes.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And then some more also to achieve 10. So we have put a mission 2028, which talks about 10 gigawatt in-board wafer cell and module, which is being announced in the results and the presentation on Saturday. So the 1.4 is already commissioned in terms of module cell, we were at 2. Another 1.2 is getting added next month and then 4.8 getting added instead of 4 which was

announced earlier. But the overall target is to achieve 10.

Hemaant: 10 gigawatt of cell and 10 gigawatt of module, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: That's right.

Hemaant: So, sir, you are saying that 1.4 gigawatt of module has already been added and 1.1 will be added in the next month, right, of cell?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, 1.2.

Hemaant: 1.2 will be added. So what will be the capacity by FY '27 then because the numbers changed, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So 2 is what is operational, 1.2 is getting added which takes you to 3.2. Next month, FY '27, we are adding 4.8, which will take you to 8 gigawatts in terms of cell capacity in FY '27.

And then we have announced another 2 gigawatt, another 1.6 to 2 gigawatt are getting added in FY '28. If look at the presentation page number,

Vinay Rustagi: 18.

Chiranjeev Saluja: 18. We have given a very clear roadmap on capacity expansion plans with the dates.

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Hemaant: Okay. And sir, what will be the module capacity, sir by FY '27? It will be now I guess 11 gigawatts?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. It will be 11.1. It will be slightly higher than the 10 which we have a target where it is going to be 11.1.

Hemaant: And sir, I wanted to ask you.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Yes.

Hemaant: Sir, I wanted to ask you one more thing, like sir, what is the tenure of the current order book on a blended basis -- on a blended basis. And sir, what is the -- I mean order in terms of megawatt which we have executed in the current fiscal year?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So the blended basis, the order book is for about 12 to 15 months and if you look at the order book it is about 5.3 odd gigawatt, which is the order book which is shown on slide number 23.

Hemaant: And sir, what is the order book in terms of megawatt which we have executed in the FY '25?

Vinay Rustagi: You know, that number we are not able to give you as we said earlier because we don't release the actual production numbers or the sales numbers in terms of megawatts.

Hemaant: Actually just wanted to have an idea regarding this.

Moderator: Hello, sorry to interrupt sir. We request you to join the queue as we have other participants as well.

Hemaant: Okay, okay.

Moderator: Thank you, sir.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you, Hemaant.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Dhruv Muchhal from HDFC AMC. You may proceed

Dhruv Muchhal: Yes. Thank you so much, sir. So just some you know understanding on your capex number, INR12,500 crores. So if I use some industry benchmarks on capex and your ongoing and future expansion plans for cell and module, is it right to understand almost 50% of your total capex plan is X of cells and modules? I mean probably it is going into wafers and wafer

, ingot and the

batteries and others.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi, Drew. So you're right. I mean, in terms of ingot and wafer, the expected capex on a per gigawatt basis is about INR400 crores. So for 10 gigawatt, that would be about INR4,000 crores.

And then there will be some capex, obviously, on BESS, as well as the inverter businesses. In

total, the BESS capex is about INR600 crores for this capacity. And for inverters, the cap is would be about INR100 to INR150 crores.

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Dhruv Muchhal: This is helpful. And the second question was on the wafer expansion that we are, the 2 gigawatt wafer expansion that's progressing. Some understanding on the status of land. I'm not sure if this requires an EC, so EC approval, equipment ordering, and some other, the other status please.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so the plan is to commission the 2 gigawatt in FY '27. We have already acquired the land and it's well aligned with what we have targeted to commission this line. This is with the

Taiwanese company SAS, which is a JV. And it's a 2 gigawatt line.

Dhruv Muchhal: So the equipment ordering and everything is all done. And would it require an environment clearance approval? I'm not sure if that is a...

Chiranjeev Saluja: it would require from the state. Its in process and it will be well on time. It'll be obtained well

on time.

Dhruv Muchhal: And so earlier, so I'm still trying to understand. What we used to understand was there is a specific size for any polysilicon on a wafer plant. Some industry, you know, some reading suggested it's about 5 or 10 gigawatts. So does 2 gigawatt, I mean, I am just trying to understand you are going ahead with a 2 gigawatt plan, so...

Chiranjeev Saluja: The target and the mission '28 talks of 10 gigawatt

Dhruv Muchhal: Okay.

Chiranjeev Saluja: 2 gigawatt is,...

Dhruv Muchhal: Okay. So the specific size can be lower and it does not impact the economics of the project.

Chiranjeev Saluja: The land has been acquired for entire 10 gigawatt.

Dhruv Muchhal: Okay.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So to answer your question, time size can be lower, but it is the procurement efficiency, the et cetera, which do make the operations optimal and which we will achieve over a period of 3 years.

Dhruv Muchhal: Okay. All right. And the last 2 questions is just a small point on the CWIP in your balance sheet, it's about INR240 odd crores, if I see the numbers. I am just wondering your cell line is yet to commission, I think about 1.4 gigawatt and the module line I am not sure if it commissioned I mean before the March quarter end or not. So the CWIP number seems low. So have you already capitalized a portion of the capex for the cell line or since the payments are pending and hence it will all come up next year?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No. So we have not capitalized on the cell. The module line was also not commissioned before March, it was commissioned on the 16th of May and we have not capitalized.

Dhruv Muchhal: In that context the CWIP number seems low, so it is just because the cash spending is coming in the next year and hence everything or I'm just trying to understand has the capex amount come down significantly for the projects.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: So Yes, there are payments due to vendors and that's why everything is not being capitalized, the number is lower in CWIP.

Dhruv Muchhal: It's not showing any. Got it. And so last question on the US market outlook, so what we understand is the duties in some of the Southeast Asian region countries where US was importing a large quantum are already in place and provisional duties are already there, some final announcements are pending and China is already there and India is positioning relative to some of the other regions seems very strong.

I'm just -- and as you mentioned 30 gigawatt of modules is there in US, so I'm just wonderin

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aren't you seeing a lot of inquiries from the US companies to source sales and I'm not sure if pricing can be better in the US market now given the shortages that we are facing -- they likely to face. So what am I missing here, I mean, just trying to understand, I understand the focus on India, but at least from an inquiry level are seeing feelers of the market.

Vinay Rustagi: So Dhruv, you're right. I think all the factors you already mentioned, I think what is missing is a long-term predictability of the tariff regime, right? So I think the problem is that these changes have been coming so thick and fast that everybody is kind of really sitting back a little bit and just trying to make sure they understand the market landscape. Of course, there is also a trade treaty with the US in under negotiation. So I think both from the customer side in the US, as well as the supplier side for us, I think it is better to wait a little bit before we fully understand the market landscape and start discussing order book. So that is the kind of little hold up right now.

Dhruv Muchhal: Okay. So it's a wait and watch situation with the customer and with you.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Akash Mehta from Canada HSBC Life. You may proceed.

Akash Mehta: Hi. Sir, my first question is on leverage, I mean, what kind of debt to equity or debt to EBITDA and debt to EBITDA we are kind of targeting with the ongoing capex by maybe fiscal '27 or '28.

So Yes, that's my first question.

Vinay Rustagi: Sure, Akash. So based on the modelling that we have done internally, first of all, we expect to be able to fund all the capex using internal accruals and cash on board. Our expectation is that the total leverage will peak out at about 1.4 to 1.5 times in terms of debt to equity and about two times in terms of debt to EBITDA. So both of which we feel are fairly conservative numbers and easily manageable in the context of the larger industry parameters.

Akash Mehta: Okay, that's helpful. And my second question is in terms of the uptrend investments that we making or backward integration, what kind of sustainable margins we kind of expect. I mean, earlier the expectations were low, but I think we might end up getting slightly better realizations

or some cost savings as well because of our investments. So I mean, maybe by fiscal '28, '29 what kind of sustainable margins that we can look at for Premier, I mean going ahead?
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Vinay Rustagi: Yes, Akash. So I think that is a very interesting question and I think we would love to know the answer to be honest ourselves. But we don't, you know, like I said earlier there are so many changes in the industry, it's very, very dynamic. So it is impossible to kind of predict what kind -- how the margins will evolve.

Our expectation is that in the selling module business we would be able to by and large sustain our margins over the next three years. Even for all the modeling and the market assessment that we have done for the PES and the inverter business, that is also very attractive in terms of EBITDA margins as well as return on capital employed.

I think for the upstream business the ingot wafer business much of it depends on how the policy framework shapes up. So I think it is impossible to give you any kind of guidance or expectation on that number.

Akash Mehta: So I mean since this would be like an integrated thing. So, I mean, we could expect a decent margin expansion at least from what we are right on the cell and module front?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so I think again that would be the logical assumption, but as I said there are so many other moving parts to this, in terms of demand supply envelope, technology outlook, customer expectations etcetera. So it's not just one factor, there are so many other variables which will affect the margin and hence it is difficult

to take any reasonable guess at it.

Akash Mehta: Okay. That's it from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sarang Joglekar from Vimana Capital. You may proceed.

Sarang Joglekar: Yes. Thank you for the opportunity. This is regarding the 14th slide in the investor's presentation about the demand for DCR modules. We have stated that for the next two years there is going to be significant demand 27 from PM Surya Ghar and 30 from KUSUM. I believe that was the total demand over three years and lot of it was installed last year also. So do you still think that another 50 gigawatt of DCR will be there over next two years?

Vinay Rustagi: Sorry I did not get your name, but I think the numbers that we have given are based on the government schemes and their targets. So looking at each of them one by one in the Surya Ghar Yojana there is a target of 1 crores installations out of which only 10 lakh odd have been done till date. So 90% of the demand is still yet to come.

Similarly, in the KUSUM program if you look at the actual execution on the ground out of the 35 gigawatts of target installations are only currently about 4 to 5 gigawatts. So there is lot of projects have been bid and allocated post auctions. There is a lot of capacity under execution. So 30 gigawatts of actual module demand is yet to come to the market.

Similarly likewise for the 5 gigawatts CPSU scheme, now these are government numbers and we are not saying that this will be the actual capacity execution. That will of course depend on a few factors, but even if you take slight moderation in these numbers in terms of realistic on the ground development there is a very robust demand environment.

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I was just saying these are only in terms of ALMM cells being applicable right now, but that will also become applicable to the corporate market from next year wherein we expect demand to start materializing from Q1 of the next financial year and even taking into account the delays in the utility scale market. We do expect that market also to start becoming 100% DCR market from 2027 onwards. So as we go forward the DCR demand is likely to keep on increasing over time.

Sarang Joglekar: Also there was some problem around delay in signing the PPAs, do you see that affecting the solar demand?

Vinay Rustagi: Look to be honest I think that is a big red herring in the sector, it is causing a lot of confusion unfortunately, but if you look at the reality the government has auctioned about 90 gigawatts of projects in the last two financial years. That is basically all solar, wind and hybrid projects. The actual number that will translate into demand is expected to be much higher because many of these projects the hybrid projects are typically oversized 1.5 to 2.5 times.

Now even if 40 gigawatts of PPAs has not been signed as per the news headlines. I'm looking at it as a positive in the sense that 50 gigawatts of PPAs have been signed, which itself would translate easily into solar demand of about 50 gigawatts to 55 gigawatts over the next three years

in addition to all the demand which is there from the projects which have been auctioned in the past.

And like you see on the Slide number 14, we have said that the utility scale solar demand will be 20 gigawatts plus per annum. So I think if you see what is in the pipeline by way of projects being auctioned and the PPAs being signed that provides us with a very healthy demand outlook for the market.

Sarang Joglekar: Got it. Thank you. That's it from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Kartik Sharma from Anand Rathi. You may proceed.

Kartik Sharma: Congratulations on a great set of numbers and thank you for taking my question. You gave you gave a break up to the previous gentleman about the capex that you have bets of INR600 crores inverters of I

NR150 crores. Just in a similar way if you could give us a timeline break up of that capex that would be very helpful, that is my first question.

My second question is how much of your cells are captive as of now and what kind of realization do you see for modules and for cells and how it will be going forward?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So on the capex plan we have already given you data in terms of the investments which you are making in the battery and inverter business. We have also given details as to when what capacity is coming up. So I think the numbers are quite clear and in terms of captive consumption around 50% of the cells what we produce goes into captive consumption for DCR modules.

And I think Vinay also shared the market prices for all these products DCR, non-DCR and the cell realization.

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Vinay Rustagi: But also just to add to that the share of captive consumption for cells will go up over a period of time over the next two years because like I said by 2027 the entire market is expected to be almost I would say 100% DCR. So we will go from 50% captive consumption 100% over these two years.

Kartik Sharma: Okay. Thank you so much. Just one follow up question like how you said that from your effective capacity that is of 2 gigawatts of cell, you take 95% of the 1.8 gigawatts and not the 2 gigawatts so how is that for the module?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So for the module it is about 75% what we are as on today and we have said that the peak we could achieve is around 80, 85 and that is also the similar thing if you produce a G12 cell module that is the installed capacity and if you are producing an M10 or M10 plus which is a slightly smaller size of wafer then the effective capacity comes down.

And then we talk of you know utilization we always talk of what we have achieved on the effective capacity and not on the name plate.

Kartik Sharma: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mohnish Dudhwala from Axia Asset Management. You may proceed.

Mohnish Dudhwala: Yes. So just wanted to understand regarding our realization. So our order book which is of 5.3 gigawatts and in value terms it is around INR8,445 crores, so which makes our realization of around INR15.9 per watt and as you said that current DCR realizations prevailing in the market are 24 cents per watt, which are around INR21 per watt. So can you help me understand difference regarding the gap between the two?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So if you see there is a 27% split in the order book for cells and cells is much lower. So what you are calculating is the average price. We have not given a break up of you know the DCR, non DCR and the cell capacity is already being shown on the screen.

Vinay Rustagi: So I think the difference is that you are working with a weighted average price, but of course in terms of the order book there is a difference between cells, DCR and non DCR module and with the prices that we have already given to you. So that explains the difference between the average prices and the individual product prices.

Mohnish Dudhwala: Sure understood. So out of this 5.3 gigawatt it is split between modules as well as cells and similar with the value that is why the difference?

Chiranjeev Saluja: And the module includes DCR and non DCR both.

Mohnish Dudhwala: Majority of our module will be DCR?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Not necessary and we would like to project it the way it is, we do not want to give a break up there.

Mohnish Dudhwala: Okay, sure. That is all from my side. Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mayank Bhandari from Asian Market. You may proceed.

Mayank Bhandari: Just on the growth guidance, what kind of guidance you would like to give for FY26 and 27 based on the capacity expansion we are doing?

Vinay Rustagi

i: Yes. Hi Mayank. So we do not give out any specific numbers in terms of guidance, but I think a very strong indication is available in the form of order book which is all due for execution over the next 12 to 14 months and we have already talked about our capacity envelope over the next year, the current prices and the order book. So that should give you a reasonable visibility into the revenues as well as the profit numbers for the next year.

Mayank Bhandari: And in terms of margin if we are looking forward to so much of backward integration, any long term margin expectation next 3 years, 4 years?

Vinay Rustagi: We already covered this question a few times. I think it is very difficult to predict how the margins will play out over the next three years to four years because there are so many changes in the market all the time. I think the key question is what is the competitive position in the sector and because of the huge strength we have built into the business over the last few years and continuing investments in new capacities, backward integration, technology upgradation etcetera.

I think the focus for us is to protect the competitive position and be close to the market, anticipate the market needs and being able to respond to that and we believe that will provide us with a very strong position in terms of revenues as well as profit margins etcetera and that is where the focus is.

Mayank Bhandari: And just lastly if you could just give a proportion of FY27 revenue that probably in terms of cell module and wafer just a guesstimate would work the composition of the revenue?

Vinay Rustagi: No I think I would love to give you that number, but unfortunately we can't. FY27 is still more than is about a year away. So in terms of most of the orders are yet to be booked, but again you have a clear visibility in terms of how our capacity envelope is going to shape up because of all these projects we are working on. So we would expect revenues and profit numbers to move accordingly.

Mayank Bhandari: Okay, sir. Thank you. That's it from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. Due to time constraints that was the last question. I now hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments. Thank you and over to you sir.

Vinay Rustagi: So thank you very much. It's been a fantastic year of performance for the company. I think our focus as we go forward is one on executing all the projects on time and on budget. We are very focused also on making sure that we are maintaining a leadership position in the industry and continually examining new opportunities.

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So that is where the focus is and we would expect to stay as one of the preferred suppliers to capitalize on the emerging opportunities and the growing demand in the sector. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your line.

Call: Jul 2025

Ref: PEL 40/2025-26
Date: 30th July, 2025.

To To
The Secretary The Manager,
BSE Limited Listing Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Dalal Street, Exchange Plaza, C-1, G Block, Bandra-Kurla
Mumbai - 400001 Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051
Scrip Code: 544238 Trading Symbol: PREMIERENE

Sub: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter ended on June 30, 2025.

Dear Sir/ Madam,

In accordance with Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we are enclosing herewith the transcript of the conference call discussing the financial results for the quarter ended on June 30, 2025. This call took place at 11:00 hours IST on Monday, 28th July 2025. The above information will be made available on the website of the Company.

This is for your information and records.

Thanking you,
Yours truly,

For Premier Energies Limited

Ravella Sreenivasa Rao
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

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“Premier Energies Limited
Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call ”
July 28, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SINGH SALUJA – MANAGING
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. NAND KISHORE KHANDELWAL – CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. VINAY RUSTAGI – CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Premier Energies Limited Q1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities Ltd. Please go ahead, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Good morning. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the Q1 FY26 Earnings Call of Premier Energies. Today, we have with us from the management, Mr. Chiranjeev Singh Saluja, Managing Director, Mr. Nand Kishore Khandelwal, Chief Financial Officer, and Mr. Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer.

We'll begin with the opening remarks from the management, which will be followed by Q&A.

Thank you and over to you, sir.

Management: Thank you, Mohit. So, good morning, everyone, and thank you for joining us today for our Q1 FY26 Earnings Call. Pleased to report a strong start to the financial year with our best-ever performance in terms of revenue and profit in the long history of the company.

In Q1, our total revenue stood at INR18,695 million, marking a 12% year-on-year growth. More importantly, we delivered a robust profitability with EBITDA at INR5,971 million, up 61% year-on-year, and a profit after tax at INR3,078 million, a 55% increase over the same quarter last year. What makes this performance even more noteworthy is that it comes despite planned annual maintenance on our cell lines during this quarter.

Thanks to strong execution on the ground, we were able to maintain high uptime and strong production volumes across the board. A key milestone this quarter was the successful commissioning of our 1.4 gigawatt module line and time-bound commissioning of our 1.2 gigawatt TOPCon cell manufacturing line.

This marks a significant step forward in our growth journey and sets the stage for our next phase of expansion. We remain firmly on track to deliver on our mission 2028, our ambitious roadmap to build an integrated 10 gigawatt in-board to module manufacturing ecosystem, 12 gigawatt of battery energy storage systems, 3 gigawatt of inverter capacity by the end of FY28.

I'm happy to report that all projects are progressing well, both on timelines and within budget, reflecting our disciplined execution and long-term vision. The macro environment continues to be highly supportive. We are seeing strong and broad-based demand across all our focus segments. The solar industry is witnessing record capacity additions, and we expect this momentum to continue.

On battery energy storage system, it's poised to take off in a big way with about 19 gigawatt hours of capacity already awarded and more activity expected through hybrid and FDRE tenders. Meanwhile, the residential rooftop solar is gaining strong traction. Driven by initiatives like the Premier Energies Limited

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Prime Minister's Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, we believe that this will be a long-term structural trend.

On the policy front, we are encouraged by the government's sustained push for domestic manufacturing, and we expect further initiatives to promote upstream capacity and advanced future-based technology development. Given this strong demand and outlook, we have accelerated our plans for both BESS and inverter manufacturing.

We aim to have both verticals begin contributing to our top line from the beginning of FY27.

Regarding our proposed cell manufacturing plant in the U.S., we have decided to continue keeping those plans on hold for now, pending greater clarity

on the U.S. policy and tariffs. That

said, it's important to note that our business model is deeply anchored in the Indian market. Less than 1% of our total order book currently comes from the United States.

Looking ahead, we continue to evaluate new opportunities that align with our core strengths and offer scale and strategic fit. We remain agile and open to meaningful growth avenues that can complement and enhance our platform.

As we approach our first anniversary as a listed company, I want to thank all our investors and stakeholders for your trust and support. We remain committed to building long-term value and delivering sustainable, profitable growth. FY27 will be a pivotal year for Premier Energies.

We'll be more than doubling our cell and module capacities and unlocking new revenues across different streams like BESS, inverters, inverter, and wafer. We believe we are well positioned to lead India's clean energy transition and create meaningful value for all our stakeholders.

Thank you once again.

With that, we are happy to take your questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Subramaniam Yadav from SBI Life Insurance . Please go ahead.

Subramaniam Yadav: Thank you. Sir, I just wanted to understand the order inflow numbers. We are at about INR2,000 odd crore s inflow this quarter. But when you look at the breakup of that, the cell mix has been increased to 39 % versus 27 % in the last quarter. So, what is our strategy going ahead in terms because we have already commissioned our model facility ? So how do we look at it? Whether it could be internally used or we are going to sell it to third party?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, Subramaniam . Hi. Good morning. This is Vinay here. So, I think, what has happened there is tha t -- there is a big demand for cells in the domestic market. Particularly, going beyond even FY26. And we've had a closure on a few of those cell orders. And I think it is just the result in the share of cells in the order book is simply a reflection on that.

I would also say that not too much should be read into that in terms of our strategy for the business mix and cell and modules. We have huge capacities coming up, as you know for both cells and modules and we continue to evaluate the market on an ongoing basis to determine the best sales mix for us.

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Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, sir. But your voice seems distant. Can you come closer? Sir, it was a little bit distant.

Vinay Rustagi: Okay. So, I was just saying that we had a closure on some cell orders going into FY27. And the ratio of cells in the order book has gone up. Having said that, we should not read too much into that as a specific company strategy. We have lots of capacity coming up for both cells and modules. And we continue to evaluate the market environment in terms of demand and pricing. And we'll fix our strategy on an ongoing basis accordingly.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay. And, sir, have you seen any pricing pressure? Because though we have improved in realization on cell and modules. But in last six to eight months, there have been a couple of fatalities come up. So incrementally for next six months, are you seeing any pressure in the pricing?

Vinay Rustagi: No. So the answer to that is, as of now, we don't see any pricing pressure. As you can see in the results for the quarter, as well as what we have in our order book. I think there is a lot of volatility in the market in terms of pricing of some of the raw materials. But, we don't -- on the whole, we are able to protect our margins. And we don't see that impacting our profitability.

Subramaniam Yadav: And for TCF annual maintenance, how much time the plant costs shut down for this cell facility?

Management: Sorry, I can take this for the annual m

aintenance. So generally for annual maintenance, we allocate about a week, Mr. Subramanian. But then it could add another day or two for them coming back into the right efficiency numbers. So anything between two to five days.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay. Thank you, sir. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mr. Mohit Kumar. Please go ahead.

Mohit Kumar: Yes. Hi. Good morning. Congratulations on another good quarter. My first question is, sir, on the order book , is it possible to help us see traditionally the order book composition at the end of Q1 -25 versus Q1 -FY26, especially between DCR and non -DCR? Has the composition changed materially?

Management: So, Mohit, the composition has not changed materially. Of course, there is an uptake in the DCR demand when you compare between Q1 -FY25 and Q1 -FY26. But then as our production lines also have come up, so I don't see there's a material change. But the demand for DCR is increasing starting June '26, as you're aware. It will become totally ALCM, which is 100% DCR for the Indian market.

Mohit Kumar: And my second question, sir, what is the progress on the approved list of sales? Has the application been submitted? And when do you think the list will be made public or notified?

Management: So, in our case, the applications have been submitted, fees paid, inspections done. And I think a couple of other manufacturers also have facilities which have been inspected. And I think it's

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now sitting with the National Institute of Solar Energy for them to compile and come up with the list shortly.

Mohit Kumar: My last question, sir, how do you see the demand of the sale from the U.S.? Are you receiving more inquiries? And is it fair to expect to see some booking in this fiscal year for supplying sales

to the U.S. market?

Management: So, on a short -term or medium -term outlook, there is a big demand from the U.S. But then we don't have enough capacities. Our priority has always been to cater to the Indian market. And we work very closely with the programs which are being monitored by the ministry. And the demand in India is so strong that we have no capacities for the U.S.

Mohit Kumar: Understood, sir. Thank you and best of luck. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rehan Syed from Trinetra Asset Managers. Please go ahead.

Rehan Syed: Oh, yes. Good morning, everyone, and thank you for giving me the opportunity. Sir, I have two questions on the PLL side. First of all, the company has achieved a 16.5% P AT margin this quarter. How sustainable do you believe this margin is?

Management: Sir, we are not here to hear you. You are smudging, please.

Rehan Syed: Yes, right now. I'm audible now?

Management: Yes, just move a little away from the phone and you can talk, please.

Rehan Syed: Okay. The company has achieved a 16.5% P AT margin this quarter. How sustainable do you believe this margin profile is given the rising depreciation from the real plant function? So, do you believe you can maintain this moving forward for FY27...?

Management: See, I think, Rehan, thank you for the question. In terms of profitability, when you look at the PAT number, there are too many levers in terms of EBITDA, obviously, and then depreciation interest and tax rate. And, on an ongoing basis, there are a number of adjustments in all these parameters. So, for example, if you see even this quarter, the depreciation has come down, interest has come down, tax has come down, and there are very good reasons for that and these changes will keep on happening on a quarter -on-quarter basis.

So, I think the key metric for us that we look at is the EBITDA margin, you know, which is how kind of we evaluate our order book and all the discussion pipeline and discussion with the clients. So, there I'

m happy to say that our EBITDA margin, that we have in our order book is pretty visible and attractive along the lines of what you see currently.

In terms of the P AT margin itself, there will be minor tweaks going forward because the depreciation rate, for example, as we go forward, there will be more drawdown on debt because of expansion of a new cell and module capacity. And as the debt gets drawn down, there will be more debt cost, and that will kind of take away something from the P AT margin.

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So, similarly, the tax rate is dependent on the mix between our manufacturing business, the project business, inventory valuation, etc. So, I think because of that, there will be some minor tweaks in the P AT rate. But overall, the EBITDA margin is very stable and attractive.

Rehan Syed: Okay. So, just clarifying what you asked was, and then we have to focus on the EBITDA margin and compare the P AT margin for going forward.

Management: Correct. Yes. Yes. That's correct.

Rehan Syed: Okay. And then second question is around the order book. They have mentioned that the order book stands at INR 86,027 Mn / 5,545 MW with 100% domestic exposure. So, given that almost all orders are India -focused, so how are you planning to re -enter or scale exports, especially with the growing global demand and trade policy?

Management: Sorry. You're not audible.

Rehan Syed: I'm asking regarding the order book at INR86,000 right now with 100% domestic exposure. Given that almost all orders are India -focused, how are you planning to re -enter or scale exports, especially with the growing global demand and trade policy? Is there any plan in the internal team to focus on the exports and also for going forward?

Management: No. What did you say? How are we going to?

Rehan Syed: Scale in export market. Is there any demand on that side?

Management: So, as we just answered the last question, we do not have capacities to sell into the export market. Our capacities are all sold out for the Indian market.

Rehan Syed: Okay. I'm clarifying that. Is there any internal demand that we have focusing for export from going forward? That's what I am asking.

Management: Yes. There is a strong demand from the export market, but we don't have capacities as of now.

Rehan Syed: Okay. And the last bookkeeping question, can you please tell me what is the capex plan for the quarter and FY26 -FY27?

Management: So, on the capex plan, I think we have been very clear in our presentation that we have accelerated our BSS and inverter lines, which will now come in Q1 of FY27, and our wafer manufacturing, our 4.8 gigawatt cell and module, all that is available in the presentation. Most of them are coming up in Q1 FY27, and I think something in Q2 FY27. Correct.

Rehan Syed: Okay. Okay. Thank you for answering the questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shivam Patel from PL Capital. Please go ahead.
Shivam Patel: Yes. Thank you for the opportunity. Just a clarification on revenue mix by business, which was said in the PPT. It has changed for the past quarter. So, how can we read those updated numbers?
Yes, that's the only question I have.

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Vinay Rustagi: Sorry, could you repeat that? Revenue mix?

Shivam Patel: The revenue mix by business, which was said in the PPT, it has changed for past quarters. So ,
how can we read those updated numbers?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, you see there is an increase in the module sales, and that is because our 1.4 gigawatt of
module line got commissioned on 16th of May. So, there is a certain amount of production of
module, which has got added to our production line. And you see a 1% drop in the cell revenue,
which is also because of annual maintenance of the lines in the start of the
e quarter.

Shivam Patel: Okay, okay. Thank you, sir. And all the best.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deepak Krishnan from Kotak Institutional
Equities. Please go ahead.

Deepak Krishnan: Yes. Chiranjeev, just more of a strategic question. Just wanted to get your take on building versus
make. How do you kind of see this? You know, there are lines available at depreciated cost
globally. Is there a chance that Premier would do that to accelerate its capacity additions? And
what are their views? Because we've also seen some players commission at a shorter period of
time versus our initial lines were 2 years plus. Now it's 18, 21 months for the remaining cell
lines. So how do you see this in terms of Premier positioning itself for this?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, A, Premier as a company, we would always invest in advanced technologies and the
latest equipment. So we would never look at depreciated or second -hand lines if you meant in
Southeast Asia or in China. We would not want to foray into such an idea because these are
equipments which are getting new upgrades every quarter. So, you know, we need to time it in
such a way that we are not investing in an old technology.

And the majority of the lines which are available in Southeast Asia or China are mono PERC
lines, which is, again, a technology which is phasing out. And getting in mono PERC lines and
upgrading them is not the best way to get the high efficiency or be a leadership, have a leadership
position on the efficiency front. The other aspect of this is it's not the equipment which takes
time for the cell lines to set up. The equipments are available within 6 to 8 months.

The problem is when you have to start from the ground, the building, the utilities which have to
be made in India, and it's impossible to get utilities from these depreciated lines in Southeast
Asia or in China because those utilities have been built to suit those local requirements. So I
think we as a company would not look at this aspect at all. We would want to build high -class,
state-of-the-art lines and build lines which will give the highest efficiency in terms of value to
the customer.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, Chiranjeev . And maybe just, wanted to understand, let me look at, this particular quarter,
the incremental sales have happened at, very low margins if I look at the incremental EBITDA
jump. Is that all a function of, incremental sales have been ALLM and non -DCR sales because
we have capacity constrained , and that mix should ideally improve in coming quarters?

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And maybe just a follow -up on the question the previous participant asked. Basically, your sell
and revenue percentages for the previous quarters have been restated in the presentation. Any
particular factor that is driving that? So the Q4 number that was there in the Q4 presentation and
this presentation do not match similarly for some of the other quarters. So any factor that is
driving that?

And just a mix of it looks like all the incremental sales have been at 10% margins, so looks
everything has to be ALMM. That should sort of rectify as we sort of add the sale capacity. And
what stage are we in terms of stabilizing the 1.2 gigawatt line? Is it like in full production already
this quarter?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So line is not in full production. We have commissioned the line and started the stabilization
process. We expect to achieve 25% and above efficiency sometime in the end of August or first
week of September. So there would be a contribution coming in from cell line starting the end
of August or first week of September. And once line is stabilized, then, looking at the deep
knowledge we have on running these lines, they generally work consistently.

In terms of the EBITDA and P A T margins, you're talking the

EBITDA margin went down,

mostly because of depreciation. We had upgraded some of our module lines in the last quarter.

And also the , Vinay, you want to take...

Vinay Rustagi: I will take this. Deepak, I presume you're looking at slide number 25. Is that right?

Deepak Krishnan: Yes.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so I think what you see is that the operating EBITDA margin over the last two quarters has gone from 32.6 % to 30.1%. And I think here what has happened is that the underlying, the core EBITDA on the sales of the business has actually remained static at the same old levels.

However, during this quarter, there was a very sharp reduction in prices for sales and w afers , in China.

And because we maintain a large inventory of these products with us, we had to mark down the prices at which this inventory was held. Because our inventory pricing policy is cost price or current price, the lower of the two. So it is only because of reduction in the inventory valuation, which basically went through to the cost of goods sold line, which resulted in a reduction in the EBIT DA margin that you see on the slide.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, Vinay. And just maybe on slide 27 itself, the Q4 number, the percentages for sale is different in this versus the previous quarter.

Moderator: Sir, s orry to interrupt.

Deepak Krishnan: No, just to follow up on just on what was asked. So slide 27, if I just, if I look at it, the sale percentage this quarter for Q3 is 33 versus the presentation at that time. So it's 35 versus that time it was 33. And similarly, Q4 number has been restated, similar to what the previous participant asked. The percentage of cell and module on a quarterly basis, the historical numbers are getting changed. Any reason, how should we sort of read that?

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Vinay Rustagi: See, just to clarify, Deepak, you're looking at slide number 26, right?

Deepak Krishnan: The revenue by mixed business, the right bar chart. If I look at last quarter, what's -- no, no, if I look at the Q4 number, it is 70, 24, and 6. You know, versus the previous, the same presentation last quarter was 74, 23, and 3. So any, and similarly, the 3Q number has also been restated.

Vinay Rustagi: Okay. So basically, your question is about the restatement of the historic numbers.

Deepak Krishnan: Yes, of cell and module and EPC. The mix is being changed.

Vinay Rustagi: Deepak, just give me a minute. I'm just checking it.

Deepak Krishnan: Yes, no worries. You can go on to the next participant. I'll join back on the queue so that we can come back.

Vinay Rustagi: Sure, we'll come back to you. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Yes, thank you so much for taking my question. So my first question is on the utilization that we have given in slide number 24. So when we take the cell and module utilization, on what capacity are we taking this utilization for Q1 for cells a nd modules? Like, are we doing it on the effective capacity, the nameplate capacity, and what would be that number?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So it is on effective capacity.

Vinay Rustagi: Correct.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And generally, the number is, you know, the nameplate capacity less 10% is the effective capacity, and this is on that effective capacity.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you. And so another thing that I wanted to know is that how are you seeing the trend in the pricing of the modules? Are you seeing that there is a drop in realizations, not only for Q1, but also for the upcoming year? Where do you see the prices moving?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So as of now, if you're looking at the ALMM non -DCR market, the re we are seeing prices to be going up because the polysilicon prices, ingot vapor sale prices in China have gone up. So we are seeing an increase in the sale

prices. And if you're talking about the margins, generally it's a pass-through cost for us, so we d on't have any effect on that.

Nidhi Shah: Okay. Lastly, on the KUSUM scheme, what is your outlook on the KUSUM scheme, especially the component B and the component C? Are you seeing that installations are rising in the upcoming quarters? Are there any hindrances in those projects that are affecting installations?

Vinay Rustagi: No. So I think in terms of the KUSUM tenders, the big volumes are expected to come in the next year, particularly for these ground -mounted projects. As you can see from the data that we have shown in our presentation, the number of pumps installation, which is basically shown as off -

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grid on slide number 13, has actually come down. That is because bulk of the focus in terms of the scheme is now on grid-connected, ground-mounted projects. Those tenders and auction awards happened over the last 1 year or so, and hence we expect a major pickup in execution in the course of the next 1 year.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you so much. Those were my questions.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of...

Chiranjeev Saluja: Can we just answer Deepak's question on the slide number 26?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Deepak, hi. So what has happened in terms of slide 26 is that historically the data that we had given was only for the domestic market. So actually, apologies, it was not complete, but now we have adjusted that data for the domestic plus export, reflecting our total business mix, and hence there has been a re-reporting of all the historic numbers.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Deepak, you're there?

Moderator: No, sir, he's not there. Okay, sir. The next question is from the line of Sujit Jain from BALIC. Please go ahead.

Sujit Jain: Yes. I hope I'm audible. So in terms of the BESS...

Moderator: Yes, sir.

Sujit Jain: Okay, great. In terms of the BESS that you put out on your presentation, A, who are the suppliers currently in India? When do you start bidding? And which are the technical partners that you're talking to? And do you see this deadline of June '26, you'll be able to come up with your facilities?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So June '26, Sujit, has got nothing to do with BESS. That is for the solar cell, mandatory use of Indian-made cells. To answer your question on BESS, we are investing in a cell to pack in a containerized solution line. We have onboarded an experienced team, and the line should be commissioned by Q1 FY '27. We are talking to various technology suppliers on the cell side. That is the battery cell which we're going to import from China. So we have not concluded on the technology partner as we speak today.

And in terms of customers whom we're going to sell this to is mostly the developers who have bid and won projects in the IPP space who's our target customer to supply the BESS containerized solutions. Does that answer your question?

Sujit Jain: In terms of the timeline, I'm not clear. June '26 is what your presentation says, 6 gigawatt hour?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, that's correct. So that is what Chiranjeev just said. Quarter one of FY '27 is when we expect this capacity to come online and start selling.

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Sujit Jain: Yes, and in terms of the order book or booking of the order, in terms of timelines, when do you actually get into that process?

Vinay Rustagi: We've just, as we said, we've just hired an experienced team and we're adding to the sales team also over there. We have simultaneously begun discussions with our IPP customers who are winning many of these hybrid or solar plus storage projects. So given that our first product is not expected to come out for another 8 to 9 months, we would expect order conversion somewhere towards the end

of the year.

Sujit Jain: Sure, and who are the suppliers currently and what capacities in India currently other players would be having? That's my last question. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, sure. So I think at this point in time, the capacity in India is very, very small. Most customers are looking to import completely packaged solutions from other countries. But over a period of time, particularly given the government's focus on indigenization, this entire value chain is expected to shift to India.

Sujit Jain: Sure, thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bala Murali Krishna from Oman Investment Advisors. Please go ahead.

Bala Murali Krishna: Hi, good morning. So do we have any incremental revenues from the recent capacity additions in this quarter?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sorry, could you be a little louder, Bala?

Bala Murali Krishna: In this current -- yes.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, I got your question. So basically our module line got commissioned in May and we had part of the production coming through reflected in our numbers. And to that end, yes, there are some incremental revenues in the business. On the cell line, the commercial production has just begun, so that is not shown in the quarter at all.

Bala Murali Krishna: So going forward in this, maybe next quarter or third quarter, so how much incremental revenue we can expect from these two additions? And I think that there is no further capacity coming in this year.

Vinay Rustagi: So I think it is very simple math, Bala. I mean, the total capacity that is coming online is 1.4 gigawatt modules and 1.2 gigawatt cell. Effectively, if you take it at about 75% capacity utilization and the prices that are currently in the market, you know, they will give you the expected uptake in the revenue numbers.

What I will say, though, is that while the module line is now currently nearly operating at full capacity, the cell line will take some time to ramp up and get the right efficiency, which we expect to happen over the course of this quarter. So I think this quarter you will still see only part of the uptake coming through with the balance coming in the next quarter.

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Bala Murali Krishna: Okay. And the gross margin side...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, but I request you to join the queue for the follow-up questions. Thank you.

The next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from SUD Life. Please go ahead.

Anupam Goswami: Sir, can you give us a hint on what's our DCR content this time and how are we going to ramp up or where do we see the mix going forward? And also, sir, on the capacity that is coming on the cells in the industry and our long-term strategy to, say, right now we are enjoying high DCR prices. Now when the capacity comes, what's our view and strategy on that?

Vinay Rustagi: Anupam, sorry, can you repeat the first part of the question? You said something about DCR content.

Anupam Goswami: Yes, sir. So DCR mix this time. Where are we at how much mix? And going forward, where do you see that ramping up and how fast ramping up?

Vinay Rustagi: So in terms of the DCR versus the non-DCR mix in our business, we don't reveal these numbers.

Now in terms of the demand, the DCR demand is obviously given is going up, steadily, given the shift, given the introduction of ALMM2. Our estimate is that the current run rate of demand for DCL modules is about 15 -gigawatts per annum.

That is basically the Surya Ghar Yojana, the Kusum scheme, and the PSU scheme. But from early next year onwards we will see the open access demand coming through, because projects commissioned by June 2026, we'll have to, procure, sales and modules, made in India. And so there on, early '26 onwards we expected the demand and rate to increase to about 25 -gigawatts. And then, somewhere towards the end of the year

early 2027 the entire market, which is about

40-gigawatts to 45 -gigawatts, will shift towards DCR. And our sales mix will basically largely reflect the changing mix of the market.

Chiranjeev Saluja : And just to answer your question on the capacity. So I mean, we are closely monitoring the situation, and our view remains that the market is expected to remain favorable with a strong demand. It's worth quoting that recent report of BNEF projects annual, deployment in India to go up from present 40 -gigawatt to 125 -gigawatts per annum in the next 10 -years.

And we feel it's a difficult business for new entrants. New capacity usually takes much longer than expected to come online and ramp -up. And moreover, the IPB clients, the developers in India are very selective with a preference for integrated supplies, offering scale, advanced technology, proven track record and bankability. So we believe that we enjoy a strong competitive position on all these parameters.

Anupam Goswami : Got it, sir. So just one if I can squeeze . Sir, a little on the long-term, when we see this year pricing coming down with the sales or the demand also subsiding, then what's our strategy to diversify out of India or in the product lines ?

Chiranjeev Saluja : So I don't think that the demand is looking to be coming down. What we are seeing is the demand is going to go up consistently. As I just mentioned to about 125 -gigawatts per annum in the next

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10 years. So even if you look at 125 -gigawatt demand, which means that the capacity of manufacturing should be at least about 170 -gigawatts, 175 -gigawatts in India over the next 10 years, so we don't see that the demand is coming down.

Vinay Rustagi : But equally at the same time, in parallel to that you already know, what is our expansion and vertical integration strategy. So we are going backwards into ingots and wafers and entering new businesses like batteries, inverters, and even making ancillary products like aluminum frames.

So while the module business will continue to grow, as Chiranjeev said, there'll be additional revenue streams coming from all these new businesses. And that will provide us with the growth

that is expected in the business.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aman Jain from Bernstein .

Aman Jain: Hello. Yes, hi. Thank you for taking my questions. Just one question. If you look at depreciation number , it has declined Q -on-Q even when we are adding new assets. So I just wanted to check with you why is that?

Chiranjeev Saluja : Yes, so I think I had answered this question some time back. Is that last quarter we had an increased depreciation, because we upgraded our solar module line stringers from the old technology to the latest technology. And hence the depreciation was slightly higher in the last quarter compared to this quarter.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Mayur Patel from 360 ONE AMC.

Mayur Patel : Congratulations, Chiranjeev, and the team for a robust set of numbers. Just give us some idea about the current pricing in the market on both module and the DCR sales side.

Chiranjeev Saluja : So Pricing , Mayur , is fairly constant. It would actually see a slight increase due to prices in China going up on the non -DCR side. You would see an increase because solar cell prices in China in the last couple of weeks have gone up by almost 30%. And this is almost close to a cent, which is incremental price in the sale price from China.

And, it doesn't, affect our orders with our customers because -- yes, so our contracts are generally passed through with variable prices. So, prices in the market are fairly stable, and our order book is going into almost, 12 to 15 months which our contracts are signed so we don't see any significant change in margins .

Mayur Patel: Okay. So it's around \$0.16, the sales for the DCR market

currently ?

Chiranjeev Saluja : DCR market sale prices range between \$0.14 to \$0.16, so an average of about \$0.15, I would say.

Mayur Patel : Got it. And Chiranjeev change of any color on the pipeline of new order booking. Is it possible to share anything? It would be helpful.

Chiranjeev Saluja : So as we speak today, we have signed significantly large orders, post 30th June. And generally we are very , very clear on our internal policy on the order book. It has to be a fully secured signed order book what we disclose . In terms of pipeline, we have a very strong pipeline going

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into FY '27. The number is fairly large, but we generally refrain from, giving numbers as a future guidance.

But, if you align with the capacity that which we are putting up which are coming up in, June 26th, the pipeline is significantly larger, compared to the volumes that we are -- the factories that we're setting up.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Nitin Arora from Axis Mutual Fund .

Nitin Arora: Hi, sir. Thanks for taking my question .

Chiranjeev Saluja: Hi, Nitin.

Nitin Arora: Hi, sir. So just, you also said that there has been volatility in the sale prices. We saw that in the last 2 months, but now we are seeing even wafer prices, sale prices going very sharp move what we have seen in the last 2, 3 months. Can you throw some light how the Indian IPP thinking about this in terms of clocking prices now?

Because I think in the previous question you said you're seeing very large pipeline. So is it like the IPPs now are going ahead and closing the orders if you can throw some light because you deal with them. So just if you can throw some light on that aspect.

Chiranjeev Saluja : Yes, I think you're spot on this , Nitin. it is a general tendency when prices are up. You want to quickly lock up the deals and then they're dropping you expect that they'll drop further and you keep waiting. So I think you're right on that. We are seeing a strong uptake of IPPs wanting to close quickly now and, this will of course show up in our next quarterly results.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Sarang Joglekar from Vimana Capital .

Sarang Joglekar : Yes, hi. Thanks for the opportunity. I'm looking at Slide 14 that you have given the whole demand scenario. So just, can you break it up into various sources , like how much is coming from each source annually, say, the main tendering agencies NTPC and all the state discounts corporate rooftop, and the household rooftop. So and maybe how much demand is coming if you could?

Vinay Rustagi : Sure, Sarang . Just to clarify, you're looking at the slide number 14, with the title strong demand with DCR modules.

Sarang Joglekar : Yes, but I just wanted, understanding on the entire not just DCR non -DCR as well.

Vinay Rustagi : Sure. So I think, Slide 14 is, kind of self-explanatory in a way. The Surya Ghar Yojana demand is obviously ultimately coming in from the households, wherein the demand is aggregated by the distributors and the local installers. And hence our customer continue -- is typically, these entities. In the P M KUSUM Yojana, again that KUSUM scheme has multiple components,

comprising both solar pumps as well as ground mounted projects.

Solar pumps obviously you have these large companies, who are all the customers. And then, for the ground mounted projects it is the same IPP customers that we see in the normal utility scale

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business. CPSU scheme is basically all PSU companies like NTPC, NHPC, SECI, etcetera . These are mostly tender driven procurements, and we have historically had a low share in this market .

The corporate market is a mix of the captive consumers themselves, so for example, the steel companies, IT companies, etcetera. And the IPPs were setting up these projects for their end

customers. And finally, the utility scale solar is the large -- is basically all the large private as well as the public sector IPP.

So that is basically the typical customer profile in each of these markets. I would say from our business point of view we have historically had a much larger presence in the private IPP business. We've done some public sector business in the past, although that business is much smaller, share of, our, business mix right now.

Now the one change that we're making going forward is that we want to scale up our presence, in the rooftop solar market, particularly with the demand growing exceptionally in the residential segment. So there, we are making a lot of effort to enlarge our distribution base, and spend more on marketing and branding efforts, targeted at the end consumer.

Sarang Joglekar : Got it. So, follow up question.

Vinay Rustagi: Sure.

Sarang Joglekar : You said that annual demand would be around 40 -gigawatt, 45 -gigawatt modules, right? And if you see ALMM list capacity and listed is already at about 90 -gigawatts, and you still are maintaining margins. So just trying to understand like if the capacity is already there, why isn't there's still pressure on pricing?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So I think we have answered this earlier also that the ALMM format is such that even, players who have, 300 megawatts, 500 megawatts of annual capacity which are supposed to operate, 24x7, the capacity is deciphered by -- on the basis of 24x7 operations. And many of these lines do not operate 24x7.

The other thing is that, if you look at the capacity utilization we have large capacities, but utilization is quite low, so we as a company have always thought of growing with the integration of cells and ingot wafer. So you see higher capacity utilization in our case. And the 90 -gigawatt what you see on the ALMM is not what is all operational, not what is all automated. Many of the lines are semi -automated. An IPP developer would not buy from such lines. So I think, that should answer your question.

Sarang Joglekar : So in your estimate, how much is the actual capacity?

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, but I request you to join -- rejoin the queue for the follow -up question.

Sarang Joglekar : Yes. No. That was the last one.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Nikhil Somani from Nixa Investment Advisors.

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Nikhil Somani: Hi. Sir, just taking a cue from the previous participant, right? Trying to understand the demand supply especially on the module side. Sir, from what we understand on the module side against a demand of 40 -gigawatt, the industry is expected to go to, let's say, 160 -gigawatt to 170 -gigawatt nameplate capacity in the next couple of years as against 90 -gigawatt to 100 -gigawatt currently, which the previous participant alluded to.

Now on 160 -gigawatt to 170 -gigawatt, even at a 60% to 70% utilization, we get 200 -gigawatt to 120 -gigawatt of available supply. Against, let's say, two years down the line, a demand of 50 -gigawatt. So optically, it still looks like we will end up in a high over supply situation in the next two years to three years. So how do you look at this?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. No. Let me explain this to you. I think we are missing the biggest point here that starting June 26, even though you have 100 -gigawatt of module capacity, you would not be able to sell those modules with upward cell capacity, because you have to use Indian-made cells. So the limitation factor is not the module, but it is the cell.

Today's cell capacity in India is around 20 gigawatts, 25 gigawatts, and this has to grow to about 150 gigawatts as the demand increases. So we foresee that the demand supply situation would continue to be as it is for at least two years to three years. We don't see that there will be an overcapacity

capacity over the next two years to three years.

Nikhil Somani: So effectively, sir, what you're saying is for an integrated player like us, probably given the fact we have a sizable cell capacity, it shouldn't impact. But for a fringe player or a player who's just into module right now and not even integrated to the cell level, things could go worse.

Chiranjeev Saluja: They would be impacted big time if they don't have cells.

Nikhil Somani: Understood. Understood.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Or if it's impact to cell manufacturer who could supply themselves.

Nikhil Somani: Got it. And on the capacity utilization for the module line, which has steadily been rising for us from 69% six months to nine months back to 77% right now. I think you already mentioned that the nameplate capacity is 10% less and the effective capacity is, let's say, 90% of the nameplate capacity. And right now we are operating at 77% of effective capacity, which is essentially 70% of the nameplate capacity. Would it be fair to assume that we are operating at fairly advanced capacity utilizations and not much scope of improving the utilization there?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. You are right.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. You're right, because in module line you're making different kind of modules of different wattages for customers. We would be making 580 -watt modules for a customer A and a 615 -watt to 620 -watt for a customer B. But that's not the case in a cell line. You just make one single product continuously. So in module lines we don't expect utilization capacity to go beyond around 80% of the effective.

Nikhil Somani: 80% of the effective. Got it. Got it. Okay.

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Moderator: The next question is from the line of Balasubramanian from Arihant Capital.

Balasubramanian: Good morning, sir. Good morning, sir. Thank you so much for the opportunity. So my first question regarding the industry, I shared the Mono PERC capacities. It's anywhere between 30 gigawatts right now. And right now the industry itself transitioning to TOPCon. I just want to happen existing capacities, whether the real demand is there for Mono PERC. And if you could share that split between Mono PERC, TOPCon and HAT in the industry in India?

And how these Chinese transition happening. Because I shared some of the players are importing secondhand TOPCon machines they installed in India. How this transition happening on the technology side? Because if you look at in 2000 – 2002, 2015, polycrystalline technologies were there. It's almost 15 years?

From 2015 to 2025, '26, almost 10 years, 11 years. Like the people are talking about post -2030, HAT will be in the place. But then how this transition happening and the timeline is also reducing. If you could share some details about the industry and how this transition happening?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So let's start with China. In China, majority of the technology share is with TOPCon. And we are seeing that the HAT is not really growing in China. It's from TOPCon. And the roadmap from TOPCon to TOPCon back on that. And Tandem is all very clearly visible with majority of the players working on TOPCon technology. If you talk about India, we have about 20 -gigawatt to 25 -gigawatt of capacity. Today, out of that, I would say about 70% is Mono PERC. The rest could be TOPCon and thin film, right? But any new line coming up would be TOPCon.

And to answer your question on getting secondhand TOPCon like China is something which we do not think is the right decision because most of these lines would be two years to three years old. And the efficiency you would get from these lines would be almost a 1% lower than the latest technology lines. So we as a company do not believe in investing into two years to three years old line...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, but your voice is breaking.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So I was sayin

g that we as a company would not recommend or would want to invest in old technology lines from China, because the efficiency you would get out of it would not be really up to the mark what is available today in the market.

Balasubramanian: Okay, sir. Sir, quick question about the recycling. Are we planning any recycling plant for, like, solar module and all that we can be able to reuse it?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi, Bala. This is Vinay here. So in terms of recycling, we are very, very keen to ensure that we have access to a high technology, completely environmentally compliant recycling source.

So to that end, we are in the process of identifying some partners and entering into strategic tie -ups with them. We don't see it as a core activity for ourselves. So, we are not going to invest and develop these plants ourselves.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Apoorva from IIFL Capital.

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Apoorva: Hi. Thank you so much for the opportunity. Sir, I wanted to – hi. I wanted to know your thoughts on this US anti-dumping duty. There was some news flow around it. How do you see that panning out in case it gets implemented? Do you see it having an impact on the Indian market demand supply dynamics as well, given that it will essentially close the US export markets?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Apoorva, hi. Vinay here. So I think the investigation has just begun. And there is a pretty long period for these investigations to get completed and any duty to get effective. In general, I would say, the two main grounds for any such duty are, one, the producers selling goods at below cost, which we know is definitely not the case in India.

The second main ground is often the companies getting subsidies from the government. So, we believe the case for this is kind of not very sure. And definitely the Indian companies are not selling any products below their cost levels.

In general, I think the timeline for this investigation is incomplete and it is very hard for us to assess, what is the viability of exports to the US market. We also have to remember that, there are a couple of other issues in relation to the US market, mainly the outcome of the pending US - India trade treaty, as well as the other levies that the US Government is proposing against big nations or other countries buying Russian crude, etcetera.

So I think in general, there is quite a lot of unknowns in relation to the US market. And hence for the time being at least, because of that uncertainty, not much -- we are not placing much value on the potential of the US market until all these issues become clearer.

Apoorva: Well, this company is getting a subsidy from government sort of leave them open for a potential duty action from US. Is my understanding correct?

Vinay Rustagi: See, I think if you look at these subsidies, they are mostly at the cell level. Now on the cell level, you could argue that there is no case for the US companies to support any duty because the US cell capacity is actually very, very limited in relation to the domestic demand. The cell capacity today is only about 5 -watt -- gigawatts in the US.

So I -- and all those cell manufacturers are actually sold out in the US. So for them to claim injury because of any cheap or subsidized imports from India is not actually a legitimate argument. So I think that is why I say that we don't believe that there's any kind of a solid ground for this investigation. But, of course, we have to wait until the outcome is known.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And also the exports are...

Apoorva Bahadur: And I think...

Vinay Rustagi: Sorry, Apoorva. My final point is that, our reliance on the export market is next to nil. And hence we are protected irrespective of the outcome of this investigation.

Apoorva Bahadur: Yes, understood. I think, fair enough. Another question, I think, and I would love to

have some
color from you.

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, but I request you to...

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Apoorva Bahadur: Ma'am, this is my second question. You're allowed two per participant.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Please go ahead.

Apoorva Bahadur: Sorry, thanks. Yes, so just wanted to get some color from you on how is the Indian market discovering pricing for cells and modules? Is it based or still based on the Chinese pricing or is the Indian market now deep enough to have its own price discovery?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, I think we always had our own price discovery. It was never related to the Chinese prices. And if you see, Chinese have been dumping and losing money quarter-on-quarter. And that is the reason why the association reached out to the government for support and they have increased prices by about 30% at cell level and substantial increase in vapor and polysilicon. So we never had any comparison to prices in China because prices in China were varying by over 70%, 80% over a year, So it's very difficult to compare with China.

Apoorva Bahadur: Sir I understand. Yes, I understand that from a floor pricing perspective, yes, that was the case. But now given that the Chinese have such increasing pricing, do you think it will percolate to the pricing of Indian cells and modules as well, irrespective of the input cost? So can the prices go more than the input cost increase?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, I think if we have a variable contract, so whatever increase for non -DCR module gets passed on, for a DCR module, whatever increase in the vapor gets passed on.

Vinay Rustagi: See, Apoorva, I think, you know, the Indian market ecosystem is actually developing and maturing rapidly, as you can see, with the rising capacity, both for cells and modules. Second, over the next 1 to 2 years, 1 and 1.5 years, we will see a complete transition to India-made products because of ALMM.

So because of that, there is really no connection between what is happening in China and what is happening in India. The Indian market, as you, I think, were trying to say, there is a completely independent price discovery in the Indian market, depending on local demand, particularly given

for DCR cells and modules and local supply.

Apoorva Bahadur: Understood. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Mahawar' from UBS, please go ahead.

Amit Mahawar: Sorry, I have just two quick questions. First is, our decision, if you see the business mix and business model, we definitely skew towards the utility and CNI and domestic market. Exports and retail rooftop, to some extent, you answered the question about exports, but still both these segments, on a 5-year basis, are going to be an important share of the total time for you. So any thoughts about these two directionally for us?

And second question is more, starting next year, if things are on track, we will see a potential shortage in local cell capacities. Where do you think, on a 3-year basis, say on FY '25 to '28, the cell demand supply will move? Thank you, sir.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So on exports, I had answered. On retail, we are focused. We have a channels sales distribution network, and we are supplying, I would say, almost 60 % to 70% of our DCR manufacturing into the rooftop segment, and about 35 % to 40 % to the KUSUM. So there is a very clear focus from the ministry and from the company to supply as much as we can to the rooftop segment.

To answer your question on when do we estimate that cell capacity would be enough, my take would be at least about 3 years, where you have enough cell capacity to cater to local demand, but then it's subjective as to how the demand would shape up. If the demand shapes up much faster, then of course this could go even longer. And

given the fact that it's not easy to set up cell lines, this would take about 3 years. Correct.

Amit Mahawar: Thank you.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Does that answer your question, Amit?

Amit Mahawar: Yes, sir, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Subramanyam Yadav from SBI Life Insurance. Please go ahead.

Subramanyam Yadav: Thank you, sir, for taking the question. Yes, sir, thank you. The second thing I just wanted to ask is, on the inventory front, what is the write-off we have taken this quarter? And incrementally, I understand that in the order book, we won't have any impact because we have passed through. But the new orders, what we are going to take from the utility, are we able to pass on that incremental increase in the wafer or cell prices?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, for the wafer and cell, we do pass on. And for the provision that we have made, as Vinay had said, as a policy, we value our raw material stock at either the cost or the net realizable value.

So in the last quarter, prices have gone down. And because of which, as prudent governance practice, we had, yes, accounting standards, we had created this provision. But then this keeps changing quarter-on-quarter. If prices go up, then we would go back to our purchase cost. It would not be then as per market prices.

Subramanyam Yadav: Okay. And what about...

Vinay Rustagi: Subramanyam, hi. It's Vinay here. The key thing there is that it is not a loss for the business. It is just an accounting entry. And ultimately this inventory is held on account of the customers. And any price increase or decrease is passed on to them. So to that end, our position in terms of margins and profits is completely protected.

Subramanyam Yadav: Yes, understood, sir. And what about the incremental thing? Because 30% increase in the raw material cost, are the utilities agreed to such increase in prices in the future orders?

Chiranjeev Saluja: They have no choice, because if they have to buy cells, and they're dependent on China, and if prices go up, they have to pay the cost of the cell of what China is selling. And this is the reason why we need to be having a very strong ecosystem of manufacturing in India, where a developer

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who bids for projects gets a fairly stable supply chain security rather than face these volatility.

So this is passed on to the customer. That's an industry-wide practice.

Subramanyam Yadav: Okay, thank you, sir. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Kunal Shah from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Kunal Shah: Yes. So thanks for taking my questions. Two from my side. Now recently, one of the leading solar EPC companies mentioned about a bit of slowdown in the tendering activity because of confusion around the ALCM timelines as one of the reasons, and that there is less confidence on

India becoming self-sufficient on cell by June '26. Now could you just throw some light here, and do you see slippage of timelines here in terms of implementation?

Vinay Rustagi: No. So Kunal when you say slowdown in tender activity, you're talking about tender issuance, I presume. You're right. There is a definite slowdown there. But bear in mind that we have more than 130 gigawatts of solar projects which have been tendered and auctioned and are currently in the pipeline. And there's a small share of that where the PPA capacities have still not been tied up with the ultimate DISCO customers.

So I think this is a very conscious move by the government to basically completely tie up the old auctions in terms of PPAs and then move on to new auctions. So I think we typically see this kind of cyclical pattern in the sector where we see a lot of auctions which the market takes time to absorb, followed by a slight slowdown in new tenders and followed by uptick in tenders again.

So I think it is all very kind of natural and normal activity.

But the good news there is that, you know, I think 3, 4 months ago, we were talking about more than 40 gigawatts of projects being held up with PPAs not being signed up. But a lot of those PPAs are now, particularly for renewable and hybrid projects, are being tied up and the backlog is being cleared up. So we should shortly see an uptick in the tendering activity, I think, from next quarter onwards.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. And just to add, the June '26 deadline would not affect the projects which have been tendered recently because they have 18 months of timeline to complete these projects. So we feel that the demand from the present levels going up over the next 2 to 3 years is going to be quite stable and in sync with the capacities which are available. We don't see overcapacity.

What will happen from June '26 is the CMI segment will have to switch over to the ALMM List II compliant, but the tenders which have been bid, they have 18 months, and they would look at buying modules at least 12 months post the tendering date or post the PPA signing date.

Kunal Shah: Understood. Now, this is very helpful. Second, on the capex towards your ingot wafer project, right? I mean, and given it's a large capex. Now, could you just tell, because on the understanding bid, would we need some sort of policy tailwind here in terms of DCR benefits, etcetera, and are we seeing any developments there?

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And also, I don't know if you've clarified this on the previous calls, but could you just help the cost of production of wafers and how competitive we would be versus, let's say, Chinese imports?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, sure, Kunal. So I think in terms of the policy, so the good news there is that we are in active discussions with the government, which is trying to assess the market landscape and is considering a very comprehensive policy combining incentives, duties, and ALM kind of measures.

So it is in anticipation of that policy that we have announced for the time being only a 2 gigawatt wafer plant, and most of the development of the remaining 8 or 10 gigawatt capacity is going to be back-ended towards end of FY '27, FY '28. So that will be after we have more clarity on the policy front.

In terms of the cost of manufacturing ingots and wafers, I think it's kind of too early to say because the local ecosystem is not really developed, but based on all the discussions we're having, once we have scale and we can develop domestic vendors for some of these products, we believe that we can reduce any cost delta over the true cost of Chinese manufacturing to very, very manageable levels.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is extremely helpful. Thanks a lot, sir.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Ladies and gentlemen, we'll take this as the last question for today. I would now like to hand the conference over to management for closing comments.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you. So I think overall, there is a little bit of volatility in the market in relation to, for example, supply of raw materials and prices in China, the U.S. duty structure, etcetera. From our point of view, we have been very, very focused, one, on making sure that our profitability remains intact. Second, that execution of new projects, which are going to more than double our capacity and impact on revenues and profits to make sure that the execution remains on track and on cost. And that is where we are focusing on.

So as Chiranjeev said, our main objective here is to be one of the leading players in the entire clean tech manufacturing space with scale, vertical integration, and the latest technologies. And we believe that given the initiatives that we are undertaking, we are well-poised to remain at the forefront of the sector, with growing demand and a growing business, I think we can

expect very

good results from the company in the coming years. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. On behalf of ICICI Securities Limited, that conclude this conference.
Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines .

Call: Nov 2025

Ref: PEL 68/2025-26

Date: November 04, 2025

To To

The Secretary The Manager,
BSE Limited Listing Department
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, National Stock Exchange of India Limited
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Mumbai - 400001 Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051
Scrip Code: 544238 Trading Symbol: PREMIERENE

Sub: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter and half year ended on September 30, 2025.

Dear Sir/ Madam,

In accordance with Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we are enclosing herewith the transcript of the conference call discussing the financial results for the quarter and half year ended on September 30, 2025. This call took place at 10:00 hours IST on Wednesday, 29th October 2025.

The above information will be made available on the website of the Company.

This is for your information and records.

Thanking you,
Yours truly,

For Premier Energies Limited

Ravella Sreenivasa Rao
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

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"Premier Energies Limited
Q2 and H1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"
October 29, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SINGH SALUJA – MANAGING
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. SUDHIR REDDY – CHIEF STRATEGY OFFICER AND
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. NAND KISHORE KHANDELWAL – GROUP CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. VINAY RUSTAGI – CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

Premier Energies Limited
October 29, 2025

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to Premier Energies Limited Q2 and H1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call, hosted by ICICI Securities Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star, then zero on your touch-tone telephone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities Limited. Thank you and over to you.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Iqra. Good morning. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the Q2 FY26 earnings call of Premier Energies. Today, we have with us from the management, Mr. Chiranjeev Singh Saluja, Managing Director, Mr. Nand Kishore Khandelwal, Chief Financial Officer, and Mr. Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer. We'll begin with the opening remarks from the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Mohit. I'm audible to you?

Mohit Kumar: Yes, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: All right. Good morning, everyone. Thank you for joining us today for our Q2 FY26 earnings call. I am Chiranjeev Saluja, Managing Director of Premier Energies, and I'm joined today by my colleagues, Mr. Khandelwal, Group CFO, Mr. Sudhir Reddy, Chief Strategy Officer and Director, and Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer. The company has reported another quarter with record revenue and profit numbers. Beyond the financial numbers, let me talk about some key highlights of this quarter.

First, our new cell and module lines commissioned in Q1 have ramped up nicely, as you can see from the increased production numbers. The 1.2 gigawatt TOPCon cell line, which commenced trial runs in August, and it should fully ramp up shortly. Second, we have made a major announcement of scaling up our 4.8 gigawatt TOPCon cell project in Naidupeta, Andhra Pradesh, to expand it to 7 gigawatt.

The total capacity of our cell lines would be 10.6 gigawatt by September 2026, aligning closely with our module capacity and our mission 2028 target. What is important to note is that this upgrade is being done at a nominal cost, taking advantage of design efficiency, and is funded entirely through internal accruals. Third update is we won new orders, aggregating to INR6,511 crores in this quarter.

These order wins come from a mix of top-tier independent power producers from across the market, which shows a strong validation of our ability to offer cutting-edge products at competitive prices with attractive margins. As you all would have seen, we have completed two very important acquisitions in the inverter and transformer businesses.

KSolare is a leading Indian inverter manufacturer focused on the residential market. Our 5149 partnership with Syrma SGS, a diversified electronics manufacturer, brings complementary strengths and provides a solid platform for this business. KSolare has [inaudible 0:04:07] 143 Premier Energies Limited

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crores in FY25. Our vision for this business is to increase the share of domestic value addition and market penetration over time.

On the transformer acquisition side, Transcon is poised to grow strongly with the total production capacity increasing from 2.5 GVA at present to 16.75 GVA by April 26. Transcon has rich experience and it is a 23-year-old company manufacturing transformers. The company is also moving up the value curve by moving towards more lucrative MV, HV, and EHV segments, which should improve margins on a growing top line. Both these acquisitions are highly complementary and value accretive.

This helps us in offering a portfolio of allied products to our clients. We expect that together with BSS, these new

businesses will contribute approximately 30% of our revenue over time.

Subtly, the business stands on very solid ground supported by growing renewable power demand, improving technology, falling costs, and the government's ever-growing commitment to domestic manufacturing.

We expect more Make in India policy initiatives for inverters, BSS, and the module supply chain in the near future. FY '27 would be an inflection point for our company as we more than double our cell and module capacity and create additional revenues from BSS, inverters, and ingot wafer.

Thank you. We are now open for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Deepak Krishna from Kotak Bank. Please go ahead.

Deepak Krishna: Hi, Chiranjeev. Hi, Vinay. Just wanted to sort of – yes, just wanted to understand this. So, if I look at your revenue from sales, based on your presentation, it's gone from roughly 420 to 440 crores, this Q-o-Q jump. And if I look at the sales number on the DCR portal, that's closer to

about 347 megawatt last quarter and about 424 megawatt this quarter.

So, that implies that, you know, sales realizations have fallen Q-o-Q about, you know, between 10% to 15%. Is that correct? Are we looking at, something different or, is there like because the top corner is ramping up? Anything that you can sort of clarify on that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure, Deepak. That's a very, very good question and I would love to clarify this. You know, the DCR portal was, launched by the Government of India more for traceability rather than, doing a financial analysis on sales and production.

So, what happens on a DCR portal is there are a lot of sales which are also inter-company or sell sales shown which are going into module production. To update you and the other shareholders on the call is that sales realizations in this quarter have marginally increased rather than decreased and the DCR portal is not the appropriate reflection which shows that there is a 22% increase in sales because that is also having sales made to inter-companies.

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Deepak Krishna: Sure, sure. And maybe just on the two acquisitions, one essentially on KSolare, in terms of when you reach about a million inverter pieces capacity, you know, what would be the total gigawatt in terms of reach?

How are you sort of trying to capture the market? Because you're trying to focus on PM Surya Ghar. So, how was the current company doing it? And, you know, how do you see doing it? Do you also sort of build a franchise network as some of your peers or some of the consumer durable companies are doing? So, that's on KSolare. And so, if I look at a transformer company, it looks like a INR1,000 crores valuation for INR16 crores part.

Obviously, you are more than quadrupling capacity. So, how should we look at, current order book and, you know, the revenue that the transformer business would have, say, maybe, you know, in FY '27, FY '28. And similarly, maybe, you know, similar numbers in terms of inverter, broad range of revenue and margins that you're sort of targeting.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. I'll pass this to Vinay to answer this question, Deepak.

Vinay Rustagi: So, you know, on KSolare, we know that the rooftop business in India is growing very strongly, mainly thanks to the PM Surya Ghar Yojana. The volumes have grown something like, I would say, 15 times over the last two years. And the current run rate is about 10 gigawatt per annum in terms of the new capacity addition.

And we expect this run rate to actually increase going forward. So, there is a very, very strong demand for residential inverters. The second point is that the government is increasingly focused on domestic manufacturing of inverters.

So, which means that, and as we have shown in a presentation, all the leading inverters in India

are basically supplied by Chinese companies, or even where there are Indian companies, they're mostly importing inverters and using white-labeled products. So, there is a great opportunity for us to create a new segment, which is growing very rapidly. So, our plan is to basically enter the residential market first, offer inverters together with our modules as bundled products.

We are also expanding our retail supply chain, building the investing into the distribution network. So, that is the starting point. But over a period of time, what we want to do eventually with this business is, one increase the product range to eventually go to utility-scale segment also, increase value addition over time by making more components in the company.

And, obviously, grow the top line and the bottom line. In terms of -- you mentioned a gigawatt of capacity. So, 1 gigawatt would typically, for the residential market employee mean, sorry, so the plan is to basically sell about a million inverters, which would typically translate to about 3 gigawatts of capacity.

And at that capacity, we should be about -- given the current market prices, that would imply about INR1,500 crores of revenues. Eventually, our expectation is that the company should be able to easily, I would say, treble the current top line and the overall financial performance over the next 2 to 3 years.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: On the inverter, I'd also like to add something, Deepak, that if you look at the inverter acquisition and the strategic partnership with Syrma SGS, you would see that Syrma SGS is already having 14 factories in India into electronic component manufacturing. They're getting into PCB manufacturing.

So, at Premier, we really value partnership and the strength which we are getting with Syrma SGS coming in is backward integration, more adherence to Make in India where we would actually be sourcing PCBs from within India once Syrma starts manufacturing PCBs. And when

you spoke about channel network, KSolare itself is a 13-year-old company having its own channel network.

So, basically, we are doubling our channel network between Premier and Ksolare on the retail side. Ksolare also does OEM for some large brands in India, which also is adding to our strength of contract manufacturing as an OEM partner. So, I think we can move to transformers now.

Vinay Rustagi: So, I think on transformers your question was about, I think, indirectly about valuation. So I think...

Deepak Krishna: I think more on forward, yes, I guess. So, maybe just on valuation. I'm sorry, you can go ahead.

Vinay Rustagi: No, sure. So, as you can see from the presentation the company is actually expanding the capacities to about 16.75 GVA from the current base of 2.5 GVA. So, there is almost a 7 to 8 fold increase in capacity. The company has a very, very strong order book. Execution is actually very, very strong. So, we have seen even over the last six months results, the numbers are significantly up over FY25.

And at the same time, the company is moving up the value chain by moving to the more attractive HV, EHV, and other MB products. And basically our plan is to be, again able to offer transformers to our customers and offer synergies in that respect, reducing the cost of customer acquisition.

In terms of revenues and PAT given the current run rate, the planned capacity ramp up, again our expectation is to actually more than quadruple the financial numbers and the overall performance over a period of about 3 years.

Deepak Krishna: Sure. Maybe just one thing on the strong order book growth that we have seen this quarter. We have seen a large addition in cells, lesser in modules. Is it just because cells are more longer cycle and modules are more shorter cycle is because of people blocking capacity for about a year, year and a half, is that the way we should look at it or are we increm

entally trying to be

more of a sort of a cell supplier to the various guys, module guys or sorry, rooftop solar guys or how should we sort of imply this to jump more in cells and less in modules?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think Deepak, you're right there. There is more of capacity blocking for cells going forward over the next 12 months to 18 months, because several module manufacturers who are not getting into cell or who have not have plans to do cell manufacturing want to block capacities. And then they look up to tying up with high quality, high efficiency cell supply contract and that is where we have seen an increased growth in cell orders.

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Deepak Krishna: Yes, those are the questions. I'll just get back on the queue. Best of luck for future quarters.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Deepak. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities Limited. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Yes, thank you so much for taking my question. My first question is, are you looking to expand into United States still, given that it makes much more sense now with all the duties?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi, Nidhi. So, I think that's a good point. So, obviously, there has been, the US policy has been quite unpredictable. But there have been a lot of changes in terms of the, higher rate sales, tariffs on other countries, anti-dumping duty investigations going on. So, we had put our old plans on hold while all these changes were going on.

But now, I think as we begin to kind of get more clarity, it does seem like, making it in making the US is going to be very attractive, particularly as the IR incentives for manufacturers will stay until almost until 2030, '31, '32. Also, I think you would understand, you would know that in the US, between the cell and the modules, there is already sufficient capacity for modules, but the market remains terribly undersupplied on the cell side.

So, basically, our current analysis suggests that US is an attractive market for local manufacturing. We are doing a lot of work internally to assess the market, get some policy clarifications, understand the execution issues, etc. So, we are studying the market. And at the right time, we will make a decision whether to go ahead with it or not.

Nidhi Shah: All right. My second question is that given that, the transformer company that we have acquired is also doing capex. We have a lot of capex upcoming in the next couple of years. What is our capex requirement for the next 2 years, year-wise, FY '27 and FY '28?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so maybe I'll take this question, Chiranjeev here. So, as of now, we feel that, our cash flows are quite healthy. And most of the capex spend what we're doing is coming in for internal accruals. We don't plan to take any new debt. In fact, we are working towards making the company debt-free gradually over time. So, we don't see any concern with the healthy cash flows coming in in terms of capex deployment.

Nidhi Shah: And would you be able to give, like, a ballpark number as to what capex you're looking at for FY '27 and FY '28?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, this keeps changing based on the plans. Now, you see we have announced the input wafer because government has sent out the draft guidelines for ALMM list three. So, and also the scale capacity we have increased. We have advanced by almost 18 months the target of 10 gigawatt. We could achieve, efficiencies in terms of the scale in increasing the capacity from, 4.8 to 7 gigawatt. So, Vinay, you would like to add something here?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So, I think it is really quite simple. So, over the next, I would say, 12 months, our big project is going to be the 7 gigawatt cell line and the 5.6 gigawatt module line. Together, the Premier Energies Limited
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capex on these is going to be about INR4,000

crores. In addition to that, the next priority thereafter is basically the input wafer project, which is about 5 gigawatts in the first phase and 5 gigawatts in the second phase. Bulk of that capex will basically come after the next 12 months, and that will be a capex of somewhere around INR6,000 crores.

So, that is the kind of big -- big numbers. Rest of that, there will be some marginal capex here and there on incremental upgrades and, other businesses. And, of course, there is a BESS capex also. Again, BESS, we have laid out quite clearly in 2 Phases. One is till June next year, which is about INR300 crores, and then another nine months after that, another INR300 crores. So, these are the kind of three main items for capex until 2028.

Nidhi Shah: Awesome. Yes. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nitin Arora from Axis Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Nitin Arora: Hi. Good morning, team. Just two things I wanted to know. One, we looked at your revenue for this quarter. So, given strong backlog, it looked a little slower ramp up on the revenue side. If you can throw some light, was it related to something on the client side? Number one.

And number two, when you -- given a press release in the presentation, you stated about 4.8 and 2 gigawatt of cell getting commissioned in June and September '26. This, I think, earlier was planned to achieve the cell capacity in FY '28. So, have we pre-poned this? And what has led to this pre-ponement? Is it like the efficiency what you are getting in terms of faster capex or were the earlier plans were different? So, if you can throw some light on that.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Thank you. So, despite a full order book and a very strong production number, it was flat for two reasons, right? One is because of unprecedented rains customer sites were not ready to receive deliveries, causing certain negatives. And then we had the reduction in the GST rates, which is a big, big advantage for our IPP customers and they wanted shipments to be postponed beyond 22nd of September.

So, this is kind of a temporary lift. Production numbers have actually increased as per our plan, thereby causing increase in the FG inventory levels. And you would see this getting cleared out in this quarter. So, there is no way slower ramp up as such.

Your other question on the justification to expand cell capacity. So, we feel that many companies have announced cell manufacturing plans. Most of this new capacity will take two to three years to come online and ramping up. So, with the demand being so strong and an attractive market opportunity to be captured in this period, we had actually gone back to the drawing board and seen that our building and utility design were anywhere ready for the enhanced capacity.

And therefore, we took a decision that we would increase this from 4.8 to 7 with a nominal incremental capex and we'll be able to pull this off quickly. That is, by September 26th, we increase capacity. 4.8 comes in June. And you're right that the original plan was to achieve 10 gigawatt in FY '28. We've actually advanced this target by 18 months.

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Nitin Arora: Okay. Please go ahead, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And I said this will be internal accruals, no new debt being taken.

Nitin Arora: Got it. Just one thing I wanted to know. Sorry, just I have one question on the cell. It's a follow up. Just one question. When we look at the DCR portal, which I don't know, sometimes it becomes very misleading because the cell utilization, what you're showing in your presentation, is very different from the DCR.

And even for other companies as well, it's like 0.1 gigawatt going to 0.2 gigawatt. So, it's like a 100% jump, but overall utilization is very low. The question was that the new cell which you have commissioned, you think by Q3 end, by December, this new cell of 1.2 gig

awatt will be

going towards 80%-90% utilization?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, we have clearly indicated that the lines are getting ramped up and by December, we will reach full utilization, almost full utilization.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Subramaniam Yadav from SBI Life Insurance.

Subramaniam Yadav: So, I just wanted to understand the incremental INR300 crores of inventory you have built up is largely because of delay in the shipment, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: That's right.

Subramaniam Yadav: Yes. Okay. And sir, just to understand on the cell realization front, because we refer the DCR portal and as you explained that the number is misleading. So, just to understand some flavor, how much realization has improved quarter-on-quarter, if you can give some color on that, because as per our calculation, it is a decrease? So, it would be really helpful.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, Mr. Subramaniam, I think the calculation which is as per you, which is based on the DCR portal, we have clarified that the DCR portal just talks about sales done, it doesn't show the clear demarcation if the sale of cell has been an intercompany sale. So, which means that data is incorrect.

But if you want to understand what has happened on quarter-on-quarter, the cell realization is marginally increased and not decreased. When I say marginally increased, it's a very small number, but there's no reduction we have seen in the selling prices.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay. Okay. Sir, the DCR sale of...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Mr. Subramaniam. If you have a follow-up question, please rejoin the queue.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mayur Patel from 360 One AMC. Please go ahead.

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Mayur Patel: Congratulations, Chiranjeev and the team for again a stellar performance and it's happening to see 18 months advancement of the expansion plan. I have just two questions. One, this 1.2 gigawatt new facility, have we achieved our desired level of efficiency or it is still in the stabilization mode?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It is still in the stabilization mode. We are almost there. We will achieve full ramp up and stabilization by December.

Mayur Patel: Okay. And that would -- what should be the ultimate efficiency which you would be targeting in this new TOPCon facility?

Chiranjeev Saluja: We are targeting an efficiency of over 25.2 to 25.4, above 25.2.

Mayur Patel: And just lastly, BESS, what is the scalability we should assume next year say for FY '27 in terms of revenue, or if you can give any insight about what's the scalability in the first year of operation in BESS?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. I will leave it to Vinay to answer this.

Vinay Rustagi: Hi, Mayur. So, we are expecting the first phase of the BESS line which is 6 gigawatt hours to be completed by June of next year. There will be obviously a slightly slow ramp up and this line would effectively be capable of producing about 4 gigawatt hours of end products.

So, we would expect very roughly about 50% annual report, say somewhere between 2 to 3 gigawatt hour in FY '27. And the realizations in the industry currently are at about, I would say, somewhere around INR60 lakhs to INR65 lakhs, depending on exact specifications, duty rates, etcetera. So that will give us a turnover of about, if you use that simple math, that will be equivalent to about INR1,000 crores plus of revenues in the first year.

Mayur Patel: Got it. Thank you so much. I'll join right back to queue. Thanks.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you, Mayur.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Mahawar from UBS. Please go ahead.

Amit Mahawar: Yes, sir. Hi. Congratulations on a great operational set of results.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Amit.

Amit Mahawar: I just have two quick -- yes, two quick questions. First is, seemingly the domestic demand can be

very, very strong if we go by the policy framework, the off-take, you know, YTD on solar.

And your capacity expansion plans are also going on the same, the way we are preponing to capture maximum value.

Sir, how do you think the dynamics playing out in China on anti-involution, the local government, you know, central government there in China stand impacting the profitability for us? Because there is a point till which we can localize and integrate. So, any color on that first?

That's the first question.

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Vinay Rustagi: Yes, sure, Amit. So, I think China, again, is a little bit unpredictable in the short run because of the changes, as you mentioned. There is a very strong effort by the companies who've been making these losses, which are unsustainable in the long run. And now the government has also got involved.

There is an attempt together with the government to try and boost profitability of the segment. Now, the counter, so and obviously, polysilicon prices have gone up and there have been consequent increases in wafer prices and cell prices also.

But the counter to that argument is that demand in China is slowing down with the move now to market tariffs as against feed-in tariffs until June of this year. Exports to US have completely stopped. Exports to India, modular exports have completely stopped now. And cell exports are very strong right now, but they will also kind of come down and get phased out over the next 2 years.

So, while the government is trying to reduce capacity or improve prices, there is a big negative impact on the industry, on the Chinese industry in terms of slowing down of demand. So, I think our view is kind of very hard to say and we will have to see how things develop. But our view is generally that the prices have nearly stabilized and don't have much more room to go up from current levels.

Amit Mahawar: Sure. Thank you very much. That's very helpful. Second and quick question is on the expansions that companies are planning in India, right. Module is a gone case now, and the focus is now on cell integration and then wafer and got eventually. The cash flows currently are very, very strong, but these are bound to change.

So the profitability and the cash translation that we will see in the next 2, 3 years might be very different than the current case, even despite the integration that top three for incumbents achieve. So, any color on how should we see where will this settle in the next 2, 3 years, assuming local demand still stays at 30, 40 gigawatt annually. So any color on some dynamics of what cash we translate, the returns that we make, that changing, the way capacities are coming. So any color on that, sir. Thank you.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, I'll take this question. I think it's very difficult to give a forward looking guidance as a previous perspective. But if you talk of industry, we have actually given an earlier presentation also a report from Bloomberg, which talks about what the deployment capacity in India would be by 2035, if I'm not mistaken. And this is showing a very strong demand.

And to your question on module, you know, getting more and more difficult, you're right. The story is getting more into backward integration. And we have taken the step towards enhancing cell capacity and achieving our targets 18 months in advance. And within 2 to 3 years, I think the story will move from cell to ingot wafer. And then the ingot wafer, you know, ramping up and scale would play a very key role. Would you like to add something, Vinay?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, I think, Amit, on the, see, I think, 1, 2, 3 years is a pretty long time in the context of this industry, very difficult to foresee. But, you know, a few things will likely to happen. One, while Premier Energies Limited
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yes, you're right, more capacity will come up, leading to these fe

ars about oversupply and margins going down.

But at the same time, there'll be two other counterweights. You know, one is that there'll be further emphasis on backward integration. And it remains to be seen how many of these new companies can backward integrate into ingot wafer, particularly at the kind of scale they're operating at.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Even ramp up of cell lines.

Vinay Rustagi: That's right. So, you know, we have seen, for example, with the implementation of ALMM-2, many of the smaller module suppliers, particularly those with outdated obsolete capacities, are going to be stranded and eventually go out of business. I think the same kind of trend will also play out in the cell business because the cell technology is also changing.

So, for example, increasingly the talk is about perovskites, new tandem technologies, back contacts, etcetera. We ourselves, you know, while all our new lines are going to be TOPCon, but we're already thinking of investing in R&D. We are exploring tie ups. We're trying to adopt new technologies over this 2 to 3 year kind of time frame.

So, while these new capacities come up, our expectation is that we would have leapfrogged in comparison with our scale adoption of new technologies and the backward integration that we are planning. So, I think -- and these are the three, I would say, fundamental pillars that will determine the overall competitiveness of all the players in the long run.

So, you know, given what Chiranjeev just said in terms of sorting demand and these factors, we

feel that some of these concerns about margins going down are a little bit overdone.

Amit Mahawar: Thank you and good luck, sir.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you, Amit.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Raman KV from Sequent Investments. Please go ahead.

Raman KV: Sir, I just have two questions. One is with respect to the margins with the new business lines like inverter and transformer and BESS. What are the margins we expect?

Vinay Rustagi: So, hi, Raman. In terms of these businesses, fundamentally very different businesses from cell and modules, obviously. You know, BESS, I would say, what we are entering into right now in the first stage will be an assembly business where we will basically be assembling, importing cells, converting them into battery packs and eventually container -- containerized solutions. There, the margin, if you look at it purely as like EBITDA by sales or PBT by sales, will be lower in comparison to our current business, which is basically cell and module, but close to the module assembly business. And for transformers, but I think the key thing there, again, to look at is your capital employed.

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You know, given that it is an assembly line business, the fixed asset turnover will be actually very, very high, something like between 7x to 10x. And the result of that will be that the overall return from capital will still be very attractive in line with the current business.

On the transformer side, I think, again, we will see the margins actually going up over the next few years because of the shift towards higher value-added and larger, more specialized products.

So, again, it is difficult to give any kind of guidance, but I can just tell you that in the industry, all the analysis that we have done, the leading players make EBITDA margins of somewhere between 20% to 25%, again, with very healthy return on capital employed. So, you know, we would be hoping that we will be able to keep these numbers.

Raman KV: And what about inverters?

Vinay Rustagi: So, inverter business, again, fundamentally speaking, is going to be very structurally similar to module assembly or BESS assembly business, i.e., you know, lower margins on a percentage of sales, high fixed asset turnover, and attractive return on capital employed.

Raman KV: And my second question is,

I just want to understand this, the new acquisition which you made with respect to the transformer company. So, from the PBT, what I can understand is, in the acquired entity, the capacity will ramp up to 4.2 gigawatts.

And then there is another JV form with respect to the new, the acquired entity, and the management team, which is of 72% to 28% JV. In that, you will add 10 gigawatt, 10 GVA capacity. So, effectively, what will be the premium energy share in this entire totality of the business?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Raman, just a small clarification. First of all, the 4.2 gigawatt -- 4.25 GVA is addition on the current capacity. So, the total capacity will actually go up to 16.75 by June of -- April of next year. In terms of, you know, our share, so we are obviously 51% shareholder in, at the top level, which is the Transcon in level. And then, effectively, if you just do a simple math, 51% into 72% at the Neotrafo level. So, our share of revenues and profits will be pro-rata on that basis.

Raman KV: So, that will be effectively around 37%, right?

Vinay Rustagi: Of the Neotrafo business in terms of the profit, the bottom line, yes.

Raman KV: Yes, yes.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. But it also depends on the capacity, right? The majority of the 10 gigawatt is coming into that line.

Raman KV: Correct.

Chiranjeev Saluja: But it is a subsidiary of Transcon Limited. And, you know, we being the majority owners, the entire top line will be controlled.

Raman KV: Okay. Understood, sir. Thank you. Thank you so much.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Puneet from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Puneet: Thank you so much. My first question is on your capacity expansion on the cell side. And you initially in your comments talked about this being brownfield and coming at significantly lower cost. Can you talk, how much will it cost versus a greenfield?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, hi, Puneet. Yes. So, we will, you know, the 4.8 to 7 gigawatt, the incremental capex which we are incurring is about INR502 crores. And as we clarified in this call earlier, our existing 4.8

gigawatt line had additional capacities in terms of utilities, land, the power connectivity, and that's how it really helped us in terms of scaling up to just adding equipment. The initial design of our 4.8 gigawatt had adequate space left for expansion. Now, with the result that, you know, overall on a per gigawatt basis, we have seen a 23% saving in our capex, and then in looking at the demand, a call which we have taken in the interest of the company and the strong order book.

Puneet: Interesting. That's very helpful. And secondly, on BESS...

Chiranjeev Saluja: Puneet, it's going to be India's single largest, single location, 7 gigawatt cell line, TOPCon line in one building.

Puneet: Okay. The entire 7 gigawatt will be housed in one location?

Chiranjeev Saluja: In one block, yes.

Puneet: Okay. That's very interesting. And on the BESS side, are you, you know, all -- before that, on the cell side, what kind of timeline are you building in for executing the order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the existing order book, it spans between 12 to 18 months.

Puneet: 12 to 18 months. Okay. That's all from my side. Thank you so much and all the best.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Apoorva from IIFL Capital. Please go ahead.

Apoorva: Hi, thank you for the opportunity, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Hi, Apoorva.

Apoorva: I wanted to understand if the recent rise in silver prices is going to have any impact on our margins going ahead and if you can quantify that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, yes, silver prices have gone up substantially. There has been a marginal increase in our BOM cost, but looking at the operational efficiency which we have achieved, there has been no impact on our margins with respect to silver.

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We do keep even hedging silver at various intervals. We have not seen any effect on margins because of this as of today. And going forward also, we feel that with the operational efficiency which we are reaching in terms of scale, we don't see any problem there.

Apoorva: Understood. And also on your ingot wafer capacity plans, can you help us with the execution and then the stabilization timelines expected over there?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we have, you know, charted out a plan to have this commissioned by December 2027. The original plan was to set up a 2 gigawatt wafer by June '26. We have now expanded this to a 5 gigawatt ingot wafer instead of just a 2 gigawatt wafer. And, you know, this is because of the announcement and the push by the government for Make in India and the ALMM list three draft guidelines. Maybe, Vinay, can add something to this.

Vinay Rustagi: No, I think that explains it, Apoorva. So, you know, we have always maintained that the government is extremely committed to Make in India and becoming self-sufficient in the solar sector. So as expected, a very well thought out ALMM-3 draft has come out.

And we expect the final policy announcement also to be made imminently because of which, you know, we get the confidence to kind of accelerate our plans and announce the first phase for completion by December 2027. In terms of, you know, ramp up, we would again expect very much like a cell line. The first line may take about close to about, 4 to 6 months for ramp up, which will help us eventually in the second phase in any future capacities.

Apoorva: So, the stabilization should happen in four to six months?

Vinay Rustagi: After the lines are fully built out, yes.

Apoorva: Okay, okay. So maybe first half calendar year '28. Understood. And for the new order bookings that we have done, obviously, the number has increased quite a lot. What is the realization and the margin profile you are seeing over there for DCR modules? Are you seeing any pressure over there because capacities are coming or do this remain steady at INR0.24, I think?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think we don't see a major difference there in realization. And of course, the contracts are generally variable in nature with the link to wafer prices. But overall, we don't see any major change in the realization.

Apoorva: Should we expect 30% margin for this entire order book? I'm going ahead for cells...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Apoorva.

Apoorva: And it's a follow-up question.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, Yes. So, Apoorva it's very difficult to give a future guidance on margins. But yes, generally, we would want to say something.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, but I think the only thing to clarify, again, which we have also said earlier is that, you know, the overall outlook for sales of the DCR modules remains very strong. And that is obviously

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going to be the more increasingly, more focus of the business going forward. So there, the margins are very steady, if anything.

You know, like we said earlier, the margins actually went up in the last quarter. On the non-DCR modules, you know, obviously, there is a little bit of an overcapacity there. And even there, the prices are stable.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Margins have slightly gone down, you know, with recent changes, particularly, for example, the cell price increases etcetera. But again, most of the cell prices increases have been passed on to our clients. And we kind of see, we'll see how things develop from here.

Amit Gupta: I understood. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ketan Jain from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Ketan Jain: Thank you. Thank you for the opportunity, sir. Congratulations on a very good set of results. My first question is just your view on how do you look at this, tha

t ALMM-2 or the DCR module

results in a higher cost of solar tariffs by around INR0.30 to INR0.40 paisa, and which might again be increased with the ALMM-3 introduction as well. So, what makes you think that there won't be any push back from the industry, because in the end the price has borne by the consumer, by the retail.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, how do you look at this?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Ketan, the ALMM-2 timelines have been known since December 24. It has been a long time. Obviously, there was an amendment issued about 2 months ago on that. But in terms of how that is going to play out and the impact and cost, etcetera we can already see, by and large, the tariffs which have been bid out in the solar sector have been very stable. Increasingly, obviously, there are no more standalone tenders. Most of the bids now are some kind of hybrid design, solar plus BESS or solar plus wind plus BESS.

And there, again, you can see the tariffs are at all-time low levels. Even solar plus 2R BESS and 4R BESS are now less than INR3. So, you know, other example I can -- you know, other anecdote I can give you in terms of very minimal impact on tariffs is our own open access projects.

We have been planning to develop captive projects for our own needs. And there, as you know, from June 2026 onwards, all projects completed thereafter have to comply with ALMM-2. And based on our studies, the increase in cost of power is of the order of about INR0.10.

So, that is, I would say, a very small increase, and the market is very easily able to absorb that. You know, all the discussions with clients basically show that the demand for renewables remains very strong, and there is no concern related to cost of ALMM-2 or ALMM-3 implementation.

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Ketan Jain: Understood. understood. Thank you. And most of my questions have been answered. Just two bookkeeping questions. One, what would be our percentage of silver, cost of silver in the BOM for cell, for manufacturing the cell?

Vinay Rustagi: I think, you know, all the different kind of paste we use, it was about \$0.01 a watt about a year ago, which has now gone to somewhere around \$1.4 to \$1.45 at present.

Ketan Jain : Understood. Just the last question, what would be our mix of cells used for captive use and sold outside in the first half of FY '26?

Chiranjeev Saluja: This keeps changing. It is very dynamic. So, we would not be able to give you a number on this.

Ketan Jain: Understood. Okay. Okay. fine. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Subramaniam Yadav from SBI Life Insurance. Please go ahead.

Subramaniam Yadav: Thank you. So, just again wanted to understand on the gross margin front, because we have seen improvement in this quarter with the last quarter, despite of silver paste cost going up. And when you look at the sale of TCR module also has come down. So, just wanted to tally this thing. Is there anything specific here or cell realization has improved much because of that your gross margin is higher.

Vinay Rustagi: Hi, Subramaniam. So, first thing I would say is that changes in margins are not particularly large. So, I think, I don't think and they've come from many different reasons, including a greater proportion of cells sold in this quarter. And then, of course, because of the increasing volumes, we also see some efficiencies, particularly on the sales side, as well as fixed cost operating leverage in the business.

So, I think those are the two main reasons why there was a marginal increase in gross margins.

But overall, I still want to kind of add that the overall prices and the outlook for particularly cells and DCR modules remains stable and the margins are at the current levels. I mean, you will see any changes that you see on a quarter-to-quarter basis can arise from one of the changes in the business mix in that specific quarter.

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Subramaniam Yadav: Okay. Just a booking question on the depreciation and other income front. Because we are commissioned to one module and one cell plant in the last two quarters, but still the depreciation is coming down. Is there some change in policy again or other income has also stooped or not, if you can explain this?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, on depreciation, Mr. Subramaniam, we depreciate some of our equipment on an accelerated depreciation basis. So, there has been a slight variance in the depreciation, because on certain equipment, what we had embarked on actually depreciation has been completed. But then this keeps on changing based on our evaluation of specific equipment.

So, that's where you see a slight change in the depreciation on the other income, we have -- other income is largely because of forex gains. Generally, forex gain has been favorable in the last

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quarter. INR has depreciated from 85.7 to around 88 during this quarter. And this has resulted in a gain in the other income.

Subramaniam Yadav: Can you quantify the other forex gain?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sorry?

Subramaniam Yadav: Can you quantify the forex gain?

Chiranjeev Saluja: We would not be able to quantify a number. But -- yes.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay, okay. Fine. Thank you. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Mohit Kumar: Yes, sir. Sir, one clarification on Transcon. There seems to be a competing business, Sealwel Group, right, which also does the manufacturing of transformer, right? And the second clarification is that EBITDA has been declining for last 3 years on Transcon Industries, right.

Can you just help us with the synergy between our business and Transcon business which leads to a higher growth and operating profit?

Chiranjeev Saluja: And what is this Sealwel Group?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, Mohit, we did not understand the first part of the question. Can you please?

Mohit Kumar: I think there is a company-to-business pathway of the same group, right? Is it correct?

Vinay Rustagi: We are not aware of any other sister or group company of Transcon.

Mohit Kumar: Understood. I think we are reading somewhere the Sealwel Corporation Private Limited, high power electrical industry and Transcon Industries together....

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, that is, I think, yes, I understand now, Mohit. You are talking about the partnership firm which Transcon was running, which was in the slump sale was done to Transcon Unlimited, and there is no connection with those companies anymore. They do come under related party, but if any related party transaction is done, it is going to be arm's length.

Mohit Kumar: Understood. My second question on Transcon, the EBITDA has been declining for last 3 years, right? So, what is, so what will lead for, what is our right to win, right?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Amit, sorry, Mohit, this is a company which actually has a very strong execution capability over 20 years of track record. And like I said, you know, the current run rate of the company is extremely strong. There is a growing order book. And last year the company delivered EBITDA of about INR30 crores, and this year we are expecting a significant growth in that number.

So, going forward, we are expecting strong growth, not just from the current capacity, but also, obviously, from the expanded capacity going up by about 6x over the next few months, next 6

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months. In terms of synergies, see, a lot of the growth in the transformer business is directly or indirectly aligned with the growth in the renewable energy capacity. Our analysis, all the work that we have done shows basically that for every gigawatt of capacity that is added into the grid, there is a, you know, 10x the 10 GVA is the demand for transfor

mers.

And now, given that about 80% of the capacity installation is now coming from renewables, there is a tremendous synergy in offering these transformers, different range, inverter duty transformers, HV and EHV transformers to the same clients who we are selling our modules,

and increasingly, we'll be selling inverters and best solutions as well. So, I think there are great synergies and customers, same for many of these products. And that is why it makes sense for us to make this, go for this acquisition.

Mohit Kumar: Understood, sir. Thank you and all the best. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you, Mohit.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sanjay Mookim from JP Morgan. Please go ahead.

Sanjay Mookim: Hi, gentlemen. Hi, good morning. A couple of questions from my end.

Vinay Rustagi: Good morning, Sanjay.

Sanjay Mookim: Hi. A couple of questions. The order book has grown very substantially this quarter. It's a very large order book now compared to current revenues. Can I ask about the dynamics of this book?

How firm are these orders? Do they guarantee a margin as they are executed, or do you carry margin or pricing risks on these order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the contracts on the order book, which we generally share with the shareholders in the market, is firm order books. We never account for any framework or orders which have a possibility of order cancellation clauses. The prices and the margins are fairly protected, and any change in, forex or wafer pricing is passed on to the customer because these are variable kind of contracts with a pass-through. So, yes, I think that should answer your question, Sanjay.

Sanjay Mookim: No, thanks, Chiranjeev. And if I may follow-up, and I'll, you know, perhaps push you a bit on this, Chiranjeev, is now that this order book is visible, and like I said, it's several quarters worth of revenue. Would you be able to guide to a margin outlook since you have such a large order book?

Chiranjeev Saluja: As a Board policy, we don't. And I think I'd like to, you know, say no for this question, Sanjay.

Sanjay Mookim: Of course, no, no, I was just trying to. The second question, if I may, Chiranjeev. One of the utility companies recently on their call have sounded a little bearish on new tendering for solar projects. And they've suggested that only 5 gigawatts of renewable was tendered in the first half of FY '26, and that about 40 gigawatts of previously tendered solar do not yet have PPAs. Do you see this as like a temporary phase of slowdown before the government figures out the new policy environment?

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Vinay Rustagi: Sanjay, hi. This is Vinay here.

Sanjay Mookim: Hi, Vinay.

Vinay Rustagi: So I think, if you have an IPP, if you're a new IPP trying to bid for projects and build up a business pipeline, then I can understand that the outlook is not great, because there is a bit of a slowdown in new tender issuance and auctions. But if you're an IPP, which has been in the business for, I would say, 3 years or more, then I think you have nothing to be concerned about, because most likely you have a great pipeline of business and a lot of execution coming up over the next two to 3 years.

So just to give you some numbers, there is, you know, currently about more than 100 gigawatts of solar capacity which has been auctioned and allocated to developers. This is only the utility scale. We're not talking about rooftop or open access or KUSUM scheme here. And even accounting for the fact that as per the press, the 30 or 40 gigawatts of projects which have not been kind of getting converted into PPAs, there is still a large backlog of these projects which are due for execution over the next 2 to 3 years.

And you see that in the execution run rate and the capacity addition that we see on a month-on-month basis. All the leading developers, if you just look at, you

know, what is their current

business vis-a-vis the wins that they have, for all the developers, the number is something like – the pipeline is something like 1.5x to 2x of their existing business. So I think, if you are an established IPP or if you're a module equipment supplier like us, there is a very strong visibility of demand and growth in this segment.

Sanjay Mookim: Great. That's very useful. Thank you, Vinay.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harsh Misra from Bernstein. Please go ahead.

Harsh Misra: Hello. Am I audible?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, you are, Harsh.

Harsh Misra: Yes. And congratulations on the good set of numbers. I just had one question. So regarding ALMM-2 demand, rooftop remains very strongly mentioned, but for utility scale ALMM-2 demand, the timeline is now only for tenders after September 2025. So no such tender has concluded until now?

Vinay Rustagi: So, that's right. You know, these -- as we were discussing, the activity on the new tenders remains very small. And for utility scale projects -- now, you know, I want to clarify one thing. While the government issued this announcement, the relaxation from shifting the implementation or

the bid cutoff date from December '24 to September '25, the government has also subsequently issued a clarification that all the projects which were bid out in the intervening period where the tenders had a specification that the bidders have to use ALMM-2 modules will still have to use ALMM-2 modules.

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So for those projects, and you know, I think we would expect all those tenders to actually already have that clause, because that is the policy design. So the government has effectively clarified that even projects bid before September '25 will have to comply with ALMM-2 as long as the tenders had stipulated set conditions.

So overall, we think that the ALMM-2 implementation timeline and the clarity is there now.

And of course, from early next year, we will start seeing all the rooftop solar and the C&I segment demand also coming into the market, because of which we expect a very strong demand growth over the next 2 to 3 years for ALMM-2 strobe DCR modules.

Harsh Misra: Okay, got it. Just one last thing. For the big jump in orders, that's of course excellent. Do we have a sense of the realization for the DCR and non-DCR part of the pipeline?

Chiranjeev Saluja: We just clarified that the margins remain similar to what they are today. And these are backed up by variable clauses in terms of forex and wafer. But we would not like to make any future guidance as such, you know. But we, I mean, as an overall sector, we are clear that the demand is quite strong.

Harsh Misra: Okay, thank you. That's all. All the best for the next quarter.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Harsh.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from SUD Life. Please go ahead.

Anupam Goswami: Good morning, sir. Sir, my first question under industry, given that new cell capacities are also on the line, and how do you see the operational capacities, efficiency, as well as the quality compared to the Tier 1 and the Tier 2 players in this? And do we see any shift or preference to Tier 1 main cell as ours?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, I think that's a good question. With new capacities coming in, we have always been clear that new cell lines do take time to ramp up and stabilize. And TOPCon is more difficult compared to Mono PERC. And small lines, which are the scales of maybe 1 or 2 gigawatts, would become not quite viable.

So there is going to be a clear differentiator over the next 24 months in terms of players having experience, high quality, efficiency scale, and continuous investment in future technology. So all this is going to play out in a big way.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, and Anupam, one of the learnings that we've had over the years is

that the large IPP clients,

they want to work with companies, suppliers with proven track record, offering the latest technology and the best products. And we can see that even in the non-DCR segment, where there is already concern about huge overcapacity, etcetera. But despite that, clients are happy to work with us.

We are signing large orders for non-DCR modules at current price levels. And obviously, with the shift towards ALMM-2 products, which are technically much more complex and

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challenging, we would expect this trend to actually strengthen over a period of time. So clients would naturally gravitate towards suppliers with, you know, bankable suppliers, offering scale and the best technology. So I think we definitely will see some preference for companies like offering these characteristics.

Anupam Goswami: Can this be interpreted to smaller players sticking only to rooftop demand while the utility scales IPP then? C&I customers will go for the Tier 1 with a large capacity and operation and execution?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So it depends on the capacity, you know, demand and supply. So if large players are able to scale as we are to 10 gigawatt, and for all you know, if the demand is good, we may even go beyond 10. We have enough land and facilities available. So it would depend on which market which they would be able to address.

Vinay Rustagi: See, I mean, they may not have a choice, but to compete only in the rooftop market. But even there, companies such as ourselves will be extra competitive because of our scale, procurement advantage, operating efficiencies, best technology, etcetera. So, we are ourselves focusing on building out the retail business, as we said earlier.

And again, all the feedback from industry is very, very positive. Demand for our products remains very strong. So because of these reasons, we believe that we will be able to compete and offer better overall, better product at a better price in comparison to the smaller players.

Anupam Goswami: The last question, given the ALMM-2 implementation, do we see in the near-term, any shortage of supply given a backlog and of demand and backlog of approvals and sanctions also? So do you see the next year, last 6 months or 8 months, do we see any short supply?

Vinay Rustagi: So your question is about short supply of domestic sales for ALMM modules?

Anupam Goswami: Yes.

Vinay Rustagi: So, current cell capacity in India is about 27 gigawatt. And the current run rate in terms of production is about 16, 17 gigawatts per annum. These capacities are obviously many new players have announced new capacities. And our expectation is that by the end of 2027, we should be able to have a total capacity of about 80 gigawatts in the cell business.

Production obviously would be much lower because of all the ramp up time and stabilization time are taken by these companies. So I think there will be a dynamic, you know, changing from quarter to quarter in terms of overall demand supply. But the overall theme going forward remains that the market should remain tight, protecting volumes and margins for products.

Anupam Goswami: Yes, hi. Okay, sir.

Vinay Rustagi: [Inaudible 1:09:22] question.

Anupam Goswami: Yes, thank you, sir. I'll join.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shrinidhi from ASK Investment Managers. Please go ahead.

Shrinidhi: Yes. Hi. Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on great set of numbers. Sir, I was wondering, would it be possible to give some color on what percentage of your cell production next year is likely for external module manufacturers?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it's seemingly difficult to answer this question because this keeps changing based on the dynamics quarter-on-quarter. So we would not be able

to give you a firm number on this.

Shrinidhi: But some broad range are given you have a very firm large order backlog compared to your capacity. Even some broad numbers should be fine, just from modeling perspective.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, about 50-50.

Shrinidhi: 50, right. And, sir, I'm presuming as the time passes, more and more cell required for your own module manufacturing will be internally producing -- internally produced. Wondering this development, first of all, it's correct assumption. And second, will it be contribution profit accretive or it would be more like neutral to dilutive?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it is going to be dynamic, right? I mean, let us say we get more of non-DCR orders for our module lines, then we would sell our cels to other module manufacturers. And if we get more of DCR module orders, then we would be internally consuming them. Very difficult to give an answer on this now for the next year.

Shrinidhi: Understood. And for the 60% backlog that you have for the cell, it's all external, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Yes. So the order book which we are showing, of course, the cell orders are all external.

Shrinidhi: Right. And, sir, just give us some color on...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Shrinidhi. You have a follow-up question, then please rejoin the queue.

Shrinidhi: Sure. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deepak Krishna from Kotak Bank. Please go ahead.

Deepak Krishna: Maybe just two follow-ups. So, one was essentially on the FX gain, while Chiranjeevi indicated FX gain, but the cash flow statement shows zero FX gain. And so, MR. NK sir, if you could sort of clarify why the cash flow statement has zero FX in 1H and we are sort of seeing Q-o-Q impact. So if any sense of what that number is?

And second, just on this, the previous question that Chiranjeevi asked, essentially what is stopping us from winning the DCR module orders directly? Because we have the cell, so we should sort of be in a dominant position to win majority of the DCR module orders. Why is the case that, we are sort of being a cell supplier to someone and they are sort of winning a DCR order when they don't have cell capacity?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think, Deepak, this is mainly because if we have non-DCR orders from our long-term

clients who are independent power producers, then we do not have enough module capacity left to convert them into DCR module. And then in that situation, we would do pure cell sales.

So, as I told you, it's kind of dynamic in nature, depending on the module order book, whether it's backlog of non-DCR orders, because these are fairly large orders which we cater to and large IPPs whom we have a very long-term kind of a relationship. So it is kind of dynamic.

Vinay Rustagi: But, Deepak, just to add to that, I mean, there's nothing that prevents us directly from taking the DCR orders. But by doing that, we will be basically blocking out both our cell and module capacity, whereas, you know, because the demand for non-DCR modules remains strong, if we can get a better overall result in terms of profitability and margins by selling the cells and the non-DCR modules separately, then that is a better option. And that is what we have kind of -- we evaluate that dynamic and accordingly decide our sales mix and strategy.

Deepak Krishna: Sure. And maybe just on the FX question, if you could sort of clarify, the cash flow shows zero FX gain in this particular quarter for first half year.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Yes. Hi, Deepak. So, FX gain is basically the reinstatement of the foreign exchange, which is not realized. So if it is realized, then only it goes to the cash flow.

Deepak Krishna: Sure.

Vinay Rustagi: It is the reinstatement, it is coming as other income.

Deepak Krishna: Sure. Sure. Okay. Thanks for the clarification.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies

and gentlemen, due to time constraint, this is the last question for today. I

now hand the conference over to management for closing comments. Thank you and over to you.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you. So, you know, I just wanted to kind of say we went through, obviously, a range of questions about the company's business in terms of our expansion plans, acquisitions, government policy, etcetera. Overall, you know, our view is that the fundamentals of the business are very compelling.

Demand is showing exceptional growth. There is obviously a very strong focus of the government on domestic manufacturing. We see a lot of new initiatives to be announced covering a whole range of products, including BESS inverters, electrolyzers, etcetera. Our aim, you know, obviously there is a lot of new players coming into the sector, but our aim remains that we want to kind of focus on scale, on vertical integration, and adopting the latest technology. And we feel that, our business is poised to grow very strongly, given our plans for capacity expansion, backward integration, and diversification into new areas. So, we hope that this is -- we believe that this is a very strong investment opportunity, and we hope that you buy into our plans and support us going forward. Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you, sir. On behalf of Premier Energies Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Jan 2026

Ref: PEL 84 /2025-26

Date: January 29, 2026

To To

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Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, National Stock Exchange of India Limited
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Mumbai - 400001 Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051
Scrip Code: 544238 Trading Symbol: PREMIERENE

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter and nine months ended on December 31, 2025.

In accordance with Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we are enclosing herewith the transcript of the conference call discussing the financial results for the quarter and nine months ended on December 31, 2025. This call took place at 11:00 hours IST on Friday, 23rd January 2026.

The above information will be made available on the website of the Company.

This is for your information and records.

Thanks & Regards,
For Premier Energies Limited

Ravella Sreenivasa Rao
Company Secretary & Compliance officer

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"Premier Energies Limited
Q3 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"
January 23, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SINGH SALUJA – MANAGING
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. SUDHIR MOOLA – CHIEF STRATEGY OFFICER AND
WHOLE-TIME DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES
LIMITED
M R. NAND KISHORE KHANDELWAL – GROUP CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. VINAY RUSTAGI – CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Premier Energy's Q3 FY26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch-tone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Huda. Good morning. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the Q3 FY26 Earnings Call of Premier Energies. Today, we have with us from the management, Mr. Chiranjeev Singh Saluja, Managing Director, Mr. Nand Kishore Khandelwal, Chief Financial Officer, Mr. Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer and Mr. Sudhir Moola, Chief Strategy Officer and Whole-Time Director. We'll begin with the opening remarks from the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Thank you, Mohit. Am I audible clearly to you?

Mohit Kumar: Yes, sir. Please.

Chiranjeev Saluja: All right. Good morning, everyone and thank you for joining us today for our Q3 FY26 Earnings Call. I am Chiranjeev Saluja, Managing Director of Premier Energies and I am joined today by my colleagues.

I am pleased to say that the company has reported another set of record revenue and profit numbers. Our lines are running consistently at best in industry utilization levels, and the order book remains healthy, giving us both top line and bottom line visibility. Let me talk about some key highlights of this quarter.

We have completed a brownfield expansion, increasing our cell and module capacity by 400 megawatt and 350 megawatt, respectively. This expansion has been achieved with relatively low capex and shows our team's strong engineering capabilities. Our 1.2 gigawatt G12R TOPCon cell line has ramped up in relatively short time, currently operating at 80% utilization and expected to reach full utilization by February 2026.

Similarly, we are working on improving efficiency from current levels of 25.2% to 25.8% by the end of this year using latest process technologies and know-how. This experience will extremely be useful in launching operations of our new 7 gigawatt TOPCon cell line. We are now excited and focused on commissioning and ramping up of our new cell and module lines progressively over the next four quarters.

Our 5.6 gigawatt module line is set for completion in March 2026, 4.8 gigawatt cell line in June 2026, followed by 2.2 gigawatt of cell line in September 2026. These capacities would make us India's largest and most integrated cell and module manufacturer with total capacity of 10.6 gigawatt and 11.1 gigawatt, respectively. This would mark an inflection point in our growth journey.

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I am also pleased to share that work has also commenced on construction of our 10 gigawatt ingot wafer line in Naidupeta, Andhra Pradesh. Our transformer acquisition was completed in December 2025. Transcon is performing very well as seen in the YTD numbers, with total capacity expected to increase to 16.75 GVA by July 2026, and change in product mix towards more lucrative MVHV and EHV segments.

This business is expected to become a key growth contributor for us. Our KSolare acquisition is also planned to be closed in the next one month. Now I would want to briefly talk about two major themes of the interest to the investing community.

First, the solar industry has achieved tremendous scale, growing at more than 50% annually over the last two years. India is now the third largest solar market in the world. This growth in demand

is expected to continue, notwithstanding issues like unsigned PPAs and transmission delays.

The reality is that we have a very large pipeline of signed PPAs, providing us strong demand visibilities over the next three years. The PM-Surya Ghar rooftop solar market is seeing huge growth, with a record 2.7 million homes solarized in the last 18 months, and further 7.3 million installations expected over the next 24 months. Other market segments, like the KUSUM scheme and open access market, are also showing sustained increase in installations.

Secondly, the cost environment is becoming more volatile, with some input costs rising sharply over the last few quarters. We are able to manage this risk effectively through various measures like hedging, advanced planning, strong supplier relationships, and passing incremental costs to customers. Going forward, we are confident that we will be able to compensate for any cost increases with our increasing scale and operating efficiencies.

To conclude, we have a very exciting growth opportunity with growing demand, continued support for Make in India policy, and our focused business strategy. Thank you. Thank you. We

are now open for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin with the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Good morning. Thank you so much for taking my question. My first question is on depreciation. This quarter, we have seen that depreciation has halved by a Y-o-Y, and it was only last year in the same quarter that we revised our depreciation policy. So what can this decrease be attributed to?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, Nidhi, good morning. And your question is on depreciation. It generates a lot of uncertainty. It generally depends on, you know, the industry policy where we depreciate our equipment over five years. In our case, we have taken an accelerated depreciation on our Mono PERC lines. As we speak today, our Mono PERC lines are fully depreciated. And you will see further depreciation numbers come up once the new lines get commissioned. I would like also, Vinay, to share some views on the depreciation and the cost numbers.

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Vinay Rustagi: Yes, sure. Hi, Nidhi. So I think basically what has happened is that we did see an increase in depreciation over the last three quarters because of accelerated depreciation on our old cell and module lines.

Now that came to an end in the last quarter. So what you're seeing in this quarter is only the depreciation on our new lines, which got operational in the middle of last year. So going forward, you will see a more, I would say, a sustainable and consistent depreciation trend in line with our new assets coming online this year. And the variability will be very less going forward.

Nidhi Shah: And just to clarify, the new lines, they are being depreciated on a five-year basis with industry standards. Will that also be accelerated?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So the industry standard is basically depreciating all these assets within five years, which is what we follow. Having said that, we do continue to monitor the market and the technology trends. And if we feel that because of any of these reasons, there is an earlier phase-out expected, we then tend to undertake accelerated depreciation to transition us to the new technologies.

Nidhi Shah: My next question will be on what is the progress on the capacity addition on the aluminum-frames side? Where are we on that? And what is the capex that was undertaken in the first nine months of this year?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So on the aluminum front, the land is already acquired, Nidhi, and the equipment order has been placed. The total capex on aluminum is going to be INR260 crores, and we expect commissioning by December 2026.

Nidhi Shah: And what is the total capex that you un-

dertook in the first nine months across all?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So the total capex that you've undertaken in the past nine months you're talking about?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So that is... Yes, please go ahead.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So the total capex was about INR750 crores. That is in relation to our new cell and module lines which are coming up in Sitarampur and Naidupeta. In addition to that, we have also paid, like we have announced, INR250 crores to Transcon for the first tranche of our acquisition.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Those were my questions. Thank you so much.

Moderator: The next question is on the line of Raman KV from Sequent Investments. Please go ahead.

Raman K.V.: Yes. Good morning, sir. Congratulations on a good set of numbers. So my question is with respect to Transcon. We have an order book of INR190 crores in Transcon. And what will be the execution cycle? One is that and post the capacity expansion to 16.75 GVA by July 2026. At optimum utilization, how much revenue can we do from this Transcon?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi. So you know the typical manufacturing and order turnaround time for transformers is about four to five months for the low voltage and inverter duty transformers. And basically, you

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can see that from the total order book, we see the total –order book at five months of expected annual sales of the company. In addition, you know, going forward, the company is now venturing into the larger higher value-added transformers, so there the execution cycle will be slightly longer. But overall, the transformer business execution and progress is very, very strong. And we are hoping that the company will touch a top line of over INR1000 crores in the next two to two and a half years.

Raman K.V.: INR1,000 crores top line from only Transformers, right?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, that's right. Transformers only. Yes.

Raman K.V.: Like with the current capacity or this is including the additional capacity?

Vinay Rustagi: With the current and the proposed capacity. See what happens is the larger transformers, there is a reasonably, I would say, six to 18 month time period for certifications and winning new orders and deliveries of those orders for the customers. So, the ramp up of the new lines will happen over a period of about two to three years. And that is why I'm saying that the top line will grow to about INR1000 crores rupees plus by FY '28.

Raman K.V.: Understood, sir. So just a follow up on this, as you mentioned that we are venturing into larger heavy duty and high value-added segment in the transformers, do we have necessary approvals?

Vinay Rustagi: By approvals, you mean, so, all the expansion works...

Raman K.V.: Customer approvals.

Chiranjeev Saluja: You mean certifications? Yes. You mean certifications? Yes. Yes, that is work in progress. Yes.

Raman K.V.: And do you have a timeline by when you will receive the necessary certifications?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, by July '26, we're expecting the plant to be commissioned. It will take about six months post July '26 for us to get certifications in a progressive manner.

Raman K.V.: Understood, sir. And so I just want to understand this 10 gigawatt Ingot wafer line, what's the total capex spent on this? And by when are you expecting it to be commissioned?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so for the 10-gigawatt Ingot wafers, the total expected capex is around INR5900 crores. you know, we are still waiting for the final government announcement for ALMM three, as you probably know. What we have announced so far is the first phase of 5 gigawatt implementation expected to be completed by December next year.

For the second 5-gigawatt phase, we would expect that to be completed in December '28. But like I said, we are still waiting for the final announcement and may tweak our plans to suit the market growth.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. And just to ad

d, in the meantime, the land is acquired, the designing work is started and the building construction work also has started.

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Raman K.V.: Understood, sir. And so, my final question is with respect to are we venturing into any BESS project? Or like doing capex related to BESS project?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so we have already announced that on BESS, we are setting up a cell to pack in a containerized solution line. The land for this also has been acquired and the factory construction started. We have not announced getting into BESS cell manufacturing as of today.

We would want to wait for more clarity from Government of India. They have come up with guidelines on localization. Once we get clarity on that, then we would look at further backward integration.

Raman K.V.: And what sort of total capex spend -- will be spending on this and what will be the capacity?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it's INR280 crores and the capacity is going to be 6 gigawatt hours per phase.

Raman K.V.: So, this is just an assembly line, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: It is a cell to pack and containerized solution assembly and the final solution kind of line that we give containerized solutions to our customers. As I said, that core manufacturing of cell is something we want to go slow on until we get clarity on ALMM kind of protection from government of India. As of today, it doesn't make sense for us to invest on backward integration because the market is still now open to China.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Balasubramanian from Arihant Capital. Please go ahead. Sir, are you there? As there is no response, I'm taking the next question from the line of Praveen Sahay from PL Capital. Please go ahead.

Praveen Sahay: Yes. Hi, sir. Thank you for opportunity. Can you give a detail related to the order book of your own? You know, the model and cell bifurcation is there. How is the in the model DCR order book or non-DCR if you can give some color on that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Hi. Good morning. So, our order book as we had shared is as we speak about 9.4 gigawatts and it is a total order value of INR13,723 crores, which is going into deliveries up to FY '28.

Now, we have given the breakup on revenue-wise that the order book of cells is about INR6,800-odd crores and modules is about close to INR7,000 crores. Now, we would also like to clarify here that cell is DCR.

But when we say module, it is a mix of DCR and non-DCR both. So we evaluate and we consistently monitor how many cells need to be sold and how many need to go into our own production. So our module mix is DCR, non-DCR put together.

And also like to clarify that, the nature of this business is such that every quarter, you have an order book and you have customers whom you are selling to and there is a mix of DCR and non-DCR of sales which happen every quarter. Now, it is very difficult to estimate accurately what your DCR or non-DCR sale would be in a given quarter because it depends on various factors like customer offtake, customer site readiness.

And that is the reason that you would see a very minimal tolerance of about 4% to 5% in the overall revenue assumption versus achieved is because if I have slightly higher non-DCR sale in a particular quarter, then my revenue would slightly come down and so would be EBITDA numbers.

Now, what market needs to understand, or investors need to understand is that they should be looked upon on a yearly basis and not on a quarter-on-quarter basis because this is the nature of the business and it is impossible to predict what would be your product mix at a 100% accurate level. So, I think, am I clear to your question or any other follow up questions?

Praveen Sahay: No, it's fine sir. Just on another question that's on the cell cost, if you can give us some color on

own manufactured cell, how is the costing and versus outside you are procuring?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No, so when we procure cells from China, it's a totally different thing. It's not made in India. So, difficult to compare a China product and a domestically manufactured cell and we, I mean, for confidentiality reasons, we cannot disclose our costing for cell manufacturing.

Praveen Sahay: Okay. And lastly, sir, if you can share the capex for a entire, like a '26, how much is the total capex and '27, how much is the plan for? Sum together of everything, you know, cell, model, ingot, even the BESS?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So, for the coming, for the current calendar year, total capex is about INR3,000 crores. Part of this is for the new cell line for coming in Naidupeta and Sitarampur. In addition to that, we will also incur remaining capex for Transcon and the KSolare acquisitions plus about INR280 crores each for the BESS product and the aluminum product.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Subramaniam Yadav from SBI Life Insurance. Please go ahead.

Subramaniam Yadav: Thank you, sir, for taking my question. I just wanted to understand why our module utilization is a flattish Q-o-Q. Is there any delay from the client side or how is the order book composition?

Maybe near-term, medium-term and long-term, if you can give some flavor on that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sorry, Mr. Subramaniam, your voice is not very clear. Could you repeat the question again, please?

Subramaniam Yadav: Yes. Okay. So, just wanted to understand the color on the order book. How is the execution period in the order book? Maybe if you can say how much in medium-term and then near-term or maybe long-term kind of a breakup. Because what we are seeing is module utilization is lower this quarter. Maybe it's a flattish, if you can say, Q-on-Q. So, is there a delay from the client side for the execution or is there any other issue in that?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. So, let me first address your question on the utilization. On module utilization, we have consistently been between 75% to 80%. And on cell, we have consistently been about close to 90%, except for when our 1.2 gigawatts TCon cell line got commissioned. Now, these are best in class numbers in industry. When you compare on utilization, we are already at peak of utilization.

And it's not possible to produce this up in the expand. And as I said, our next four quarters is going to be the exception point. Now, coming to the order book. If you look at the order book, all the order books which we disclose are all signed, confirmed with advances received. These are not framework order book or pipeline which we disclose. These are order books which are signed up to FY 2028.

We are not seeing any delay from off-takers in terms of supplies. It's just that the mix sometimes gets delayed by about one or two weeks. And if that happens in the last month of the quarter, then that would reflect in that particular quarter but come back in the next quarter. So, that depends on customer off-take in terms of their site readiness, their payment receivables from the government department they sell to. So, there are a lot of factors which play out.

Subramaniam Yadav: Okay, understood, sir. Sir, also just a clarity on the inventory. Maybe at the end of Q2, we had some inventory due to the GST-related issue. So, we said some inventory was piled up. So, is that completely liquidated now or how is the situation?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, so the inventory which was carried forward in September 30th has been fully liquidated. And as I said earlier, that is not showing in the revenue number this quarter because this quarter we had slightly higher non-DCR sales compared to DCR sales. And that was because of various issues with the customers in terms of their receivables and their delay in pickup which

has now

become very positive.

In this last quarter, we have an unprecedented demand for DCR as against non-DCR. So, this keeps changing quarter-on-quarter. So, what happens is that a tolerance of about 4% to 5% because of the DCR, non-DCR mix is something which we have to live with, and it is the nature of the business.

Subramaniam Yadav: Understood, sir. Thank you, sir. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nitin Arora from Axis Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Nitin Arora: Hi, sir. Thanks for taking my question. First thing on your slide on the silver, what you put in your presentation, can you dwell a little bit because as you stated that lot of increase in the commodity prices, you know, the street was also expecting a big decline in gross margins for cell companies in this quarter which we didn't see so far, you know, whosoever has reported. Do you see this gross margin pressure coming up because the chart what you have shown is showing a very sharp reduction in silver, number one. Number two, what is our hedging policy because when I look at your other income, Y-on-Y, it's down but similar kind of an income I'm seeing in your other comprehensive income which is a very big number. So, is it because of the hedging policy? If you can take first question on these two aspects.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Thank you, Nitin. So, on the hedging policy, yes, we have in this quarter adopted a hedging policy and you will not see any hedging income coming. It is only going to be in other comprehensive income. Once it's realized it will go and sit in our COGS, right? Now, if you look
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at our last quarter other income, it was forex hedge and interest earned on fixed deposits, those funds which were sitting with us in our bank account.

Now, most of the capex funds have been utilized and hence you see the other income. The silver hedging which is the unreliable gain as we speak today is sitting in the other comprehensive income and as and when we realize it, it will come and sit in the COGS.

Nitin Arora: Yes, I got it. And how do you see gross margin? Do you see any impact would be coming in, in your gross margin or you think because the contribution to the Mono PERC and TOPCon is pretty less and you are hedged? Because we have seen few Chinese companies whose reported, their other income is higher than their EBITDA because of hedging. I am talking about LONGi and all in this quarter. So, can you throw some light on your trajectory for the gross margin because of this?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, as you have seen in our results which we have declared yesterday, there has not been any reduction in other income as was estimated due to silver. And this is because we have a very strong hedging policy and we have almost six months of silver which is hedged.

Then if you look at also an industry leader for the last years in this industry and close to 15 years in cell manufacturing, we have shown on our investor presentation that as technology moved from multicrystalline to TOPCon and the wafer size has increased from 125 millimeter to 182 by 210, the consumption of silver has dropped by 68% in five years. And with the advanced technology process adoption, which our team is doing in our plants, we expect a further reduction of 30%.

Then we are in advanced stages with our suppliers of silver paste who are almost ready with copper instead of silver, and we are expecting that to be coming up soon, maybe in the next few quarters. If you look at our operational efficiency because of scale, what we will be getting into with the 7 gigawatts cell line without any erosion on margin.

Nitin Arora: Got it. Sir, just on the other aspect of demand because when we look at your order book and your cell capacity, it looks like that you almost sold more than half of your cell capacity which you are coming up. Going b

y your -- and the way you explained that in any quarter non-DCR could be lower and DCR could be higher.

But going forward, how we should build in now the order intake because you must be now planning to take orders for FY '28 second half or let's say nine months because if we look at the math and you can correct me, you are already now sold out for the next 15 months.

Can you throw some light segment-wise, how is the inquiry pipeline? Because what we hear from the street and a lot of people that there will be a big slowdown that will happen, but when we look at all the renewable companies, every quarter order intake has been pretty steady. Can you throw some light segment-wise, how is the inquiry pipeline across IPPs, KUSUM? There is KUSUM C now also which is becoming very big. If you can take that aspect.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Sure. So let me first clarify to you that our cell capacities are not 50% sold out, they are almost 90% sold out. We are at 3.2 gigawatt, and we have done a 400 megawatt expansion which is 3.6

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gigawatt as we speak today. And even if you calculate at 90%, it's about a 3 gigawatt of production, 3 to 3.2 gigawatt.

And then, 7 GW are coming up in June and September, you would just get about one quarter of revenue. If you calculate that and you look at our INR6,800 crores of our cell order book, we are almost sold out. We do not have much capacity to sell and that is the reason why we took up this 400 megawatt of debottlenecking at lowest ever capex of INR101 crores which was a major achievement by our team to get this expansion up and running. So that is on the order book. The second point of view is that there is a demand. We can very easily sign up orders for the next five years or sell orders from existing module manufacturers. But we do not have any reason to do that because if we do not get substantial advance and the order is not a final like a committed order book, it would again not come into our order book because it would be a framework agreement. And that is the reason why we are not going very aggressively, although the demand we can sell our cell capacities for the next three years.

Now, if you look at capacities coming up in India, if you look at certain reports which had come even as early as January '25, I remember seeing a report from Kotak which said that they estimated FY '26, 54 gigawatt of cell capacity would be up and running in India. But as we speak today, we are way below 30 gigawatt.

And when you look at utilization, we are way below actual production of 22 or 23 gigawatt.

Now, we have been telling consistently that cell business is high technology, difficult to run, strong expertise needed in this manufacturing process. It is not as simple as setting up a cell line and running it. It takes time.

And this has been proven in the last 14 months that not as much capacity has come up as was predicted. So, we feel that, you know, I will leave it to Vinay to talk about the demand and the supply side. I think Vinay, maybe you would like to add.

Vinay Rustagi: Sure. So, hi, Nitin. So, I think, we've been at pains to basically explain and elaborate that the demand environment continues to be very strong. We see great momentum in every single segment in the market. And we are seeing that in our discussion pipeline as well. In fact, the discussion pipeline is at the highest number of all times. And we are seeing -- and there's a very good healthy mix across IPPs, EPCs, both utility scale as well as the corporate market and the KUSUM market. So, there is a very healthy pipeline.

And the only reason we are not able to take more orders is because one, obviously, we are kind of heavily sold out over the next particularly 6 to 12 months. And we don't have capacities matching some of the project requirements. But in general, we want to kind of, again, take the pains to reiterate that

the demand environment remains very strong in the sector.

Nitin Arora: Sure. Just lastly, from my side...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Mr. Arora...

Nitin Arora: Sorry, I'll come back in the queue.

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Moderator: But can you re-join the queue.

Nitin Arora: Sure, I will. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bharani from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Bharani: Good morning. Am I audible?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, Bharani. Hi.

Bharani: Yes, good morning. So, can you throw some light on how much in what did we sell this quarter in modules and cells?

Vinay Rustagi: So, yes, we don't release the actual sales number or the mix between cell and module. But you've seen the production numbers. Production has been quite steady on the module side and has increased by about 86 megawatts for the cell business.

Bharani: Okay. How much would be the realization on cells for us right now?

Vinay Rustagi: So, realization for the cell business is pretty steady in line with the previous few quarters. The market prices are hovering at around \$0.14 to \$0.145, depending on what size and activity timeline.

Bharani: And how about our module realization, both DCR and non-DCR?

Vinay Rustagi: So, you know, for the module prices, the prices are very, very volatile, given that the cost environment, there are so many changes going on. So, we saw, I would say about, over the last 6 to 9 months, there was a compression in the NDCR market because of strong competition. But then over the last one or two months, prices have started going up as, you know, we need to pass on our increased cost to the customers. So, the non-DCR market prices are back to about, I

would say, \$0.16.5 to \$0.17, you know, which is an increase of almost \$0.02 in the last one month alone. And the prices are at about \$0.23 to \$0.24.

Bharani: Okay, your voice was breaking. I will take it offline. My last question is on the composition of selling cost in your BOM for module. And how much has it increased because of the silver price increase? And how are we passing it on? What percentage of our order book is, like, on a pass-through mechanism?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, if you look at our order book, close to about half, and if you look at the non-DCR business, since it is sold from China, everything is pass-through. There is no effect of silver contribution on our non-DCR. On DCR orders, as I shared with Nitin, who asked the last question, that, you know, we are working on reduction of silver consumption. We have also shown that in our PPT, on the investor PPT, that what has been reduction of silver over the last five years, and what is the plan going forward?

Bharani: Your voice was breaking. If I summarize, you are telling your non-DCR is on a full pass-through basis, and the DCR, you are working on reduction of silver consumption.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: That is right. Reduction. And consumption and also hedging. Hedging of silver.

Bharani: Right, but how much, you know, would be the percentage cost in BOM for, say, manufacturing a module right now? And how much was it, say, maybe six months back?

Vinay Rustagi: So, giving you broad history data, so the total silver cost over the last one year, on a per-watt basis, has gone up from about 1 cent to about 2.5 to 2.7 cents. So, basically, there is a net increase of about 1.5 to \$1.7 cents on a per-watt basis. Having said that, there is no impact on our current business, because for our current operations, and I would say up to about six months from now, we already have either sufficient stock in place or we have a hedging process in place.

So, there is no impact on the business over the short term. And I think going beyond that, we are basically hoping to compensate some of the cost increase by changes in the BOM approach, as Chiranjeev outlined

earlier, more effective hedging, more, I would say, detailed negotiations with the suppliers, as well as passing on some of the cost increase to our customers. So, overall, net, I would say, there is very little impact because of the silver cost increase on our margins.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kunal Shah from DAM Capital.

Kunal Shah: One on the order book of Rs 137 billion now, how much of this would be converted to revenues during F27? And simple question here is factoring in all the commodity inflation or whatever is going on, how would the spreads look like on the execution of this order book versus the current spreads?

Vinay Rustagi: So, Kunal, hi, this is Vinay. So, you know, we can't give exact numbers, but I would say about 70% to 75% of our total order book is due for execution over the next 12 months. And sorry, your second question was?

Kunal Shah: Second was in terms of execution of this order book, let's say factoring in all the commodity inflation, how would the spreads look like on the execution of this book versus the current spreads?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so look, I mean, in terms of the increase in various commodity prices, silver is the by far the biggest and the most notable increase. You know, if you look at other commodities, the major consumption or expense comes from glass where there is no impact. On aluminum frames there is no material impact. I mean, there are some monthly variations, but if I look at the overall cost trend over the last six months or even 12 months, there is no major impact from any of these commodity price increases.

And whatever any residual impact is from any other cost increases, I would say is very minimal and is easily compensated by improvement in our scale and efficiency of the overall business.

So, to answer your question, I mean, net-net, we expect very minimal, if any, impact on profitability because of increases in any of these material costs.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is helpful. Secondly, on the efficiencies that you briefly mentioned about increasing from 25.2 to 25.8. Now, these levels are unheard of. And are we aiming to sort of implement and execute this over the entire TOPCon line? So let's say 7 plus 1.2 gigs. And also,

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do you see this becoming a big competitive edge vis-a-vis peers? And are we attempting to improve this through our own in-house R&D team or there is some tie-up? So if you could just sort of highlight more on that.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So the efficiency levels we are talking about are unheard of in India, but in China, these are, you

know, pretty normal that they're talking about these kind of efficiencies. And Premier as a company has always maintained leadership position in all areas of cell manufacturing, be it execution, be it capex cost at which we set up our cell lines and efficiency levels, which we achieve. And also the ramp-up time, which we have been continuously improving. And we will be deploying all these, you know, high-end technology process adoption on our total 8.2 gigawatt TOPCon cell line. So it's already getting adopted in the 1.2 gigawatt. And of course, it will be replicated in the 7 gigawatt TOPCon cell line.

Kunal Shah: And this is all through our in-house R&D team, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, it's all through our in-house R&D team.

Kunal Shah: Understood. And lastly, if I may, when it comes to the order book building during the F27 as a year, in your estimates of estimates, what would be the demand size for where, you know, the domestic cells would be required? And what are the key segments driving the growth? I think you briefly mentioned on the segments, but if you could just quantify the demand size that you are looking at during F27, which will become order inflows for us?

Vinay Rustagi: So, yes, hi. So for F27, the demand for the DCR market is basically expected to com

e from the

residential rooftop solar scheme, where we expect installations of about 10 gigawatt. KUSUM scheme, where on a conservative, we would estimate installations of about between 5 to 7 gigawatt. And the open access and the private rooftop market.

Now open access, if you see what has happened in the last one year, we see a record capacity addition of about 11 gigawatts in AC terms. So that equates to about 16 gigawatts of DC demand. So across all these three markets, we would expect the demand to be about 30 gigawatts plus for the DCR market in F27.

Kunal Shah: Understood. Versus which the current capacity is roughly 24 gigawatts as per your presentation, right?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, but if you, yes, that is the current capacity, but I think the more relevant number is the actual production number. And the current run rate of production, as I'm sure you're monitoring, is only about 20 to 21 gigawatt in annualized terms.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aashish from InvesQ PMS.

Aashish: Yes, my question, sir, mostly related to the industry demand supply, which you just addressed.

Sir, is it possible to further take it, maybe, because most of the players would have already announced a lot of capacities. So how much do you expect to commission based on your experience?

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Because as you said in the initial remarks that the actual capacities that come on the ground are pretty low versus what the market expects. So is it possible to take it forward maybe till FY28 kind of scenario versus the demand also? Because you said that the demand is around 30, I think So how does that pan out?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi, Aashish. So in terms of the supply, look, I think there have been total announcements by something like 45 to 50 companies. If I add up all the nameplate announcements, they add up to something like 200 gigawatts. But the fact of the matter is that there is a very strong discipline being exercised by both equity investors as well as lenders. As I'm sure you've seen, even the government advisory not to fund to the banks and the financial institutions to not fund any overcapacity in the sector.

Chiranjeev already mentioned that last year there was an expectation that by the end of FY26 there would be operational capacity of 54 gigawatts, which the reality is that it will be somewhere between 27 to 30 gigawatts. So taking the reality, which is the financial discipline exercised by the investors plus the time that it takes to execute these capacities and then finally ramp up production, the actual number we believe will be far, far short of all these nameplate announcements.

In fact, we already see on the ground that some people have been calling off their investment plans, and some people are even looking to exit the sector or trying to find a bigger investor for acquisition. So it is difficult to say as to what the exact number will be, but we expect the number to be not very north of the expected demand.

On the demand side, we are saying that FY26 should end with a total market demand, including the DCR and the non-DCR components of more than 50 gigawatts annualized. And by FY28 we would expect that demand to grow to about 60 to 65 gigawatts.

So that is the overall demand supply, but I think I want to also add a little bit of context into the cell nameplate capacities. One, even if some of the capacities come up, the actual production number is expected to lag quite significantly because of the time that it takes for all the new lines to ramp up, stabilize, and achieve the right efficiencies.

Second, there is as much as 13 gigawatts of all the Mono PERC capacity, which will need to be

eventually taken out over the next 1 to 2 years or be upgraded to TOPCon. And we believe that there will be moderation in that capacity.
And finally, we have always maintained that with the implementation of ALMM

-2, all the focus

of the market and the profit pool is basically shifting from the module to the cell business. And with the implementation of ALMM-3, the same effect will basically move from cell to the upstream ingot and wafer business.

So overall, our assessment is that the cell market is expected to be in much more demand-supply balance than projected by many of the analysts. And the focus of the business in terms of scale, investment, and profitability will in any case shift towards ingots and wafers over the next 3 years.

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Aashish: Right. So I think you mentioned the production numbers also. What is the supply in the market? If you could repeat that, FY '26 you said some numbers as to what the supply is likely to be on the cell side?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so in the current year...

Aashish: '26 and '27, maybe, what do you think?

Vinay Rustagi: So in the current year – the current run rate of production are about 1600 megawatts which equates to about 20 gigawatts of production for the full year. And for next year, it remains to be seen which lines actually come up. Obviously, our lines are due for completion between June and September.

But bear in mind that all new lines do take from 6 months to as long as 18 months to fully stabilize and start running. So the expected production volume will really depend on the timeline of many of these new lines which are expected to be commissioned in the next year.

Aashish: But roughly, you don't see FY '27 where there will be still short supply versus the demand. That's what would be the assumption?

Vinay Rustagi: That's correct. Like I said earlier, the total demand in the year is expected to increase to about 30 gigawatts plus, which compares with something like 15 to 18 gigawatts this year. Because bulk of the increase is basically going to come from one increase in the residential rooftop installation and second, implementation of ALMM-2 for private rooftop and open access markets. So with the increase in demand, we don't expect any likelihood of oversupply given the expected pace of capacity addition and ramp up in the coming year.

Aashish: Sure. Thank you so much.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Chandan from Rajgadha Industries Private Limited. Please go ahead.

Chandan: Yes, hi. My question is, last quarter we discussed about the potential of the next quarter for Q3 in which we discussed about three things. One is that GST change. Because of that, some orders got pulled and were supposed to be delivered in Q3. Similarly, we talked about rain. Due to rain, the inventory piled up and that was supposed to be liquidated in Q3?

And then order book, obviously, order book was substantially grown in the last quarter. But what we see in this quarter, revenue jump of 5%, which I don't see is substantial growth considering those three parameters, three reasons, which was mentioned in the last quarter. We can get some thoughts around that. That would be really helpful?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, Mr. Chandan, the material or the inventory which was carried forward from last quarter to this quarter has been dispatched, sold to the respective customers. Now, to answer your question on revenue, I would like to make it a little bit more clearer that when we sell a non-

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DCR module to a customer, when you look at the prevailing pricing levels, it is approximately around INR1.4 crores to INR1.5 crores per megawatt at which we sell these modules. When we sell a DCR module, the pricing is around INR2.2 crores to INR2.3 crores per megawatt. Now, in this quarter from October to December, my non-DCR sales have gone up because my customer sites were ready. And my DCR sales had a slight dip because most of my customers had realizations to recover or to get from the pro

jects they had supplied DCR modules into various programs.

Now, this mix, if it moved by, let's say 3% or 4%, this is what you're seeing in the revenue

numbers. But there is no impact on margins because the DCR orders which we executed in this quarter were contracts which were signed much earlier and had higher margins. So, every quarter, this is the nature of the business that if you have slightly higher non-DCR business, your revenue will not really show up, but your margins are protected. But if you are a higher DCR business, then your revenues will go up. So, that is the reason that you're seeing that addition.

Vinay Rustagi: I think, just quickly on your point about the order book, like we've been saying, a lot of our production over the next year is already sold out. Changes in the order book do tend to be lumpy. So, it is very natural to see big orders in one quarter followed by slight decrease in the next quarter. But our discussion pipeline remains very strong and we will continue to see good order inflow in line with the growth of the business.

Chandan: That's it. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sabri from Emkay Global. Please go ahead.

Sabri: Good morning. I have just one question. Can you show some color on the aluminium frame market in India in terms of what is the demand, domestic production and imports currently?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the challenge on the Aluminium Industry in India is that we've got enough aluminium manufacturing, but the challenge is on the anodizing side. And there is not enough anodizing facilities available in India for supplying aluminium frames. And as of now, there are enough and more aluminium profile manufacturers, but because of anodizing, there is a lot of demand from China in spite of the duty which has been imposed by the Government of India.

Sabri: What should be the domestic production versus imports currently in gigawatt terms?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it's phenomenally high. If you talk about aluminium profile manufacturing in India and demand in India, let's say 50 gigawatts, the manufacturing is much, much more than that. The problem is in the anodizing. So, in the anodizing, there is not enough capacity.

Sabri: Anodizing will be how much then? Anodizing capacity in India?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, that would be maybe 20% of India's demand.

Sabri: Okay, and remaining everything is imported from China?

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Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, as we speak. But a lot of players, including us, have announced highly automated aluminium profile and anodizing plants. And we expect in the next 18 to 24 months, India will be self-sufficient on anodizing to cater to the demand of the domestic industry.

Sabri: So, 50 gigawatts of module demand will be largely satisfied from domestic sources in the next 2 years. That's what you are saying, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, yes.

Sabri: Okay, thank you so much and all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prakhar from Ambit. Please go ahead.

Prakhar: Good morning, sir. One question. So, when you mentioned, let's say, as we know through our order book that we are already more than 90% booked in terms of cell capacity. Now, when I see the demand drivers in, let's say, FY '27, Residential Rooftop, KUSUM, etc., I believe these are more distribution-led businesses where you sell over the counter. So, are we selling our cells to some of the OEMs, etc., or maybe some of the other companies who will then sell in the residential or KUSUM market?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, the cells which we sell to are to domestic module manufacturers who would buy these cells from us and make modules which would go into residential PM-Surya Ghar or also into KUSUM schemes. And the order book which we show, we do not take into account our own retail sales, which is close to about half a gigawatt

att every year.

It's about INR1,000 crores of revenue, which we do not take in our order book because this is a retail market. And so, the order book which we get every quarter, a lot of the orders are also spot orders or, you know, orders with a short-term delivery period.

Prakhar: So, my question linked to this is that, given our distribution network is so strong, why can't we directly sell our own DCR modules in this market, given great demand in KUSUM residential rooftop?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, the residential rooftop program depends a lot on the retail network which you have. We work with, we sell to certain module manufacturers who are very strong brands in the retail segment. We also do OEM for certain customers of ours.

So, you have companies which are in the retail segment selling not just solar panels, but selling electrical appliances, cables, home solutions. So, these are, kind of – I mean, they have a very, very large network. And that is why we also support those markets through these, channel sales partners.

Prakhar: Okay. And so, the second question, very quick one. When we say 7 gigawatt capacity addition, what type of line is it, G12R or G12, just to understand what would be the effective output

available for us, given right now the demand mostly would be maybe M10 or gradually it will be G12R? So, what is the effective capacity of the 7 gigawatt?
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Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we at Premier were the first ones. And as we speak today, there are only two companies in India which are manufacturing G12R cells, and that is Adani and us. We were, early movers to G12R. If you look at China, almost 80% to 90% of China market has moved to G12R. And making M10 is not economical today. And all players which are into cell manufacturing, all new lines will come up with G12R or G12. And the existing players would have to, in any case, upgrade to G12R, which would mean a dip in production levels.

And again, getting the line back into peak efficiency of about four to six months. And I think most of the customers are booked on orders of DCR and at the moment they do not have the time to upgrade, but gradually they would have to. And our 7 gigawatt line is a G12R line and even the TOPCon which is operational is G12R.

Vinay Rustagi: I was just saying that currently, basically the rooftop market and the KUSUM market is not -- does not make too much distinction between G12R or M10. But from next year onwards or this year onwards, when ALMM2 is set in place, there's a large institutional market which will start procuring DCR modules, so that is the open access and the private rooftop market. And there we expect most customers to prefer G12R over M10.

Prakhar: And this effectively will be 90%, 95% of the 7 gigawatt would be available for sale?

Vinay Rustagi: That's right, yes.

Prakhar: Understood. Those are my questions. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Mahawar from UBS. Please go ahead.

Amit Mahawar: Yes, sir, congratulations on stable results. Just one question and you have touched upon this in the previous question.

Moderator: Sir, you're sounding a little distant. Mr. Amit, can you please sound a little louder?

Amit Mahawar: Is it okay now?

Moderator: Better now. Please continue.

Amit Mahawar: Yes. Sir, see, we have a very, very quicker transition to new technologies in a very short span. But a lot of companies take time to ramp up cell. A large part of industry is still planning subscale capacity on cell. And then you have China anti-involution, which is jacking up the price for the end plants, manufacturing.

Do you think -- so, what is the level below which the industry profitability, maybe in gross margins and EBITDA margins indicator, you think beyond 28-29 it is unviable for people?

Because we can very clearly see accelerated, you know, phasing off of ma

nufacturing plants had

to be done. And we saw that in China also. So, that's the first question, sir?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, let's address this question in two kinds of logics. One is, yes, China has close to about 1,500 gigawatts of capacity, which is almost three times world demand. And a lot of plants in

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China will close down. Then let's talk about affordability. If you're talking about affordability solar is the cheapest source of energy today.

And if the prices are now coming up because of the anti-involution policy in China and this is passed through to customers, these were the prices which were prevailing in the market just about six to eight months back. It's just that the prices dropped. So, there was a two or three quarters of opportunity which customers had where prices dropped, and China would not continue to bleed.

So, even if prices come back and they're passed on to customers and even if model prices go back to, let's say, \$0.17 or \$0.18 per watt from 14 or 15 they were in about a month or two ago, these prices were prevailing in the market just six to eight months ago. So, we don't see a major issue there. And I think Vinay wants to add something.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. Hi, Amit. I think if you look at Slide number 18 in our presentation, we have basically said how we compare against many of the newer players who are entering the segment. The fundamentals of the sector are such that it basically lends itself to companies with great scale, backward integration and using the latest technology.

And bear in mind we are expected to transition from TOPCon to some of the newer technologies over a period of about 2028 to 2029 and we are also likely to see the rollout of ALMM3 in the same kind of time frame. So any of the newer players with smaller capacities, high debt levels, maybe not the same level of technical competence in terms of running and operationalizing their

lines.

They are likely in our view to basically struggle with having to undertake new technology upgrades and having to backward integrate. So, it is possible that many of these companies will basically struggle to sustain the business and compete with the benefit of scale and technology with some of the larger players such as ourselves. So, I do believe that we will have a strong competitive advantage against many players, many of the newer players entering the segment. Amit Mahawar: Yes, thanks. And second and quick question is the cost of complying or transitioning to G12R because this was not the case we realized in the last one year, but it was very, very specific in the last couple of months. A lot of players will have to switch and then we have further policy coming from the government. What is the case that beyond 27, 28, the industry demand supply from sell point of view is very, very favorable vis-a-vis what we see today. How would you -- would you assign a higher probability to that, that beyond 27, 28, the industry demand supply dynamics is very, very favorable than it is perceived today? That's it. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, hi, Amit. I think that's a very qualitative discussion. It's always very difficult to see how the market would be in two or three years' time. But I think a lot of the industry concerns about overcapacity are overdone because of the factors we discussed earlier in terms of the financial discipline and time taken, technical expertise required to execute these plans.

But we don't have to just look at the cell capacities alone. I think we have to look at the fact that the technology landscape is evolving and changing and the focus of the business is going to shift towards backward integration with the rollout of ALMM3. So, I think given that and if you look

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at how many companies will be able to also successfully integrate backwards in t

his short space

of time, we do believe that it will be only about, I would say, six to eight players who will be successful in doing so and they will be basically accounting for bulk of the market.

Chiranjeev Saluja: And just to add on the G12R, it's not the cost of upgrade, it's the time which it takes to upgrade and then stabilize the lines, which is more expensive.

Amit Mahawar: Got it, sir. Thank you, very much and good luck.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Puneet from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Puneet: Yes. Thank you so much for the opportunity. My first question is on your non-DCR cells where you said everything is a pass-through. So, how do you think about margins? Is it more in percentage terms or dollar per watt peak?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, I think -- hi, Puneet. So, for the non-DCR market we obviously look at what is the EBITDA for the business taking into account basically a BOM and other conversion costs. And overall despite the competition and the overcapacity in the non-DCR space, we are able to -- we have been able to maintain a margin at a very attractive levels and also pass on the increased costs to our customers.

Puneet: So, what I'm trying to understand.

Chiranjeev Saluja: I think your question is...

Puneet: On your order book.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, I think the realization what we get is on a dollar per watt. It is not on percentage because it is a pass-through and the cell is fully funded by the off-take loan.

Puneet: Right. So, will it be fair to assume that you will -- might also be enjoying the rupee depreciation benefit here?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. Sometimes, yes, depending on at what contract terms we have with the customer. If the customer is signed up for INR per watt peak order, then we would not, but if the dollar we will.

Puneet: Okay. And you also mentioned that you are seeing profit pools move from non-DCR cells to DCR cells. Has it already started happening and what would your margins have been earlier on the non-DCR side versus now?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No. So, non-DCR cell is just a bought-out item for us. I didn't get your question. Could you repeat that?

Puneet: No. You said the profit pool will start moving from the non-DCR modules to DCR modules on the cell side?

Chiranjeev Saluja: As ALMM fully implemented, you would see that by FY28 India market, I think 100% would be DCR. It starts off in 2026 June, but then it is a gradual phased implementation. The C&I gets

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implemented immediately and the IPP projects will come in after the earlier projects which were grandfathered are executed.

Puneet: Are you already seeing some bit of compression in margins on the non-DCR side or has this yet to happen?

Chiranjeev Saluja: No. Maybe last quarter we had seen a slight compression, but it's now kind of started increasing. Prices have started increasing.

Puneet: Okay. And lastly, on your cell lines you talked about June and September. When should we assume that those lines will stabilize?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, if you look at the historical track record which Premier has, we have been able to ramp up lines between four to six months. And in the TOPCon line, if you see, we are already at about 80% as we speak and by next month we will be 100% of what we can achieve. In terms of plant utilization, it will be about 90%, but that's the peak at which we have been achieving every quarter. For our new cell lines, we expect the same thing that we will be able to achieve in about four to six months.

Puneet: So, full utilization for the June line should happen by December for sure?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes.

Puneet: Okay, great. That's all from my side. Thank you so much and all the best. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shashank Jha from [inaudible 0:71:37] Capital. Please go ahead.

Shashank Jha: Yes, sir. I have two questions. First

one is regarding the effective capacity utilization like when you say you will have 10 gigawatts of cell capacity, so how much will we actually be able to produce out of it?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, we have always been very transparent with the market on effective capacity. In fact, if you look at our TOPCon cell line, which we have said is 1.2 gigawatts. We had our ALMM inspection which got completed yesterday and as per ALMM, our capacity is 1.35 gigawatts, but we always talk about effective capacity.

Shashank Jha: So, like when you say 10 gigawatts expansion, so what will be the actual usable throughput?

Chiranjeev Saluja: The actual usable would be 90% of 10, that is 9 gigawatts.

Shashank Jha: And you are talking about G1-2R cells?

Chiranjeev Saluja: We are talking about G12-R.

Shashank Jha: Okay, okay. Got it, got it.

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Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, if I actually take it as a G12, then it will be even higher. But then we also want to be conservative in an announcement that it is a 10 gigawatt line based on G12-R, not on G12.

Shashank Jha: It will be like when you said 10 gigawatts, it will be the capacity and 9 gigawatts will be the actual production, right?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Right. After it is ramped up.

Shashank Jha: One last question, sir. When you expanded 10 gigawatts to cell, you may have done some demand forecasting that by FY '29, FY '30, this will be the usage for cell. So, from where you get the idea that I have to make my cell capacity to 10 gigawatts? What was the rationale behind it, doing this capex? I just want to understand that, sir.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, so I think that depends on the overall assessment of demand supply, given the bottom-up analysis of the market. We follow all the government policy announcements, the technology developments, and cost of production trends, etcetera, very closely.

And obviously, we also follow the track of the competitive landscape in terms of different players, their execution status, funding status, etcetera, very closely. So, like we have said, we believe that it takes much longer time for companies to actually deliver on their announcement in terms of implementation of their lines, and then to finally start production from these lines. So, given our view was that the demand supply landscape is expected to remain favorable, we saw an opportunity, and that is why we decided to accelerate the implementation of a 7 gigawatt cell line, because we feel that we have an opportunity to be able to sell these cells at attractive prices.

Shashank Jha: Okay, got it. Any plan on moving to electrolyzers?

Vinay Rustagi: I mean, yes. I mean, I think we have to see how the fundamentals of the green hydrogen market develop. There is obviously a lot of promise. The government of India has a target of 5 million tons of green hydrogen capacity. But I think the truth is that the technical and economic viability of green hydrogen business is expected to take another 3 to 4 years.

That is why you see the actual implementation on the ground to be very, very slow. We are tracking this market closely. It remains of interest, and we have announced our plans based on our expectation of the market takeoff.

Shashank Jha: Sir, one last question regarding green hydrogen. So, one green hydrogen translates to 1 gigawatt, I think translates to like 1 million metric tons translates to five green ammonia. And 5 million metric tons translates to something around, I just wanted to confirm, 20 megawatt of AC power,

right? 5 megawatt -- gigawatt.
Vinay Rustagi: That's correct, yes.
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Shashank Jha: So, sir, how much DC module will it take? I think it will take around 70% of the module, okay?
So can you give the number for 1 million metric ton green hydrogen, how much DC solar module do you need?
Vinay Rustagi: Yes. So it is very di

fficult to give a precise number because ultimately it would depend on the kind of renewable project configuration, whether it is solar plus storage or solar plus wind plus storage, etcetera. But I think based on broad industry trends, we expect about 15-20 gigawatts of solar module demand for every million tons of hydrogen capacity. So, if the government target is 5 million tons, the total solar module demand could be about 100 gigawatts.

Shashank Jha: That's great, sir. Yes.
Vinay Rustagi: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Dhruv from HDFC AMC. Please go ahead.

Dhruv: Yes, sir. Thank you so much. Sir, one clarification. You mentioned that a lot of pricing is also on dollar basis. So, is it different for cell and module or similar? And if you can share what proportion of, say for example, the order book is dollar-based pricing and how much is INR-based?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So about majority, about 80%-85% of our order book is dollar-based. There are very few orders which we take on rupee-based. Those are mostly short-term orders. Cell and module both, be it DCR, non-DCR or be it cells, is all dollar based.

Dhruv: Okay, interesting. And sir, secondly, in the comments you mentioned that we are seeing some price increases in modules. The industry is taking some price increase probably because of the inflation. But if I am not wrong, probably I have not heard that not much of talk is happening on the cell price increase for the DCR market.

So, just curious why, I mean, there is a lot of inflation. Although you are hedging, probably you will replace with copper, but that also will add to some element of the cost. So, why is the industry probably not trying, given the demand supply is favorable, why the industry is not aiming for a price increase in the DCR cells?

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, Dhruv, it would depend on the contracts which we have signed. So, let's say I have signed a contract with a customer where there is a...

Dhruv: No, probably for the new contracts, for the new contracts, I am saying, for incremental contracts.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, again, for the incremental contracts for the DCR price, we are seeing prices to be fairly stable. In fact, you know, as per market estimates, there was a talk that DCR prices would fall to as low as INR13, but we have not seen this drop. We are still seeing price elevation over INR13.

Dhruv: I am just trying to understand, given the cost inflation, meaningful cost inflation, silver, although you hedge, but still the incremental, assuming the spot remains, the incremental hedge will also

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come at a higher value. So, there is an inflation. So, I am just trying to understand, as industry, as a player, why aren't you trying to push for that cost increase?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes, as we told, we have been doing this for 6 months, and the supply is beyond 6 months when they come up, and depending on the silver prices as they progress, we would maybe push for a cost increase once that really comes in.

Dhruv: Sure, got it. Perfect. Thank you, sir and all the best. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Roshabh Sanghvi from Oaklane. Please go ahead.

Roshabh Sanghvi: Hi, thank you for taking my question. I know you mentioned the contribution of silver in a previous answer. I just wanted to know exactly, as a percentage of the total cost of a cell, how much is silver, and how has that been trending the last 6 months?

Vinay Rustagi: So, hi, Roshabh. You know, I am not able to give you a percentage number, but like I said earlier, the cost of silver, the share of silver has basically gone up from about INR0.01 a watt to about INR0.025 a watt. And we would expect that number to actually start going down with the proposal for reducing silver consumption.

Roshabh Sanghvi: Got it. And I know you mentioned that a lot of the c

osts that we incur are passed through, especially for cost escalation, but can you help us understand how the cost of the imported cell has actually gone up, regardless of whether it passed through or not?

Chiranjeev Saluja: You mean the quantum of increase?

Roshabh Sanghvi: Sorry?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Rishabh, you mean the increase in the non-DCR cell prices?

Roshabh Sanghvi: Increase in the imported cell prices.

Chiranjeev Saluja: So, it has gone up from levels of about sub INR0.04 to about INR0.06 now, as we speak.

Mohit Kumar: Okay, got it. So, I am assuming that the entire thing is just from the silver, what you are saying, from 1 to 2.5.

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes.

Roshabh Sanghvi: Got it. Okay. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nitin Arora from Axis Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Nitin Arora: Sorry, my questions have been answered. Thank you. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Balasubramanian from Arihant Capital. Please go ahead.

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Balasubramanian: Good afternoon, sir. Thank you so much for the opportunity. So, I think we have seen limited tariff impact from ALM to almost 0.1 per kilowatt hour for [CapTO as well as Open access].

However, I think we have 61 gigawatt solar and 20 gigawatt hybrid projects under development.

And what proportion of this pipeline is subject to ALM 2 and 3? And how we are going to absorb part of ALM-related cost increase pressure, which impact margins? These are my first questions.

Vinay Rustagi: Bala, hi. I am not sure I followed the full question correctly. But I think the question I understood was about basically the split of the pipeline in terms of ALMM-1 and ALMM-2. Is that correct?

Balasubramanian: Yes, sir. Between 61 gigawatt solar and 20 gigawatt hybrid projects, which are under development, that one also.

Vinay Rustagi: Yes. See, I think if you look at the timeline for various auctions, a bulk of these auctions were completed in FY '24 and FY '25. And there has been a massive slowdown in auctions over the last year, basically since the time that ALMM-2 has become effective. So, I would expect as much as, you know, I am taking a very broad guess, but as much as 90% plus of the current pipeline would be ALMM-1.

Balasubramanian: Okay, sir. And, sir, how we are exposed to changes in domestic content requirement, especially for mandatory 50% for VGO projects, and how this will impact our cost structure?

Vinay Rustagi: So, I think the movement to DCR and ALMM-2 is very, very beneficial because we have a fully integrated business and we have our cell lines running at optimal capacity utilization. So, this is only going to provide a further impetus to our business in terms of sales as well as margins.

Balasubramanian: Okay, sir. May I ask you one small question?

Vinay Rustagi: Please.

Balasubramanian: Yes, sir. Sir, I think, like, bigger panel companies are, like, targeting to occur small solar cell companies. How this industry is consolidating? I think Goldi Solar is acquiring a small cell company based out of Andhra Pradesh. How the industry is shaping up in terms of consolidation?

Vinay Rustagi: So, I think, you know, this is something which is expected to play out over the next 2 years as more and more companies get into the sector. We feel that many companies will find that actual execution and operations is far more challenging, and particularly with complexities around technology, scale, backward integration, etcetera. So, we will see more consolidation opportunities over a period of time.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Deepak from Svan Investments. Please go ahead.

Deepak: Yes. Hi. Good afternoon, sir. So, just wanted to check it out in terms of the spread in the dollar terms, given the hike in the raw material. How do we see this spread in dollar terms? Whether

this would be sustained in DCR and non-DCR both? If we can share your perspective, especially after the six months when our hedging for the silver is going to get over?

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Vinay Rustagi: Hi. So, our margin in dollar terms, we have been at pains to elaborate, that does remain unchanged. Because we've discussed the silver price cost increase, we've discussed increases or changes in other commodities. So, basically, we are trying to maintain our margins and pass on the cost of increase, any increases in cost to our customers for new orders wherever possible.

And the intent is to maintain the profitability and overall margins.

Deepak: Okay. So, spread in the dollar term is going to be maintained even in the DCR and non-DCR both?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, it is dollar term pricing as we have said in both. And even for the current order book beyond six months also, that will be maintained?

Chiranjeev Saluja: Yes. So, you know, this is too much of speculation. It depends what the silver price is then and, you know, our negotiations with our customers. As far as we are concerned, our goal is to protect the margins and pass on any increase which comes in post our own internal processes to reduce silver consumption.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, we will take that as our last question for today. I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you. So, thank you everyone for staying in the call and giving us your time. We touched a lot of ground in terms of the industry landscape and the company's business. I just want to close with some quick remarks about the demand landscape because I know that there is a lot of concern in this particular area.

You know, we have seen unprecedented growth in solar capacity installations over the last two years beating all industry estimates. And that basically vindicates, you know, our belief in the attractive fundamentals of this technology.

We believe that growth and demand, you know, growth will surprise us on the upside. Now with the new capacities coming up and the increase in scale of our operations, particularly over the next two to four quarters, we are poised for a tremendous growth in our business, marking an inflection point in the company's journey.

And combined with proposed forays into storage inverters and transformers, we are set to see an exciting growth journey with combined benefits of scale and diversification. I want to thank all our investors and the analyst community for your continued support and look forward to working with you. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Call: May 2026

Ref: PEL 19/2026-27

Date: May 20, 2026

To To

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Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the conference call on financial results for the quarter and year ended on March 31, 2026.

In accordance with Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we are enclosing herewith the transcript of the conference call discussing the financial results for the quarter and year ended on March 31, 2026. This call took place at 18:30 hours IST on Friday, 15th May, 2026.

The above information will be made available on the website of the Company.

This is for your information and records.

Thanks & Regards,
For Premier Energies Limited

Hitesh Kumar Jain
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

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"Premier Energies Limited
Q4 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"
May 15, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. CHIRANJEEV SINGH SALUJA – MANAGING
DIRECTOR – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. NAND KISHORE KHANDLWAL – CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
MR. VINAY RUSTAGI – CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED
M R. SUDHIR REDDY – CHIEF STRATEGY OFFICER –
PREMIER ENERGIES LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Premier Energies Limited Q4 FY26 Earnings Conference call hosted by ICICI Securities Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Rutuja. Good evening. On behalf of ICICI Securities, I welcome you all to the Q4 FY26 Earnings call of Premier Energies. Today, we have with us from the management Mr. Chiranjeev Singh Saluja, Managing Director; Mr. Nand Kishore Khandlwal, Chief Financial Officer; Mr. Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer and Mr. Sudhir Reddy, Chief Strategy Officer.

We will begin with the opening remarks from the management, which will be followed by Q&A.

Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Thank you, Mohit. Am I audible?

Moderator: Yes, you are. Please go ahead.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Good evening, everyone. Thank you for joining us today for our Full year FY2026 Earnings call. I am Chiranjeev Saluja, Managing Director of Premier Energies and I am joined today by my colleagues Mr. NK Khandelwal, Group CFO; Sudhir Reddy, Chief Strategy Officer and Director and Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer.

I am delighted to share that the company has reported a record set of revenue and profit numbers.

Our total revenue has increased by 20.7% year-on-year to INR8,026 crores. The profitability margins have held steady; operational EBITDA margin is reported at 30.4% and PAT margin at 18.8%.

Our PAT has jumped 61.1% year-on-year to INR1,510 crores. The most pleasing thing about these numbers is that they have been achieved in a challenging overall environment with increase in several commodity prices and freight prices. Amongst key business updates, we recently completed construction of our 5.6 gigawatt module plant at Sitarampur in Telangana.

This is one of the largest and most automated module plants in India and is expected to achieve full ramp-up in the next 2 months. In the last few months, we launched two new products Zero Busbar cells and All-Black modules responding to an evolving market. These two products the requirements are showing a strong technical expertise.

These innovations are already receiving great market acceptance. Our manufacturing plants continue to run at near peak capacity utilization and our TOPCon cell line, which was commissioned in June 2025, was stabilized in record time and is now running at 90% plus levels. Our proposed acquisition of 51% stake in Transcon is complete. Transcon has reported excellent results with annual revenue and PAT of INR423 crores and INR45 crores respectively. EBITDA and PAT margins have jumped sharply over previous years to 19.1% and 10.6% respectively.

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The company is now embarking on major growth trajectory with total capacity set to increase nearly sevenfold to 16.75 GVA by July 2026 with focus on more lucrative HV and EHV segments. As we look forward to the new year, the environment around us is becoming ever more unpredictable.

But our investments in scale, technology, people and supplier relationships built over a 30-year operating platform are paying off in building a resilient business with profitable growth. The Middle East crisis is turning into a pivotal moment for renewables as all stakeholders look to rethink energy mix and reduce consumption of fossil fuels.

We believe this is going to provide a major boost to long-term demand for the sector. We are already seeing strong demand traction across all segments

. New installations in FY26 grew to

almost 45 gigawatt in AC terms, a fantastic 87% growth over FY25, with estimated total module demand of close to 60 gigawatt.

The momentum is expected to carry through into the current year, and I emphasize, notwithstanding concerns around tendering slowdown and transmission delays. This is reflected in our growth order book, which currently stands at INR14,010 crores, up 66% year-on-year. We are primed to capitalize on the booming solar opportunity with our expanded module capacity of 11.1 gigawatt and cell capacity going up to 10.6 gigawatt shortly. These capacities make us one of India's largest and most integrated cell and module manufacturer. FY27 is a year of large capex for us at INR5,100 crores to be deployed across cells, ingot wafers, batteries and inverters.

Helping us to transform our business with a diversified portfolio of clean energy equipment. At the same time, a major endeavour of the company is to leverage AI and digital technologies, automate day-to-day tasks, exploit process efficiency and boost productivity to stay competitive in an evolving marketplace. With all these initiatives, we hope to maintain our leadership position as the lowest cost producer of best-in-class products for the foreseeable future. Thank you. We are now open for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Praveen Sahay from Prabhudas Lilladher. Please go ahead.

Praveen Sahay: Yeah, thank you for the opportunity and many congratulations for a good set of numbers. My first question is related to the module. If you can clarify, like the total Q4, the DCR module volume as a percentage of a total volume has sequentially doubled?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: It's been clearly the same.

Praveen Sahay: Because if I look at the DCR website, it's showing that the production of the DCR module for you has been doubled on the sequential basis. So as the case for you, like can you clarify that?

Vinay Rustagi: So in the last quarterly call also we had said that the DCR website is more a verification portal for traceability and for DCR verification. It is not a portal to arrive at numbers of sales of module or cells. So the number there may not be an accurate number.

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Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Yeah, maybe you know, just to add to that Praveen. Our sales mix between selling cells and DCR modules, it changes on a quarter-to-quarter basis. And we have an order book comprising both—hello, can you hear us?

Praveen Sahay: Yes. Please go ahead.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Okay. And a sale order book comprises both cells, DCR modules and non-DCR modules. But I don't think you should read too much into the quarterly changes in this mix.

Praveen Sahay: Okay. Second on the cell realization or the external cells revenue, if you can give some indication that sequentially how it is shaping, because you have a higher order of a cell now in the order book. So how the realization is shaping up on the sequential basis?

Vinay Rustagi: So in terms of the cell market, you know, the cell market overall still continues to be favourable. The pricing has been quite stable at between 13.5 to 14 US cents and we don't see any change in pricing in the current environment.

Praveen Sahay: Okay. Yeah, thank you, sir. That's it.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Vikhram from DB Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Vikhram: Hi, sir. Two quick questions. First of all, there is a significant increase in purchase of stock. Could you clarify why is that the case, because it's approximately four times of last year? Is that helping us with the margins?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Hi. The stock going up is a planned move by us looking at the supply chain situation and also the new 5.6 gigawatt of module line which has got comm

issioned, which also requires more

stock to be purchased for the module line. So it's well in line with our plans. There is no major increase.

Aditya Vikhram: Okay. And there is also a net debt increase of approximately INR660 crores. Why is that?

Vinay Rustagi: So that is inevitable because we are embarking on a large capex program. You know our total capex for the cell line of 7 gigawatt alone is about INR3,000 crores. And then in addition to that, we have already started work on our ingot wafer project and separately on other projects including aluminium line, aluminium frames, battery storage and of course, transformers as well. So I think you will see, as we have previously said, we have about a INR12,000 crores capex plan spread over 3 years starting FY26. And as the capex goes up, we are funding it through a mix of internal accruals and debt and the debt level will inevitably go up as well. We are obviously -- sorry, please go on.

Aditya Vikhram: No, sorry, just to add there. I know you have clarified this on previous calls as well, but what is the debt-to-equity ratio which you are looking at or targeting?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Sorry, please repeat that question.

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Aditya Vikhram: So what is the debt-to-equity considering all the expansions which are in place and which we are planning as a company? What is the debt-to-equity ratio you are looking at in next 1 or 2 years?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So through this capex cycle our endeavour is to maintain our A plus rating and we want to maintain the debt-to-equity ratio at about 1 and debt-to-EBITDA ratio at about 1.5 or below.

Aditya Vikhram: Okay. And last and final thing, so we have somehow sustained margins when other peers in the same group are not able to because of copper prices, silver prices increase. It clearly looks like that this time the in-stock trades have helped us. How are you seeing the margin trajectory in this upcoming quarter? Again, silver prices and copper prices have started going up and there is all the war escalations and everything which is happening. So how do you see this sustaining at this level?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, I mean we can't give you any guidance on margin. We as a company, we don't give any futuristic, we don't make any futuristic statements. But our current order book is priced at levels which are consistent with what we saw in the last year. Yes, some costs are going up, but at the same time we are also doing a lot of work behind the scenes to be able to reduce our cost and improve the efficiencies in the overall business.

We also need to understand that the scale of the business has grown by almost 2x in the last 1 year and is going to grow by something like 2x to 3x over the next year as all the new plants

come online and our production kind of picks up. So the result of this is we are building significant operating leverage in the business, which is going to give us the advantage of efficiency in reduction of the fixed cost base.

The procurement cost should come down as scale goes up. So I think the result of all these things is that yes, some costs are going up, but we believe that we are in a very good shape to be able to absorb some of these cost increases and stay profitable. What happens to the exact margins obviously depends on a number of factors, many of which are outside our control.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: And just to add to what Vinay said, there is a favourable shift in the business. There is more DCR modules coming up as the demand increases, plus there is a policy shift towards ALMM-3, which is an advantage for leading players with strong balance sheets. So as Vinay said, apart from this, our scale, procurement efficiencies, low cost base, we believe it will help us maintain industry-leading margins.

Aditya Vikhram: Okay. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line o

f Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Hi. Thank you so much for taking my questions. So my first question is on exports. We've seen that exports have sort of never really been the focus for the company because of domestic demand. And now that the tariffs on tax plus the anti-dumping duties on India are very high, are we looking to export to the US at all by procuring cells from Africa or anything like that?

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Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So Nidhi, we are looking at -- if you look at our presentation, we feel there's a strong potential of exports to Europe and US both. We are seeing that the demand in Europe will really pick up after the FTA is in place. And even for the US, we are looking at more on cell manufacturing.

We had earlier announced our cell manufacturing plans in the US and we are looking at it positively now because things have settled down. And we feel that there is still a good opportunity for exports and we will look at the right opportunity to start exports to the US.

Nidhi Shah: All right. And since ALMM-2 is coming up, applicability in June when do we expect realistically that demand driven purely by ALMM-2 should actually start picking up through grandfathered projects?

Vinay Rustagi: So Nidhi, I mean when it comes to ALMM-2, we need to understand that there are various market segments with different rules applying to them in terms of application of ALMM-2. The private market both rooftop and open access projects for C&I customers, ALMM-2 becomes applicable from June 1 and the demand is expected to come online to come to the market immediately.

And that by the way is a very substantial demand because now the C&I segment is almost equal in size to the utility-scale segment. So we expect from June 1 onwards the entire market, the entire solar sector except for utility-scale segment to shift towards ALMM-2 or domestic cells. And then when it comes to the utility-scale market, the demand is going to come, I would say, towards the end of FY28 and 29 onwards because there are all these old projects which had been auctioned before September 25. They have been grandfathered and they can still use imported cells.

But if you look at the overall market demand mix, you know, if we look at what we did in the last year, out of 45 gigawatt, 30 gigawatt including rooftop, KUSUM and C&I is switching onto the domestic cells right now and only 15 gigawatt will be remaining for the utility-scale market for FY28 and beyond. So a bulk of the market shifts to domestic cells immediately now.

Nidhi Shah: All right. My last question would be on K-Solar. So the company recently announced that we will not be acquiring K-Solar anymore. So could you let us know why that was firstly and second that do we have other companies in mind for inorganic growth or is there something now that we're looking to build this piece on our own?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, so in terms of K-Solar, look this was a non-binding term sheet at that time and the final documentation still had to be completed. Obviously, there is a very comprehensive set of documents for any transaction of this kind and unfortunately we could not find an agreement on some of these terms and conditions in the set of documents.

I think that is the reason why the transaction could not be completed. In terms of our future plans, we remain totally committed to the inverter business and indeed are working right now to expedite our plans. We are looking at strategic options in terms of JV partner. We have a proposed JV with SMA SGS and that JV remains our first preference and we are looking at other strategic options as well and we will finalize this over the next few months.

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Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Kunal

Shah from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Kunal Shah: Yeah, hi sir. Congratulations on a very good set of numbers first of all. So firstly we've been able to maintain our gross margins at a stable level versus most of our peers seeing a very sharp decline in that sense. Could you just throw some insights on our execution and how are we managing this cost inflation which is ongoing?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So Kunal, I think one of the significant things which you see is utilizations of our cell lines. So we have been able to ramp up and utilize our cell lines at optimum level and that is one of the key reasons that we've been able to have the right DCR mix. Do you want to add something, Vinay?

Vinay Rustagi: No, I think Kunal this is a question we already tried to answer earlier. Yes, there's been an increase in some of the costs, but as the scale of the business goes up, we are also seeing a significant amount of operating leverage and efficiency coming into the business. We are actually doing a lot of work to optimize our operations, increase automation, use all the digital technologies etcetera to reduce our cost base. And I think what you see in terms of the results is basically a mix of some of these costs going up, but us being able to reduce costs on some of the other areas of operations helping us to maintain our margins.

Kunal Shah: Understood. Just a follow-up on this now, given like the 7 gigawatt line is going to come on stream anytime soon, right, in the next 3 months, 4 months. Now, do you see like as you ramp up the line these cost optimization will continue and if you can just quantify that and second on the 7 gigawatt line, would there be like a front-ended capex wherein you can do further Brownfield at a lower cost and what would be the optionality of that capex?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, sure. So I think I mean definitely 7 gigawatt is basically trebling our current capacity, all in a single line, single site. So there will definitely be many more efficiencies coming into the business. Just to give you an idea, we currently have four different module plants spread across Fab City and the new Sitarampur plant that we've just commenced operations in uses 40% less manpower on a per megawatt basis.

So that is the kind of advantage that we're seeing in reducing our cost base. In relation to a potential for Brownfield site, yes, I mean, I think that is definitely a real possibility for us. We have the land and the additional infrastructure available for doing an almost parallel 7 gigawatt new cell line with a capex cost efficiency of as much as 30% to 40%. So bearing in mind that our capex for the first 7 gigawatt line is already at about 35% lower than the industry benchmark, that gives us a major advantage in terms of cost and in an ability to scale up and build this line in a very quick time, assuming that the demand takes off.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is very helpful, sir. Secondly, in terms of the existing order book of INR14,000 odd crores, how should we think of the execution timelines of the same like the conversion to revenue on this? And sir, a follow-up here would be what, I mean, we know that you don't give a precise guidance, but the FY26 order inflows have been extremely strong for the company.

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Like, are we confident to grow on the order inflows for FY27 as well? Are you seeing that market shaping up in that sense?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, so Kunal, the execution of the order book, most of this will happen in FY27. I can't give you an exact number, but it will be, I would say more than two-thirds. And in relation to new order intake for the year, I think like we've said earlier there is a very strong demand momentum in the sector.

And in fact, we are going to see a surge in particularly, I would say, DCR order intake as we go forward because a large part of the market has been sitting on pl

acing new orders in anticipation

of hoping for an ALMM-2 extension. But we believe that the policy is here to stay and there will be no further extension. As and when, we approach June 1 and that kind of decision line becomes clear, we will see I would say, a big rush for orders. And I think FY27 should be equally good for the order intake for us and for the industry.

Kunal Shah: Understood. Thirdly sir on the resolution fund raising resolution is INR5,000 crores now. Could you just help with the rationale for the same and how are we contemplating on the potential capital allocation like what are the areas that came out?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Kunal this was an enabling resolution. We had taken this approval from our board. There is no plan for any QIB or fund raise immediately. As I told you we are looking at opportunities in

Europe, in US. As and when we see that there is an opportunity and we need to do a fund raise we will of course intimate as of now there is no plan. It was just an enabling resolution.

Kunal Shah: Understood. And last one, bookkeeping. There's this sharp increase of inventory, I mean, your working capital getting blocked. And now, could you help like is it because like we're building up the stock ahead of the module line coming up or like could you just explain the rationale?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: It's for two reasons. One is building up stock ahead of the module line and also because of the Middle East crisis that we've stocked up, we planned these inventory levels and stocked up raw material.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is extremely helpful, sir. All the best for the future and I'll fall back in the queue. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Naman Jain from Kotak Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Naman Jain: Hello. Am I audible?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Yes, Naman.

Naman Jain: Yeah. My question is primarily on the BESS business since it's the future is solar plus BESS and there have been multiple reports that the government's going to push for a 50% plus localization in BESS going forward, right? So seems like more of an ALMM moment for modules. So why and since the capex intensity is pretty low, especially for containerized BESS solution where we are not doing cells anymore.

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Why are we not pushing for a, let's say, a 12 gigawatt hour capacity by March 2027 itself?

Because given the asset turns going to be very high, so might be -- you might be one of the earlier players in the field and make up most of the profitability in this space in FY28?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, sure. Sure. I mean, I think Naman, you would have noted if you're following the government announcements and the likely shape of the policy, any localization roadmap is likely to become effective only by around FY28 or so. And as we speak, there is -- the industry is primarily basically relying on imports from China on which there is no constraint right now and the duty level also remains quite low at about 11%. So I think over the next 1 to 2 years, we will still continue to see a big portion of the demand being met from imports, and that is why we've decided to basically pace our capacity addition program for this business.

Naman Jain: Got it. And secondly since we have been able to create sort of a capability where we can expand cell capacity quickly and as well as at a lower capex, how sure are we in achieving the 7 gigawatt capacities as in, it sort of indicates that we'll be able to do it in the half year, which will probably make you the largest player in cell, right? So do we see any delays or it's sort of like we really believe that it's going to happen? And what's your expected timeline for stabilization after that?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So Naman, we had even said the same thing in our last earnings call that it's on track. And if you look at our presentation, the 7 gig

awatt plant, 4.8 June and 2.2 September is on track. It takes 4

to 6 months for stabilizing these lines and as we speak, everything is on track. We don't see any significant delays.

Naman Jain: Got it. Yeah, that's it from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Abhishek Nigam from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Abhishek Nigam: Yeah, hi. Thank you so much for the opportunity and congratulations on a very good result despite all the volatility. Just on -- in the presentation there is one slide on global opportunity.

So I was just wondering if you are able to give a little more details in terms of specifically is there something that you are looking for, either in module, cell, battery, any specific geographies that you prefer over others? So any thoughts over there that's my first question?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So Abhishek, on solar cells we had announced our JV with Heliene. We had put it on a pause. We have reinitiated discussions now. We have also started looking for sites. So we are serious on our US solar cell plans. On Europe, we are seeing a great opportunity. The demand is about 80 gigawatt there per annum. There's also a mandate in EU for solar cells, for inverters. So we are evaluating all these opportunities and as and when we are close to finalizing, we would update the markets.

Abhishek Nigam: Okay. Okay. Fair enough. I understand. And second on the battery side, so you know, everybody is doing capex. I see you are doing capex and Waaree is doing and others who are also sort of in the fray. Markets have expected a localization policy for a while, but off late there has not been much from the government or from the ministry. So is there anything you would update us on what is happening over there and if you expect a localization policy, could it be first half of this year, second half of this year? Anything you have over there?

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Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, sure Abhishek. So we feel that the government is completely committed to local manufacturing for batteries. In fact, batteries and all the other clean energy equipment, be it wind turbines, electrolyzers and all the other pieces of equipment over a period of time. With batteries, I think the government has been slightly conservative given that it's a nascent market and there is a large need for batteries in the short run.

There's more than 50 gigawatt hour of auctions which have been completed, which have been done at very, very competitive prices. Also given what the government and the market experience has been for ALMM for solar, the government is planning to give about a 2-year timeline to the industry to prepare itself.

We feel the government is very committed to this. They've already held industry consultations and the thought process is very, very consistent with what we have seen in ALMM-2 and ALMM-3. And we would expect the policy to be announced, I mean it's very difficult to give exact indicators for government initiatives, but it could be announced anytime over the next 3 months to 4 months.

Abhishek Nigam: Okay. That's very useful. Thank you so much. I will come back in the queue.

Vinay Rustagi: Thanks, Abhishek.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ketan Jain from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Ketan Jain: Thank you. Good evening, sir. Congratulations on a very good set of numbers. I just had a follow-up question from a previous participant. I understand we've been able to retain our margins and that is really appreciable. But how has the price cost moved from January till now?

The bill of module, bill of materials for modules, how has it moved in terms of cents per watt?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So you're talking about DCR modules or you're talking about non-DCR modules?

Ketan Jain: Both, sir. Just the bill of material, how has it increased? How has the cost increased?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So on non-DCR modules, we have seen cell prices rising in China. They have gone up from 3.5 cents level to almost 6, 6.2 cents. So it's like almost a 80%, 90% increase on cells. But since it's a pass-through to the customers, module prices would go up in line with China prices. And if you talk of DCR modules, because of scale, efficiencies and the mix which is changing, so we have been able to maintain our margins.

And we are quite confident that going forward long-term margin trends should be stable and likely even better because the mix is changing. What you need to understand is that the non-DCR modules are gradually going to be phasing out and more of made-in-India DCR mix is going to be brought in as the IPPs also start buying DCR modules. And we are quite confident that with scale and procurement efficiencies, we will be able to maintain healthy margins.

Ketan Jain: Is there any increase in the bill of material as well, apart from cells, in the costing?

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Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So for glass, there has been no increase because of the minimum import price. For aluminium, we have seen around 11% of the module cost is aluminium. There has been slight increase, but again with design changes and frame size optimization, we've been able to mitigate those increase of aluminium. So it's not been significant.

Ketan Jain: Understood. Sir, as you mentioned, there have been a healthy sales mix. I think around FY25, we would have had around 60% of non-DCR and around 40% of DCR. Do we maintain the same for FY26? Did we have the same mix?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So we never gave the FY25 numbers, but going forward, I can give you an indication that every quarter DCR mix is going to increase.

Ketan Jain: Okay. Understood, sir. Thank you and all the best. I will get back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prakhar Porwal from Ambit Capital. Please go ahead.

Prakhar Porwal: Thank you, sir, for the opportunity. Just one question again a follow-up to the previous participant's question. We talked on DCR, non-DCR modules. On cells, in the last call you mentioned two levers of cost saving. One is silver reduction in your solar cell and second is hedging that we do for 6 months.

So one first question is on hedging, what is the policy right now because given since last 6 months silver prices have remained elevated? So is the cost increasing on that front? Second, given you filed on the BSE as well about Zero Busbar cells, so maybe just some clarity what could be approximate reduction in silver consumption because of that, because we have not heard of Zero Busbar from anyone, any breakthroughs that globally you are seeing in terms of reducing silver which maybe we can also do in coming quarters?

Vinay Rustagi: Yes, hi Prakhar. So on silver, we had extensive discussions in the last call also. And we maintain sufficient stock at any given point of time and obviously also undertake hedging as we said last time. The other thing what we have started doing now is that we have started passing the silver cost risk to our customers in all the new orders that we are signing.

So as a result of all these initiatives, we are not affected by silver cost increases going forward, I would say. Second in terms of you mentioned about the potential for reduction of silver usage in our production. So the Zero Busbar modules or cells, they use lower silver by as much as about 10% reduction in silver.

And we believe that in longer term, we've got lot of other initiatives, again as we discussed last time also, including a potentially a complete replacement of silver with copper-based or even aluminium-based. That I would say broadly is about 1.5 to 2 years away. But in the meanwhile, we are working on a comprehensive program including reducing the silver consumption, hedging and passing

the cost to our consumers.

Prakhar Porwal: Sure, that's very helpful. Second question is on the order book. If I look at the order book mix, 60% cells and 40% modules and very rough calculation maybe suggests around 4 gigawatt, 4.5

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gigawatt of module order book. So my question is, given we'll have 11 gigawatt odd of module capacity largely for the entire year.

So will that mean reduction in utilization levels and how to look at that? That is one. And second is, given it is a very big cell order book, so does this mean that we're selling to players who are more dominant in the retail category where we don't have that dominance right now? And so what are we doing exactly to increase our presence there? Those are the two questions.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: So just to clarify on the cell order book, substantial portion of the order book also goes into FY28, so it's not in FY27 itself. These are contracts with module manufacturers whom we'll be supplying cells next year also. In terms of module utilization we are at almost about 11 gigawatt taking a 75% kind of a utilization, that's about a 7 gigawatt, 7.5 gigawatt. And then module orders we also see some potential possibilities of getting orders in every quarter. So these are orders which are in the order book which are long-term orders, whereas every quarter there is a order book which also comes up.

Vinay Rustagi: So just to add to that I'll again point to if you look at the makeup of the market, almost half of the market is basically coming from the rooftop and the C&I segments. The rooftop segment never shows up in our order book because those are mainly cash and carry orders and they are booked on a daily, weekly, monthly basis.

And the C&I market, which is basically about estimated at about 15 gigawatt, the ALMM-2 has become -- is becoming applicable now. And with that, I think we are likely to see a surge in order placement by these customers. So in general, we are very, very optimistic that we will see the order pipeline is already very healthy and we will see a large surge in order booking by customers which will basically allow us to also fulfil or fill our production capacity.

Prakhar Porwal: Understood. So just one clarification so the rooftop segment that you cater to, that is through the cash and carry distributor model?

Vinay Rustagi: That's right, yes.

Prakhar Porwal: Okay. Thank you so much and all the best for the coming quarters. Thank you.

Vinay Rustagi: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Vikhram from DB Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Vikhram: No, all my questions were answered. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Kunal Shah from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Kunal Shah: Yeah, thanks for the follow-up. Sir, on the cell technology, now we've been much ahead of the industry, so we were amongst the first to introduce the G12R cells and now Zero Busbar as well.

So what is the efficiency level in the Zero Busbar? How are like how is it getting received by

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the customers, like what feedback are you getting? And what would be the timelines for achieving the 25.8% that we sort of highlighted?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: I'll let Sudhir answer this question.

Sudhir Reddy: I think on the efficiency front, it is going to be about 0.1% to 0.15% higher efficiency. This is basically due to higher exposure area in the Zero Busbar. But besides that, it has other advantages

with respect to more robustness to shading and microcracks. That's the main advantage with respect to Zero Busbar.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: And your other question was on when do we reach 25.8% efficiency?

Sudhir Reddy: We are currently at an average efficiency in the TOPCon line at about 25.5%. Now that we are getting sta

bilized these lines with a 90% utilization, we expect to move forward gradually over the next few months, one step at a time. I would say at least it will take us couple of more quarters to get to that kind of efficiency levels.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is helpful, sir. And sir, just a follow-up here. Now from here on like how do you see this efficiency curve panning out like what are the further tech upgradations or improvements that we are working upon which has already worked in China and if you could just provide some insights over there?

Sudhir Reddy: See, I think currently, if you see the efficiency trends in China, they are on a mass production, it's still hovering around 25.6 to 25.8 even for the A-grade ones. What you see these announcements around 26 and all are more for the champion cells and not the mass production cell efficiencies.

With the TOPCon technology, you hit a bar somewhere around 26% to 26.1%. Beyond that, efficiency improvement just at the TOPCon cell is not possible. It will need more innovations, more into tandem cell technology, back contact and all these kind of newer technologies which will take some more time to mature on a mass production scale. I think we are at least a couple of more years from 2 to 3 years at least from seeing mass-produced tandem modules.

Kunal Shah: Got it. This is very helpful, sir. Second, in terms of the backward integrations, you've talked about aluminium frames. So are there any other verticals also that we are looking or contemplating upon in terms of insourcing of raw materials or anything of that sort?

Vinay Rustagi: See Kunal, I think that remains a watching piece for us. We have to wait and see how the government policy evolves. We know that the government is quite keen to start getting all these components also made in India. But what is the exact policy and what are the timelines, we will have to kind of wait to see how that shapes up and accordingly we will decide what is best for the business.

Kunal Shah: Got it. And so lastly on Transcon, like it's a bit untouched now with respect to the upcoming 10 gigawatt hour capacity. Could you just give some like how do the milestones look like here in terms of getting the required certification and especially because it's an HV, EHV segment, how are we progressing on the talent acquisition as well, if you could just tell that? Thank you.

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Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, sure. So Kunal, in terms of milestones, this plant is due for completion in July this year. And the good thing is that because of the strong management team in place and the fact that the company already has existing production facilities, they have already started producing some of the larger transformers and doing type testing and certification work which can take as long as 6 to 12 months.

So I think the company is making very steady progress on that. In terms of management team, there is already a strong management team as we have shown in our previous presentations which is ex-Toshiba and some of the other majors in the electrical goods industry. And we believe that the company has already secured amongst their first orders. So it will take about 2 years for the company to fully ramp up their operations, but they are well on track to beginning commercial production and achieving certification in this timeline.

Kunal Shah: Understood. Just a clarification, from which like which client have we got the order from?

Vinay Rustagi: See, unfortunately, I can't give you the client name, Kunal.

Kunal Shah: Understood. This is very helpful, sir. Thank you so much.

Vinay Rustagi: Sure. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aritra Banerjee from Nomura. Please go ahead.

Aritra Banerjee: Yeah. Hi. Thank you for taking my question and congratulations for a very good set of numbers.

So sir, just wanted to ask one bookk

eeeping question. So on Slide number 22, the sales that you've mentioned is 21,751 million, whereas in the reported financials, the sales number is 22,303, the revenue from operations. So just wanted to understand why the difference?

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, sure. So what you see on this slide, Aritra, is only the cell and module sales because this order book is only for cells and modules. But in addition to this, we obviously have the projects and the EPC business. So the rest of the revenue is coming from that line, which is not showing here.

Aritra Banerjee: Okay, sir. Understood. And another question I wanted to ask was sequentially the share of modules in the revenue has gone up, but still like the overall margins have remained stable. So

I understand like the DCR share in the module revenue has also gone up. But typically, like cells have sharper margin profile than DCR module business as well.

So going forward, even like going forward, even if the cells' share in the revenue comes down, are the margins still expected to remain same or in other words, are like DCR module business revenue and cell business revenue margins the same? Could you please share some colour on that?

Vinay Rustagi: So Aritra I think unfortunately we can't predict the future and we can't say how the margins are going to play out in future. But you can see what is the current shape of our order book. And we've said earlier that the order book pricing is consistent with what we have seen over the last 6 to 12 months.

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So that gives us a good visibility in terms of the volumes as well as—as well as pricing and margins. But going forward, the mix is only going to become more favourable wherein the DCR share is going to grow at the cost of the non-DCR market, which is a much lower margin market. So overall, I think the margin outlook for the business is likely to be favourable going into the future.

Aritra Banerjee: Understood, sir. And just one last question regarding the ALMM list 2 implementation. So hypothetically speaking, if it doesn't get implemented, let's say in June 2026 or it gets delayed by some months, so is there any risk of some of the orders in our current order book getting cancelled going forward or is that not a material risk?

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: No, it's not a material risk because none of the orders in our order book are from the C&I segments which are deliveries in the next 2 or 3 months. So if you look at what business is going to come up from 1st June, it is going to be the C&I business which will immediately move into the DCR mix.

And most of these C&I developers have finished or have completed their installations with the 1st June deadline. So the orders in our order book from that segment are post October-November. So even if the DCR or the implementation gets delayed by a quarter, it would not affect any of our orders and we don't see any material risk there.

Aritra Banerjee: Understood, sir. Thanks for the answers and all the best for the upcoming quarters.

Chiranjeev Singh Saluja: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from participants, I now hand the conference over to management for closing comments.

Vinay Rustagi: Yeah, thank you. So thank you everyone for your time. I appreciate it's a Friday evening. You know, just to conclude the call and how we see the business, see there is a lot of noise in the market in relation to demand slowdown, strong competition, cost and margin pressures, etcetera. We believe that our performance over the last year has been a very strong validation of the company's overall business strategy, management competence and execution. In general, we are very, very positive on the growth outlook for the sector given all the initiatives by the government. And we are now, in fact, beginning to think beyond the current plans and looking to n

ext stage of growth in terms of products, technologies and geographies. We are grateful for your support and look forward to working with you. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of ICICI Securities Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.